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IN BRIEF

Two fires in city leave 7 hurt; over 100 evacuated

NEW DELHI
Two fires in different parts of Delhi on Sunday left seven persons injured. Nearly 100-150 people were evacuated from a building adjoining one of the burnt structures and large-scale firefighting operations were launched, an official said. » **Page 2**

THE HINDU
greet its readers on the occasion of
Vinayaka Chaturthi
There will be no issue of THE HINDU dated September 15, 2026 as Vinayaka Chaturthi is a holiday
Readers can access the online edition at www.thehindu.com

EDUCATIONPLUS » PAGE 17

Modi flags weaponisation of tech, critical minerals

BRICS, now in its third decade, should focus on concrete actions, not 'merely ideas', says Modi; he lists initiatives to bolster supply chains, boost resilience against pandemics and climate disasters

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Warning against the "weaponisation" of technology and access to critical minerals, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday highlighted new BRICS initiatives to strengthen supply chains and increase resilience against disruptions, pandemics, and climate disasters.

The rising number of global conflicts has an increasingly negative and far-reaching impact on the lives of ordinary people, Mr. Modi said on the final day of the BRICS Summit here.

As the 11-member grouping enters its third decade, the world expects concrete results from the group, not "merely ideas



Prime Minister Narendra Modi at a session on the second day of the BRICS Summit at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, on Sunday. PTI

and commitments", the Prime Minister noted.

Mr. Modi also pointed out that the confidence of Global South countries in BRICS has grown because "their voices are heard, their experiences are respected, and solutions are developed not for them, but together with them".

"The weaponisation of technology and critical minerals can hinder our shared progress," Mr. Modi said.

"Therefore, we have emphasised inclusivity in the adoption of technology. Pandemics, climate disasters, and supply-chain disruptions have shown

that in today's interconnected world, no crisis remains confined to a single region," he said.

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BRICS should ensure the world is free from 'double standards': Xi

Ananth Krishnan
BEIJING

Chinese President Xi Jinping on Sunday called on the BRICS countries to "rally the Global South" to ensure that an increasingly volatile international order was "free from double standards", even as he offered a five-point AI and smart manufacturing initiative to take forward the digital future of the grouping.

Speaking at the second session of the summit in New Delhi before returning to Beijing after a 24-hour visit to India, Mr. Xi said the global landscape was currently "volatile and fraught with risks and challenges".

"To bring stability to the world and make it a better place, BRICS countries must seize the historical initiative, rally the Global South, be an active, stabilising, and positive force in



Xi Jinping

international affairs, and advance the well-being of all humanity," he said, according to remarks released by the Foreign Ministry in Beijing.

Mr. Xi did not name the United States. Still, Chinese officials have increasingly aimed at Washington for how they see its exercise of power in a self-described "rules-based order", especially after recent actions in Venezuela and the war with Iran.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Putin suggests BRICS grain trade to fight global curbs

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Under crippling sanctions by Western powers over the war with Ukraine, Russian President Vladimir Putin on Sunday proposed a new insurance mechanism and a collaborative grain market among BRICS nations for economic growth of the bloc as well as the Global South nations.

He urged the 11-member grouping to adopt a holistic approach to fight both symptoms and roots of global challenges. "We have independent routes for moving capital, labour, and technologies. In fact, we can operate regardless of outside pressure," Mr. Putin said at the final session of the BRICS Summit here.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Kin of 4 killed in Leh protest to get *ex gratia*

Peerzada Ashiq
SRINAGAR

Ladakh Lieutenant-Governor V.K. Saxena on Sunday announced compensation of ₹15 lakh to the next of kin of those killed during the Leh street protests in September last year. The administration also announced ₹3 lakh to those with major injuries and ₹1 lakh for minor injuries.

"In our continued commitment to support the families affected by the tragic violence in Ladakh on 24 September last year, today sanctioned compensation of ₹15 lakh to the next of kin of each of the four deceased," said the L-G.

The announcement comes after Ladakh's civil society groups, including

Leh Apex Body and the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA), held talks with the Centre on September 9.

There is a growing convergence between the Centre and the Ladakh groups, which had demanded compensation for the deceased.

'Grateful to Shah'

The L-G said he was "deeply grateful to Union Home Minister Amit Shah for his sensitive, humanitarian and guiding approach, who has always stood in solidarity with the victims and their families".

The Home Ministry has proposed an elected body for the UT by introducing a new constitutional provision under Article 371 of the Constitution.

Royal salute



Warm welcome: A batch of elephants for the Dasara festival next month arriving at the Mysuru Palace on Sunday. M. A. SRIRAM

Iran President slams 'unilateral sanctions'

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The BRICS must play a greater role in building a more balanced, inclusive, and just international order, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said on Sunday while stressing that resilience, cooperation, and sustainability should be translated into practical action.

In an address at the concluding session of the BRICS Summit here, Mr. Pezeshkian, taking a swipe at Western powers, also slammed "unilateral sanctions", saying they were directly impacting global food security and welfare of people. The remarks came weeks after the U.S. imposed new economic



Masoud Pezeshkian

sanctions on Iran, tightening the squeeze on its finances amid the ongoing war. Mr. Pezeshkian said economic resilience could not be sustained without security, referring to what he described as the military aggression by the U.S. and Israel against Iran.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 11

Houthis claim new attacks on Saudi Arabia while Yemeni forces prepare to fight back

Associated Press
CAIRO

Iran-aligned Houthi militia in Yemen on Sunday claimed new attacks on Saudi Arabia, as internationally recognised Yemeni government described the rebels' swift advance along the Red Sea coast as a "painful" development in a new front in the Iran war.

The Houthis claimed more attacks with missiles and drones on Saudi Arabia, which supports Yemen's internationally recognised government. A Houthi military spokesperson, Brigadier General Yahya Saree, claimed in a statement that the group targeted a military base in Sharurah province in Saudi



A screengrab from a video released by the Houthis on Saturday shows fighters near military vehicles in southern Yemen. AP

Arabia's Najran region.

The Saudi Arabian civil defence said a projectile fell in al-Tawwal governorate near the border with Yemen along the Red Sea, injuring two people and damaging a mosque and several other buildings.

There was no statement from Saudi Arabia on Sunday on any new attacks targeting the Houthis, who have been hitting the kingdom's oil infrastructure and shipping as part of a recently declared blockade. However, Houthi me-

dia reported on Sunday that Saudi Arabia had carried out two strikes on Sada, in the north of Yemen.

While the rebels, who now control the Red Sea coast and the crucial Bab el-Mandeb Strait, have said there is no threat to commercial shipping, markets remain wary and oil prices have risen again. Meanwhile, a government official in Yemen said its forces will return to the coast and fight back. Sultan al-Arada of the presidential council in Yemen said late on Saturday that forces "are currently regrouping and will return to the battle in one form or another."

PIPELINE OUTAGE IMPACTS
» PAGE 14

One killed in strike on Iranian commercial vessel in the Strait of Hormuz, says Tehran

Associated Press
CAIRO

An Iranian commercial ship was struck early on Sunday off the Qeshm Island in the Strait of Hormuz, killing one person, Iranian state media said, a day before Tehran plans to brief countries in the region on its contested efforts to manage shipping traffic at the crucial waterway.

Iran's state-run IRNA news agency quoted the governor of Qeshm, the island crucial for Iran asserting control over the Strait of Hormuz, as blaming a "terrorist enemy" for the attack.

There was no immediate comment by the U.S.



With traffic in the Strait of Hormuz being low since the war began, vessels seen anchored off the coast of Bandar Abbas in Iran. AP

military, which has struck Iranian-flagged vessels during its blockade of Tehran's ports. On Saturday, the military said its forces had redirected 100 commercial vessels over the past 60 days.

Separately, the United

Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations monitor said a vessel was hit by a projectile while transiting the strait, with no further details.

The monitor said a fire had broken out and that local authorities were evac-

uating those on board. It was not immediately clear if it was the same strike.

Hours before the attack, Iran's government remained defiant. "Our people cannot be bullied into submission. Iran will not surrender," President Masoud Pezeshkian said in a social media post.

Iran has said Foreign Ministers from regional countries will meet on Monday in Oman to discuss efforts by Iran and Oman, located on the other side of the strait, to manage shipping on it, which has been low since the war began with U.S.-Israeli strikes on Iran in February.

'TURNING THE PAGE'
» PAGE 14

Over 700 held in five-month illegal liquor drive as new excise policy takes shape

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Excise Department has arrested 730 people and registered 725 FIRs over the past five months as part of a crackdown on the illegal liquor trade in the Capital, the Chief Minister's Office (CMO) said on Sunday. The department also seized 2.20 lakh bottles of illegal liquor and 197 vehicles during the period, even as a new excise policy is in the works, it added.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said that the Delhi government has a "zero-tolerance policy" on illegal liquor trade. "The government is working on a new excise policy aimed at strengthening public safety, ensuring responsible regulation of the liquor trade, maintaining quality and increasing government revenue," Ms. Gupta said. She added that the government's priority is to ensure availability of legal liquor during festivals so that residents don't face inconvenience, while also effectively curbing the sale and smuggling of illegal liquor.

Check on emissions

Meanwhile, in a video statement, Ms. Gupta announced that all pollution testing centres in the city will be upgraded to effectively check emissions. Noting a technol-



CM Rekha Gupta said her govt. has a zero-tolerance policy on illegal liquor.

ogy gap, she said private vehicles use petrol pump booths while commercial ones rely on outdated certification systems. To strengthen monitoring, every centre will be equipped with cameras. New automated stations in Tehkhand and Nand Nagri will each test 72,000 commercial vehicles annually.

Arpan centres

According to a CMO statement, Delhi Metro's 10 'Arpan' centres, launched last month, have collected over 41 tonnes of old clothes from nearly 4,000 people till August 31, with a portion being reused or upcycled. The government plans to open 10 more centres in January 2027, the statement added.

Two godown fires leave seven injured; over 100 residents taken to safety

Building next to warehouse in Dallupura a 'hostel-type structure' with 50-60 rooms, say fire dept. officials; three children rushed to hospital after blaze in Swaroop Nagar

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Two godown fires in different parts of Delhi on Sunday left seven persons, including a senior fire department official, injured.

Around 100-150 people were evacuated from a building adjoining one of the warehouses and large-scale firefighting operations were launched, an official said. In east Delhi's Dallupura, a fire broke out at a ground-floor warehouse behind Dharamshila Hospital.

A ground-plus-two-storey residential building, described by fire officials as a "hostel-type structure" with 50-60 rooms, stood close to the warehouse.

"Around 100-150 people, including families, were evacuated from the adjoining building and brought out safely. The building was cleared as smoke and flames from the warehouse posed a risk to its occupants," Assistant Divisional Officer of the Delhi Fire Services (DFS) Ashok Kumar told *The Hindu*.

Station Officer Sunil Sagar inhaled smoke while carrying out operations and was rushed to Lal Bahadur Shastri Hospital in a CATS ambulance, the DFS stated in a release.

Deputy Chief Fire Officer M.K. Chattopadhyay said the DFS received the first call at 3.29 p.m. "On reaching the location, firefighters found a large warehouse with heavy black smoke rising from plastic and PVC materials stored inside," Mr. Chattopadhyay said. "At 5.18 p.m., it was declared a medium-category fire," he added. As of 10.17 p.m., the fire had been brought under control while cooling operations were under way.

Earlier in the day, a fire broke out at a godown containing rexine products and gym equipment in north-west Delhi's Swaroop Nagar. According to an



(Top) Firefighters at work near a godown in east Delhi's Dallupura on Sunday; the site where a blaze broke out in Swaroop Nagar. PTI, SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

official, the blaze spread rapidly through a basement and a ground-plus-two-storey building, with flames and radiant heat reaching an adjoining residential property.

Six persons from the neighbouring house were injured in the fire. Priyanka, 28, Santosh, 33, and three children, Vani, 5, Tanvi, 8, and Anshika, 8, inhaled smoke while fleeing the blaze. They were rescued by fire personnel and taken to Babu Jagjivan Ram Hospital.

Vijay Singh, 55, sustained leg injuries after jumping from the adjoining building in panic.

He was shifted to a government hospital in Burari for treatment, the official said.

Division Fire Officer Ashok Kumar Jaiswal said no one was inside the godown when the fire broke out. "The building was separated from the neighbouring residential structure by a road about 15 feet wide, but flames and smoke reached the adjoining house," he said.

Short circuit

"A preliminary assessment suggested that an electrical short circuit may have triggered the fire. The presence of inflammable material caused the fire to spread rapidly," he added.

Mr. Jaiswal said further investigation into the cause of the fire and the extent of the damage was under way.



An MCD team inspected the structure and found that it posed a risk of collapse, with cracks in several places. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Four-storey building tilts in Gandhi Nagar, 11 people evacuated

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Panic gripped residents of east Delhi's Gandhi Nagar area after a four-storey building tilted, forcing the evacuation of 11 people from two families living on the second and third floors, an official said on Sunday.

Shahdara Deputy Commissioner of Police R.P. Meena said police personnel on patrol were alerted by a resident that the building, located on Satsang Marg in Chand Mohalla, had tilted on Saturday afternoon.

Subsequently, officials from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), Delhi Fire Services (DFS), Delhi Development Authority (DDA) and other agencies reached the spot.

The DFS control room received a call about the incident at 1.45 p.m.

Marked for demolition

"The building has been marked for demolition, which is scheduled for Monday. A temporary jack (structural support) has been installed to support the structure and keep it stable until demolition," Mr. Meena added.

According to an official, an MCD team inspected the structure and found

that it posed a risk of collapse, with cracks in several places. Eleven members of the two families were asked to vacate the premises immediately.

"The building, which stands on about 50 square yards, has a godown housing clothing material and textiles on the ground floor, while the first floor was vacant. The two families were residing on the second and third floors," the official added.

Owner notified

Meanwhile, a notice has been issued to the owner, warning that the structure could collapse at any time and cause a major accident.

"The authorities are keeping a close watch on the situation to ensure the safety of people living in the surrounding area," the official said.

The incident comes a week after the collapse of a five-storey building housing a paying guest accommodation in Satya Niketan in south-west Delhi killed seven people and injured several others.

The incident prompted the MCD to intensify inspections and launch a demolition drive against illegally constructed and unsafe structures across the city.



UNION TERRITORY OF JAMMU & KASHMIR
OFFICE THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER PWD (R&B) PROJECT
DIVISION- III, JAMMU

SHORT NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Short e-NIT No. 66 of 2026-2027 Dated 11-09-2026

For and on behalf of the **Lieutenant Governor**, Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir e-tenders are invited on **percentage** basis from approved and eligible Contractors registered with Union Territory of J&K, CPWD, Railways, MES and other State/Central Governments for each of the following works :-

S. No	Name of Work	Name of Division	Advised Cost (Rs in Lacs)	Cost of document (in Rs)	Earnest Money (in Rs)	Time Allowed for completion	Time and date of opening of tender	Class of Contractor
1	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly upgraded Kotli no-4 and Kotli no-8 at Ghulam Bagh, Jammu. CNo-222 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	9.60	600	2% of Advised Cost	60 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
2	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly constructed room in various quarters at C-Block Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-223 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	9.60	600	2% of Advised Cost	60 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
3	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly upgraded Government Qtr. No. 20, C.21-C & 39-C at Gandhi Nagar, Jammu by way of construction of additional rooms and other allied works. CNo-224 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	8.64	600	2% of Advised Cost	60 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
4	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly constructed room in various quarters at B-Block Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-225 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	9.60	600	2% of Advised Cost	60 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
5	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly constructed rooms at Government Qtr. No 6-B, 10-B, 29-B and 8-B Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-226 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	11.52	600	2% of Advised Cost	75 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
6	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly constructed room in Govt quarters no 11-B-Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-227 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	4.80	600	2% of Advised Cost	45 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
7	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly constructed room in various quarters at A-Block Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-228 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	9.60	600	2% of Advised Cost	60 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
8	Electrical upgradation of Govt. Qtr. 14-A-Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-229 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	4.80	600	2% of Advised Cost	45 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
9	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly constructed rooms with toilet at Govt. Qtr. 11-A Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-230 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	4.80	600	2% of Advised Cost	45 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
10	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly upgraded Govt. Qtrs. No. 2-A, 3-A, 4-A, 26-A Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-231 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	19.20	600	2% of Advised Cost	75 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
11	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly constructed rooms with attached toilet and parking shed and allied electrical works at Govt. Qtr. No. 1-A Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-232 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	4.80	600	2% of Advised Cost	45 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card
12	Electrical wiring and allied works for newly upgraded of Government Qtr. No. 21-A, 25-A, 33-A and 35-A Gandhi Nagar, Jammu. CNo-233 P	PWD (R&B) Project Div. III, Jammu	11.54	600	2% of Advised Cost	75 Days	(1300 Hrs) on or after 18-09-2026	Electric Card

Position of AAA : Accorded
Position of TS : Under Process

The Bidding documents Consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Drawings, bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen/downloaded from the departmental website <http://jktenders.gov.in> as per below schedule:-

1	Date of Issue of Tender Notice	11-09-2026
2	Period of downloading of bidding documents	From 11-09-2026 to 17-09-2026 upto 1800 Hrs
3	Date, Time and place of pre-bid meeting	15-09-2026at 1200 Hrs. in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Project Division III, Jammu
4	Bid submission Start Date	11-09-2026
5	Bid Submission End Date	17-09-2026upto1800 Hrs
6	Date & time of opening of Technical Bids (Online)	18-09-2026 on or after 1300 Hrs in the Office of Executive Engineer PWD (R&B) Project Division III, Jammu
7	Date & time of opening of Financial Bids	To be notified after technical bid evaluation is completed

No. :-PWD(R&B)/PD-III/7314-26
Dated :-11-09-2026

Sd/-
(Er. Rahat Gupta)
Executive Engineer
Project Division III, Jammu

DIP/J-10290/26 Sep 12 2026



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MONDAY, SEP. 14

RISE 06:05 SET 18:27

RISE 09:01 SET 20:08

TUESDAY, SEP. 15

RISE 06:06 SET 18:26

RISE 10:00 SET 20:43

WEDNESDAY, SEP. 16

RISE 06:06 SET 18:25

RISE 10:59 SET 21:23

Delhi Weather max min

Delhi City 36 27

Safdarjang 36 27

Palam 34 24

Delhi Palam Today
34°C The weather will be warm. Chances of light rain & thundershower with gusty winds. A comfortable night.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

Sh. A V Raja and his wife Smt. Pavayee, R/O E-148, 3rd Floor, JJ Colony, Indrapuri, Delhi-110012, have severed all relations with their son Shaktivel Raja, disowning him from their personal life and from all movable and immovable properties with immediate effect. They shall not be responsible for his acts, misconduct, or deeds. Anyone dealing with him shall do so at their own risk, cost, and consequences.

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TENDERS

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Gaur Sundaram Association of Apartment Owners (GSAOA) Greater Noida West, invites bids from reputed and experienced agencies/firms for providing Horticulture & Landscaping services. Interested agencies may obtain the tender document from gsoa2023@gmail.com and submit their bids as per the prescribed terms and conditions.

Security deposit / EMD: As per tender Terms and Conditions. Start Date for Horticulture Services: 14-Sep-2026 Last Date: 28-Sep-2026
GSAOA reserves the right to accept or reject any/all bids without assigning any reason.

ABVP unveils manifesto for DUSU polls; student housing, women's safety top priorities

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) on Sunday released its manifesto for the Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) elections, with student housing among its key focus areas. The recent collapse of a building housing a paying guest (PG) accommodation in Satya Niketan had highlighted the shortage of safe and affordable living spaces for university students.

In its manifesto, the ABVP has proposed the construction of new hostels, adequate hostel facilities for women students, a dedicated student accommodation cell and helpline, safety audits of PGs and hostels, strict implementation of fire-safety norms, and better access to basic facilities such as clean amenities, drinking water, and Internet connectivity.

Speaking at the release, ABVP's presidential candidate Yash Dabas said, "The four pillars of our manifesto, 'A-Awas, B-Bhagidari, V-Vishwas and P-Parinaam', represent the issues that directly affect students' lives and aspirations. The manifesto focuses on safe and affordable student accommodation, women's safety, greater student participation in university decision-making, academic reforms and career opportunities."

'Stronger security patrols'

On women's safety, the manifesto proposes stronger security patrols, pink booths, adequate women security personnel, improved lighting, common rooms for women students, sanitary napkin vending machines, gynaecologists at health centres, and

ABVP candidates Yash Dabas, Ishu Maurya, and Riya Chhawdi unveiling the group's manifesto in New Delhi on Sunday. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

self-defence training. To strengthen students' transition from education to employment, the ABVP has also proposed greater opportunities through job fairs, industry and research-institution partnerships, training and internships, AI and digital-skills programmes, and innovation and entrepreneurship initiatives.

'Creating mechanisms'

ABVP's vice-presidential candidate Ishu Maurya said, "Students are the primary stakeholders of the university, and their voices must have a meaningful place in decisions that affect them. Our focus will be on creating mechanisms where students can raise their concerns and see effective action on them."

The ABVP candidates contesting the election are Yash Dabas for the post of president, Ishu Maurya (vice-president), Riya Chhawdi (secretary), and Lakshya Raj Singh (joint secretary).

Meanwhile, the National Students' Union of India announced that it will release its manifesto on Monday. The election is scheduled for September 18.

213 buildings brought down this month in MCD drive

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Sunday carried out 11 demolitions and sealed four properties as its crackdown on dangerous buildings and unauthorised constructions continued across the national capital.

With the latest action, the civic body has carried out 213 demolitions and sealed 109 properties since September 1, an official said. The drive was carried out at various locations across the civic body's 12 zones, covering areas such as Bijwasan, Dilshad Colony, Dilshad Garden, East Delhi, and Old Delhi, the official added.

The MCD carried out 33 demolitions and sealed five properties on Saturday as part of the ongoing drive. It was intensified following the September 6 collapse of a building housing a paying guest accommodation in Satya Niketan that claimed seven lives.

Field survey

As part of the wider exercise, the MCD is also conducting a field survey of buildings operating as PG accommodations. Officials have identified 2,114 facilities so far to create a database. The civic body also confirmed that action against those violating building bylaws would continue across all 12 zones.



A NDIDE



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INBRIEF



Nagina MP detained while visiting slain trader's family

Azad Samaj Party (Kanshi Ram) president and Nagina MP Chandrashekhar Azad was stopped and detained in Uttar Pradesh's Barabanki on Sunday while en route to Gonda to meet the family of slain trader Vinod Kumar Sahani, police said. According to Masoli SHO Ashwini Kumar, Mr. Azad was travelling from Lucknow to Gonda when police stopped his convoy at Shahpur toll plaza, took him into custody and escorted him to a circuit house in Ramnagar. Mr. Azad's detention angered his supporters, some of whom allegedly broke the toll barrier, leading to brief chaos. PTI

M.P. hooch tragedy: wanted man caught after encounter

A man wanted in connection with the hooch tragedy in Madhya Pradesh's Sagar district that claimed 16 lives was apprehended after a brief encounter with police early on Sunday, officers said. The 21-year-old accused, Shivanjay Rajput, who was carrying a bounty of ₹30,000, suffered a gunshot wound to his leg during the face-off, the police said. With this, the number of accused arrested in the spurious liquor consumption case has gone up to 19, police sources said. A country-made .315-bore pistol, three live cartridges, a mobile phone, and a motorcycle were recovered from Mr. Rajput's possession. PTI

Nephew 'spreading false rumours about my health', says Mayawati

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) president Mayawati on Sunday hit out at her nephew Akash Anand, accusing him of spreading what she described as "false rumours" about her health.

'Call to secretary'

Addressing a press conference in Lucknow, the four-time former Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister said she expelled party leader

had called her personal secretary Alok Kumar and enquired whether she was unwell.

"Those expelled from the party spread the rumour. The office in-charge received a call from Akash Anand. He asked about my health. The office in-charge told him that I was doing fine and busy with party work. At this, Akash hung up after telling that 'Behen ji' (the BSP president) not be informed of this conversation," Ms.

Mayawati said. The allegations came days after the BSP president removed Mr. Anand from the party, shortly after his father-in-law and former Rajya Sabha member Ashok Siddharth announced his retirement from politics.

The BSP had removed Mr. Anand as national coordinator of the party on September 3.

Ms. Mayawati urged party workers to mobilise for the upcoming elections.

Dipke 'resigns' as M.P. CM over deaths of 30 children in Balaghat

Press Trust of India
BHOPAL

Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) founder Abhijeet Dipke on Sunday resorted to satire to target the Mohan Yadav government over the deaths of tribal children in Balaghat district and posted a tongue-in-cheek letter on X about his "resignation" as "Chief Minister of Madhya Pradesh".

In the letter, addressed to Governor Mangubhai Patel, Mr. Dipke stated he was quitting as "my conscience does not allow me to continue occupying this chair after the deaths".

Through satire, the CJP chief took aim at the government's handling of the deaths of more than 30 children, particularly the compensation announced for the victims' families.

SPOTLIGHT

Nikhil M Babu

It is around 11 a.m. and the downpour is intensifying. Mahesh Saini, 40, with a sack slung over his left shoulder and a stick in his right hand, reaches the Nehru Nagar Atal Canteen, an initiative of the Delhi government to provide meals at ₹5 each. As he enters, a man at a counter inside shouts, waving his hand: "Bora bahar (Leave the sack outside)."

Mahesh, a ragpicker, puts down the white plastic sack, ties its mouth carefully, and leaves it next to the door. He props up his stick there too. His once-white T-shirt and his hair tell the same story: neither has been washed for a while.

He walks to the counter and the man behind a laptop holds out a webcam and takes his photo. "Now blink," the operator says, so that the camera can scan his iris. Mahesh silently obeys, as he knows the drill by now. He produces a ₹5 coin, moves to the next counter and picks up a steel plate. A woman serving the meals wastes no time in filling the plate's compartments with hot short-grain rice, yellow pulse with some *rajma*, a runny vegetable of potato with a little brinjal, and four thin tawa *rotis*.

Mahesh settles at one of the six metal tables with attached metal stools. "Kha-

na mujhe achha lagta hai (I like the food)," says Mahesh, who collects plastic bottles and other trash. For this, he earns ₹200 a day. "I end up spending almost all the money," he says, adding that he sleeps on the footpath.

For thousands of people like Mahesh, Atal Canteens have become a daily stop for a cooked meal, which costs them little. Since December 2025, the Delhi government has started similar Atal Canteens at 100 locations across the city, giving out close to 50,000 meals every day. Each canteen has a daily capacity of 1,000 meals, 500 each for lunch and dinner.

The contract for running the 100 canteens has been awarded to 11 different companies or NGOs. The vendor charges ₹30 for each meal, of which it collects ₹5 from the individual and ₹25 from the government.

At the launch of the scheme on December 25 last year, the birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said that the government's aim was to make sure that no one in Delhi goes hungry.

India ranks 102nd out of 123 countries in the Global Hunger Index report, with a score of 25.8 that places the country in the "serious" hunger category.

Gupta says the subsidised food network has crossed the milestone of 1 crore meals served. She

For thousands, Atal Canteens have become a daily stop for a meal that costs ₹5. Spread across 100 locations in the city, these spaces serve around 50,000 meals a day, attracting people from different walks of life



A filling stop: The Atal Canteen in Anand Vihar, located near the inter-State bus terminal and railway station, that is frequented by commuters and workers. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

adds that the government is open to improving the menu, but every change will be driven by nutrition, evidence, affordability and the public preference.

Respite for thousands

Though most canteens have come up near slum clusters, a few are located near hospitals, colleges and bus terminals, drawing people from diverse backgrounds.

The pulse and the vegetable change after every meal at each canteen. Unlike Oliver Twist, who was admonished for asking for

a second serving, people at many Atal Canteens can refill their plates.

However, Appu Rao, 48, from Andhra Pradesh, says, "Modi is giving (subsidised) food now, but in the South it has been given for a long time." He gets into a conversation with another person about how the food was better when the canteen opened and it is still better at the Atal Canteen in Andrews Ganj in south Delhi. "The food at the Gurudwara is better. Sometimes, on Sundays, you get *paneer* also there," he says, a view that is shared by

some others too.

As the afternoon wears on, food delivery agents and auto drivers join for the lunch. "The food is not bad. According to the rides I get, I eat at one of these canteens twice a day. I'm saving about ₹3,000 per month," says Harish Babu, 28, an autorickshaw driver. Many others also pitch in to say that this saves them money because food elsewhere costs between ₹60 and ₹70.

Mukesh Kumar Aggarwal, adviser, Micro Education and Social Welfare Society, a non-profit

organisation that runs 10 Atal Canteens, says, "For a canteen like the one in Anand Vihar we make around 125 kg of *dal* plus *sabzi*, 100 kg of rice and 2,000 *rotis*." "After paying the workers, we make maybe 50 paise per plate or sometimes just break even, but we are a non-profit and our aim is to feed the hungry and provide employment," he adds.

However, staff at the canteens complain they are not even paid the minimum wage. A woman in her 40s serving food at one of the canteens says she gets only ₹8,500 per month. "We come here at 10 in the morning and leave only after 9 at night and get only two days off a month. The money we get is very low and there is no time to work anywhere else," she says.

Reetika Khara, professor at IIT Delhi, says there are about a dozen major States in India that run subsidised canteens. In her recent book, *Freebies or Rights*, she talks about the importance of public canteens in ensuring food security, based on her team's 2023 study of 174 such canteens across three States. She says that in terms of scale, Rajasthan was the best example at the time of the study. In terms of quality, the best was Kerala. But the meals start at ₹30 there. There is also the option of ordering a non-vegetarian dish by paying extra.

Though only 17 kilo-

metres from Nehru Nagar, the Atal Canteen near the University of Delhi's north campus stands in stark contrast, with students at almost all six tables. It is cleaner and everyone is given spoons. The canteen, inaugurated by the Chief Minister on August 16, abuts Chhatra Marg (Students' Road), which leads to many well-known colleges.

A group of three students, who have completed their master's degrees in political science, are busy eating and chatting. "For ₹5, this is good. What will you get for ₹5 these days?" says Sunil, 25.

Sitting at the other end of the table, Rahul Thakur, 25, lifts his head and joins the conversation. "*Mirch masala kam hai* (there is less masala), but I can save about ₹4,000 a month by eating here," says Thakur, who is doing his PhD in history.

Past experiments

In 2010, the then Congress government in Delhi launched the Jan Aahar scheme, under which vans started providing lunch and dinner at ₹15 each.

After the AAP government came to power, they started 'Aam aadmi canteen' at the government-run LNJP Hospital in 2017 to provide meals at ₹10, but the scheme was not scaled up. Professor Khara says when a new party comes to power in a State, they try to undermine the public canteens started by the

previous government and people end up suffering due to it. "There should be some legal protection for public canteens, so that they can continue to function despite the change in governments," she says.

Where commuters eat

The Atal Canteens are a hit at many locations, one of them being Anand Vihar on the Delhi-Uttar Pradesh border, a stone's throw away from the interstate bus terminal and railway station.

Twenty-three-year-old Tejender Saini and his wife eat quickly.

"We work at a tile factory in Punjab and are here to meet our relatives for Raksha Bandhan," he says. "At the bus stand someone told us that we would get '*bhar pet khana*' (food to fill one's stomach) for just ₹5 and we thought we would check it out," he says, adding that he liked the food.

But for some, the canteen itself is the destination. Rita Devi, 34, a widow, travelled with her eight-year-old daughter for about half an hour to reach the canteen.

"I lost my job as a security guard at a mall about two months back as I fell ill. I have been looking for a job for the past two weeks, but I can't find anything," Devi says, as she wipes her tears. "I'm thinking of coming here every day till I find a job."

nikhil.m
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T.N. bypolls: Left parties to contest as separate front

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI/TIRUCHI

The Communist Party of India (CPI) and the Communist Party of India (Marxist) [CPI(M)] have decided to contest the October 6 byelections in Tamil Nadu without aligning with any formation. The CPI will contest from Dharapuram while the CPI(M) will contest from Madurantakam, CPI State secretary M. Veerapandian said on Sunday.

With the Left parties' decision to contest as a separate front, there will be a multi-cornered contest in these two Assembly constituencies. The alliances led by the TVK, the DMK and the AIADMK have already announced their candidates. Seemanth Naam Tamilar Katchi (NTK) will go it alone.

Candidates to be named

Speaking to reporters at Balan Illam, the CPI State headquarters in Chennai, Mr. Veerapandian said the candidates would be announced on September 15. "The CPI had already decided not to be part of any alliance. At the executive committee meeting held on Saturday and Sunday,



M. Veerapandian

there was also a strong view that the same stand should continue," he said.

"Respecting the people's verdict, the Left parties extended outside support to the TVK to form a government, to avoid Governor's Rule, which would have been indirect rule by the BJP," he said.

According to him, the byelections were imposed on people. "It has been decided that the Left parties will face these byelections from the position we have already taken: not to be part of any alliance. We appeal to democratic forces to extend their support to the Left parties," he said.

CPI(M) State secretary P. Shanmugam said though the two Left parties had decided to contest the bypolls separately, the CPI(M) would continue to extend outside support to the TVK-led government.

Focus on corrective steps as CPI(M) State committee meeting begins in Keralam

The Hindu Bureau
KOZHIKODE

Corrective steps to overcome organisational weaknesses are on top of the agenda as the extended three-day State committee meeting of the Communist Party of India (Marxist) is progressing in Keralam.

Select participants from across districts, and representatives of the party's organisations, will get a chance to air their views in an open debate on a draft report prepared by the State committee on the problems plaguing the CPI(M) following its rout in the Assembly election in Keralam.

Opening the conference on Sunday morning, party general secretary M.A. Babby claimed that a situation



Addressing gaps: CPI(M) leaders raising slogans ahead of the State committee meeting in Kozhikode, Kerala, on Sunday. K. RAGESH

akin to that of 1960, when the undivided Communist Party of India improved its vote percentage in elections but lost power in the State, had happened in 2026 too. "The creation of false perceptions against the CPI(M) began after the party-led front came back

to power in 2021. One among them is that we have reached a deal with the RSS and the BJP. We need to examine where we made mistakes in countering such campaigns," he said.

He added that the party cadre should engage in criticism of others and of

themselves.

"Many of our prominent leaders, including some who are at the helm, have gone through the party's rectification exercise. We have a time-tested method for corrective steps," the CPI(M) leader said.

'Attacking the party'

Addressing the media earlier, State secretary M.V. Govindan said the central and State committees had brought out review reports on the party's weaknesses.

"Our efforts will be to correct lapses and suggest improvement measures."

He also said that the attempt by the ED to implicate Leader of the Opposition Pinarayi Vijayan in corruption cases was a way of attacking the party.

BJP-led Centre, Bihar govt. not serious about floods: RJD

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) national working president and Leader of the Opposition in Bihar Tejashwi Yadav on Sunday criticised the BJP-led governments in the State and at the Centre over their "tepid" response to floods in the State.

Mr. Yadav said he had written to Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary demanding that the floods be declared a national disaster and seeking compensation and a special economic package for affected families.

"Those in power are simply not serious about this issue," he said.

Jarange-Patil alleges plot to shoot him; police deny nod for protest in Mumbai

Yohaan Varghese
MUMBAI

The Mumbai police on Sunday denied Maratha reservation activist Manoj Jarange-Patil permission to hold an indefinite hunger strike at Azad Maidan from

September 19, even as he alleged that there was a conspiracy to shoot him during his planned march.

"They do not want to kill Marathas, but want to target me," he claimed while addressing newsmen at Antarwali Sarati village.

There is so far no independently verified evidence to substantiate the claim. Mr. Jarange-Patil is planning to continue his ongoing fast till Tuesday, when he and his supporters are set to begin their march to Mumbai.



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

"LOOK OUT NOTICE"

As intimated by SDPO Bari-Brahmana vide letter No. SDPO/BB/26/7987 dated 09.09.2026, that one person namely Sibe D/o Ram Singh R/o Bihar A/P Bari Brahmanahas been missing from Bari-Brahmana and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No.14 dated 15.02.2025 of P/S Bari-Brahmana. Her search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba :- 01923-246333, 9541649001

2. SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in

3. SHO PS Bari-Brahmana :- 8713023636

The description roll along with photograph of missing person is as under:-

Description Roll:-	
Name	: Sibe
D/O	: Ram Singh
Permanent Address	: Bihar A/P Bari Brahmana
Age	: 18 Years
Height	: 5 FEET 04 INCH
Complexion	: Wheatish
Face	: ROUND
Body Structure	: Medium
Languages known	: HINDI
Attire	: SalwarKameez



Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police,
Samba

DIP/J-10255/26, Sep 12 2026

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customercare@thehindu.co.in



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QR code to
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TRANSMISSION CORPORATION OF TELANGANA LIMITED

TENDER NOTICE

The TGTTRANSCO invites bids online for the following works:

1. Spec. No. e-TGTL-13/2026-27, Name of work: Supply of Material/Equipment including Transportation & Insurance, Delivery, Erection, Testing & Commissioning and Civil & Construction works of (i) Erection of 132KV Sub-station at Buggamadharam (V), Chintalapalem (M), (ii) Erection of 132KV DC line to proposed 132/11kV SS at Buggamadharam from existing 220/132KV Sithapuram SS (3.60 KM) and (iii) Erection of 2 Nos. 132KV feeder bays at existing 220/132KV Sithapuram SS on Turnkey basis in Suryapet District under Rajiv Gandhi Lift Irrigation Scheme.

2. Spec. No. e-TGTL-14/2026-27, Name of work: Supply of Material/Equipment including Transportation & Insurance, Delivery, Erection, Testing & Commissioning and Civil & Construction works of (i) Erection of 132/11kV Sub-station at Vellatur (V), Chintalapalem (M) (ii) Erection of 132KV DC line to the proposed 132/11kV Vellatur SS from existing 220/132 KV Sithapuram SS (20 KM), (iii) Erection of 2 Nos. 132KV feeder bays at existing 220/132KV Sithapuram SS in Suryapet district under Mukthiyala Branch Canal Lift Irrigation Scheme on web site: **11.09.2026**. Note: Further details can be seen in website:tender.telangana.gov.in FAX NO. 040-23323565, Phone No.040-23396000 Extn.3552/3424/3672/3349/3502/3305.

Sd/-
CHIEF ENGINEER/LIS

DIPR R.O.No.526-PP/CL-AGENCY/ADVT/2026-27 Dt:13.09.2026



THE POWER BEHIND PROGRESS

Excerpts of Chairman's Message at the 40th Annual General Meeting held on 31st August, 2026

Parminder Chopra, CMD

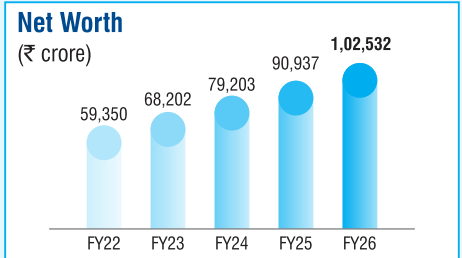


Dear Shareholders,

It gives me immense pleasure to welcome you to the 40th Annual General Meeting of Power Finance Corporation Limited.

As PFC completes four decades of nation building, we do so at a time when India itself is entering a new era of economic growth and infrastructure development.

Net Worth (₹ crore)



FY	Net Worth (₹ crore)
FY22	59,350
FY23	68,202
FY24	79,203
FY25	90,937
FY26	1,02,532

↑ **13%**
Y-o-Y Growth

↑ **11.6%**
5-year CAGR Growth

The nation today stands at the cusp of a historic transformation—one where energy security, economic competitiveness and sustainable development are becoming increasingly interconnected.

India's aspiration of becoming a **Viksit Bharat by 2047** will not only be shaped by the pace of economic growth, but by our ability to build resilient infrastructure and ensure affordable, reliable and 24x7 power for every sector of the economy.

Building the Power Sector of Tomorrow

Over the past decade, India's electricity sector has demonstrated a remarkable progress. Installed generation capacity has more than doubled to over 520 GW, while peak electricity demand has crossed 250 GW, making India one of the world's fastest-growing electricity markets.

Unlike earlier decades, this growth is no longer driven solely by population expansion. It is being propelled by rapid industrialisation, increasing adoption of air conditioning, electric mobility, urbanisation, artificial intelligence, green hydrogen production and the emergence of large-scale data centres.

Four Decades of Nation Building

For forty years, Power Finance Corporation has fulfilled precisely this role.

Established to strengthen India's power sector, PFC has evolved alongside the nation's changing priorities. From financing conventional power generation and transmission projects in its early years to supporting renewable energy, transmission corridors, energy storage, distribution reforms and emerging clean-energy technologies today, PFC has consistently adapted to the evolving needs of the sector while remaining true to its core purpose—to provide long-term financial support for projects that are critical to India's development.

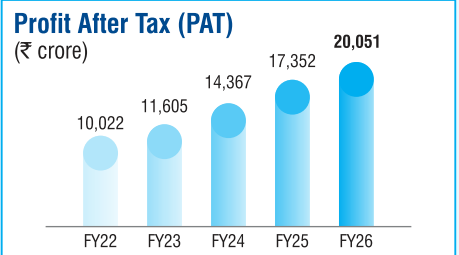
As the nodal agency for the Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme (RDSS), PFC has played a critical role in strengthening the India's distribution sector by enabling investments in smart metering, infrastructure modernisation and operational efficiency. A strong and financially sustainable distribution sector remains the cornerstone of a resilient power system and will be critical to sustaining India's long-term energy security and economic growth.

With four decades of experience, PFC remains uniquely positioned to mobilise long-term capital, develop innovative financing solutions and partner with stakeholders in building India's future power ecosystem.

Delivering Performance with Purpose

Our performance during FY 2025–26 reflects not only strong financial outcomes but also our continued ability to anticipate the evolving needs of the sector and respond with discipline, agility and purpose.

Profit After Tax (PAT) (₹ crore)



FY	PAT (₹ crore)
FY22	10,022
FY23	11,605
FY24	14,367
FY25	17,352
FY26	20,051

↑ **16%**
Y-o-Y Growth

↑ **14.9%**
5-year CAGR Growth

During FY 26, PFC continued to be India's highest profit-making NBFC, while the PFC Group reaffirmed its leadership as India's largest NBFC Group with a consolidated balance sheet of around **₹12 lakh crore**.

Smt. Parminder Chopra, CMD, PFC, along with Mr. Nick McCaffrey, Australia's Deputy High Commissioner to India and Shri K. Balasubramanian, MD, India CEO, Citi exchanging Loan Agreement. Export Finance Australia (EFA), the Australian Government's export credit agency is extending a guarantee to support PFC in raising USD 180 million from Citi.

On a consolidated basis, Profit After Tax increased to **₹33,625 crore**, while standalone Profit After Tax crossed **₹20,000 crore** for the first time, reaching **₹20,051 crore**. Standalone net worth surpassed the landmark **₹1 lakh crore**, significantly enhancing our capacity to finance India's growing infrastructure requirements.

Also, during FY 2025–26, we recorded annual disbursements of approximately **₹1.65 lakh crore**, while our loan assets expanded to **₹5.80 lakh crore, with ₹90,135 crore**, of renewable book. Even as we grew, we maintained a healthy Capital Adequacy Ratio of **23.44%**, ensuring that our growth continues to be supported by a strong capital base.

The Board has recommended a dividend of **₹18.55 per share**, the highest in the Company's history, reflecting our



1.09%
Gross NPA Ratio



₹5,80,115 crore
Loan Assets



0.15%
Net NPA Ratio



86%
Provisioning maintained on NPA assets
(Stage-II)



₹1,65,414 crore
Disbursements



₹6,323 crore
Assets under advanced stages of resolution
(Stage-III Total)

commitment to delivering sustainable value to our shareholders while preserving financial strength for future growth.

Recognising the increasing importance of sustainable finance, we have continued to strengthen our Environmental, Social and Governance (ESG) framework and integrate sustainability considerations into our financing strategy. Our objective is not merely to finance growth, but to finance growth responsibly, balancing commercial excellence with environmental stewardship and long-term societal impact.

During the year, we also expanded our engagement with leading international development finance institutions, including **Japan Bank for International Cooperation (JBIC)** and **Export Finance Australia (EFA)**, broadening access to diversified sources of long-term capital and reinforcing PFC's standing in global financial market.

These achievements are not merely financial outcomes. They reflect disciplined lending, prudent capital allocation, robust governance and the continued confidence reposed in PFC by borrowers, investors, lenders and other stakeholders.

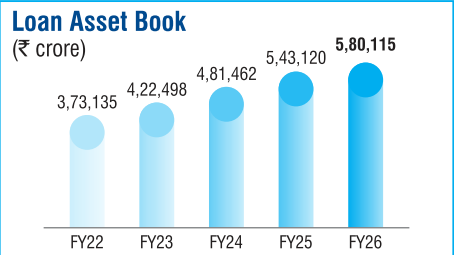
Building the Institution for India's Next Decade

FY 2025–26 also marked one of the most significant strategic developments in PFC's history.

The proposed merger of REC Limited with PFC represents much more than the coming together of two successful institutions. It is a strategic step towards strengthening India's development finance landscape.

Upon completion, the merged entity will create one of India's largest specialised infrastructure financing institutions, with an aggregate loan book of around **₹12 lakh crore**.

Loan Asset Book (₹ crore)



FY	Loan Asset Book (₹ crore)
FY22	3,73,135
FY23	4,22,498
FY24	4,81,462
FY25	5,43,120
FY26	5,80,115

↑ **6.8%**
Y-o-Y Growth

↑ **9.2%**
5-year CAGR Growth

The combined scale will strengthen our ability to mobilise larger pools of domestic and international capital, diversify funding sources and finance increasingly complex infrastructure projects across the evolving value chain.

POWER FINANCE CORPORATION LTD.

(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
Regd. Office : "Urjanidhi", 1, Barakhamba Lane, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110 001, Ph.: 011-23456000, Fax : 011-23412545
www.pfcindia.co.in, CIN: L65910DL1986G01024862

Connect with us on:    **@pfcindia**

For borrowers, this will mean stronger and innovative financing capabilities. For investors, it offers enhanced operational efficiencies and long-term value creation. For the nation, it strengthens an institution capable of supporting one of the world's most ambitious energy transition and infrastructure investment programmes.

This is not simply an organisational milestone; it is an opportunity to build an institution that is better equipped to support India's next phase of economic growth.

Smt. Parminder Chopra, CMD (in centre) along with (Standing from L to R) Shri V. Packirisamy, Director (Commercial), Shri Rajesh Kumar Agarwal, Director (Finance), Shri Shashank Misra, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Power and Dr. Sudhir Mehta, Independent Director at the "Investors Meet 2026" held in Mumbai.

Looking Ahead

As we enter our **Fifth Decade**, we do so with a clear conviction: our role is no longer limited to financing power projects. Our responsibility is to help finance India's energy future.

Our priorities remain clear—to strengthen our leadership in power and infrastructure financing, accelerate sustainable and green finance, deepen access to global capital, preserve best-in-class asset quality and continue delivering consistent long-term value to all our stakeholders.

With a strong foundation and deep sectoral expertise, we are confident that PFC will continue to remain India's most trusted finance institution and a key partner in financing the India's journey towards Viksit Bharat 2047.

Acknowledgements

Before I conclude, I extend my sincere gratitude to the Government of India, the Ministry of Power, our regulators, auditors, lenders, investors, customers for their continued trust and partnership. I express my heartfelt gratitude to you, our shareholders, for your continued confidence in PFC.

Together, we will continue financing progress, powering possibilities and shaping the energy future of our nation.

Thank you.



(Parminder Chopra)
Chairman & Managing Director

Place : New Delhi
Date : 31.08.2026

(This does not purport to be a record of the proceedings of the Annual General Meeting held on 31st August, 2026. For full text, please visit : www.pfcindia.co.in)

CM YK A ND-NDE



Building consensus

The 18th BRICS Summit pushed for changes in traditional power equations

Reaffirming the importance of reformed multilateralism in a world riven with unilateral actions by superpowers emerged as a binding theme of the 18th BRICS Summit and the New Delhi Declaration. The Summit's success could be measured by three main parameters – the participation of members at the highest levels, the importance given to intra-BRICS trade cooperation mechanisms and the consensus achieved by Indian negotiators in forging a joint statement in a time of war. The government should be commended for ensuring that Iran and the UAE, two rivals in the West Asian conflict, used the occasion for their highest-level bilateral meeting since the war began. The New Delhi Declaration, which was issued despite scepticism about all the differences within the grouping, presented the BRICS as a formidable front in its 20th year. Among the BRICS members, the position of Saudi Arabia, which has yet to formally join the group, remains ambiguous, as Foreign Minister Faisal bin Farhan Al Saud arrived after the main session where the joint statement was adopted on Saturday. For the other members, however, the consensus was clear on issues of global importance. The declaration made a call for the reform of the Security Council and support for a greater role for Brazil and India while recommending new initiatives for global governance. It condemned western sanctions and tariffs and resolved to improve intra-BRICS trade and transact more in local currencies. It also condemned unilateral wars, without criticising any member. While the statement omitted references to the U.S.-Israel attacks on Iran, the assassination of Iran's Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei, and of Iran's retaliatory attacks on its neighbours, especially the UAE, it is understood that this was due to a last-moment compromise effected between the two countries so as to forge the agreed text. It also took an exceptionally strong position on Israel's actions in Palestine and Lebanon.

India's fourth BRICS chairship has given ballast to its reputation as a Global South balancer with easy access to both sides of a divided world, while delivering bilateral benefits. Prime Minister Narendra Modi's close attention to Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian would have gone some way in assuaging hurt feelings, when New Delhi appeared to be tilting towards the U.S. and Israel in the war. Mr. Modi's meeting with Chinese President Xi Jinping also afforded the two countries a chance to reaffirm their political will to normalise ties. And his meeting with important leaders from the ASEAN grouping and African nations paid much-needed attention to India's ties with them. This BRICS Summit will be remembered for a moment of solidarity among countries that have many differences but are together in desiring a shift in traditional power equations to one more driven by their emerging economies.

A rising graph

Doping is now a deep-rooted culture in Indian sports

At least 13 doping positives in the run-up to the recent Commonwealth Games and the upcoming Asian Games have again put India in an embarrassing spotlight. For a country that has been notoriously leading the global doping charts for three consecutive years, the spate of positive results across disciplines including athletics, weightlifting, wrestling, wushu and judo, has not only brought shame but has also robbed India of some berths in these prestigious events. The dope-tainted names have forced authorities to pull them out of the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games squad. More such names are expected to trickle out in the coming weeks. Lucrative cash incentives for Asian Games medalists are a major factor driving athletes and coaches to take shortcuts, risking their health and reputation, as well as the country's pride. While the spike in dope-positive results ahead of major multi-sport events is not new, the jump this time is a cause for concern. The matter getting raised during the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA) workshops in Delhi, the Athletics Integrity Unit (AIU) downgrading India due to an extremely high risk of doping, and an international agency recently conducting surprise tests in Bhubaneswar and Bengaluru indicate the seriousness of the issue.

Even though National Sports Federations have been expressing concern, it cannot be said that they are strict to the core to curb the menace. Despite being seriously understaffed, the National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA), which shoulders the primary anti-doping responsibility in India, has significantly increased the number of tests and raids based on intelligence gathering. But it needs to do more in a vast and populous country to discourage doping. Besides, NADA needs to get out of the government's control to function truly independently in order to enhance its effectiveness. Proper implementation of the National Anti-Doping (Amendment) Act, 2025, to give more powers to NADA and its allied bodies, is another requirement. With dope testing becoming costlier and NADA needing more staff, the government can bolster the fight against doping by increasing the overall budget allocation, which was reduced in the current budget. The other challenge is to cut the supply line, as India has become a hub for the trade in banned substances sourced from different countries. An Indian serving a jail term in Kenya for illegally importing performance-enhancing drugs stands as proof of this. As India prepares for the 2030 Commonwealth Games and hopes to host the Olympics in the future, it needs to act resolutely to weed out a deep-rooted doping culture in Indian sports.

The terror attack carried out by al-Qaeda on the Twin Towers in New York on September 11, 2001 was neither the first major terrorist attack in the world nor the first against the United States. But it fundamentally changed how terrorism would be fought in the decades that followed.

Over the past 25 years, the global security landscape, including that of India, has changed irreversibly. The forms of terrorism have evolved, the instruments used to perpetrate terror have changed, and so too have the strategies adopted by countries around the world to counter terrorism.

We no longer hear of large terror groups operating under ruthless terrorist leaders such as al-Qaeda founder Osama bin Laden or Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi, who led the Islamic State and called for the establishment of an Islamic Caliphate. Instead, terror groups have morphed into smaller, more autonomous entities. Lone-wolf attacks are becoming the norm, while technologies such as drones, cyber capabilities, and even artificial intelligence are being used not only by terror groups but also by nations combating terrorism.

From an Indian standpoint, 9/11 certainly helped bring greater attention to India's concerns over cross-border terrorism, particularly in Kashmir. However, it was not until the 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks (November 2008) that the world truly stood in solidarity with India and acknowledged its fight against cross-border terrorism. Over the years, India's strategy towards terrorism has evolved – from a passive strategy of merely warning Pakistan but not punishing it, to a bold and active strategy that classifies any act of terrorism backed by support from across the border as an 'act of war'.

The starting years saw a passive response

Although cross-border terror commenced in Kashmir in early 1990s, the first major terror attack did not come from the Kashmir Valley. The assassination of former Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi by the Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam terror group of Sri Lanka on May 21, 1991 in Sriperumbudur, Tamil Nadu shook the nation.

With no clearly defined counter-terror strategy and a rapidly expanding terror network in Kashmir, India found itself stretched. The March 1993 Mumbai serial blasts, which killed over 250 people in 13 coordinated blasts across the city, and the synchronised blasts across Coimbatore city (Tamil Nadu) in February 1998 exposed the inadequacies of India's internal security mechanisms to detect and fight terror inside the country.

However, the direct role of Pakistan was first exposed with the hijack of Indian Airlines flight IC-814, on December 24, 1999. Under tremendous public pressure and with very few options, India agreed to release dreaded Pakistan-based terrorists such as Ahmed Omar Sheikh and



Rajeew Agarwal

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India has moved from defensive restraint to proactive counter-terrorism

Masood Azhar in exchange for more than 160 civilian hostages. The attack on India's Parliament in New Delhi by the Pakistan-based Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM) terrorist group on December 13, 2001 outraged India and led to a large-scale military mobilisation under 'Operation Parakram'. With India and Pakistan having acquired nuclear weapons, the threat of escalation grew, prompting the international community to rush in to cool tempers. After almost two years of a tense standoff, the military disengagement took place without any direct punishment on Pakistan. The 26/11 Mumbai terror attacks – widely considered India's 9/11 moment – also did not lead to any military action against Pakistan.

There were other terror attacks too, such as the 2002 Akshardham Temple attack, the 2006 Varanasi serial bomb blasts, and the 2010 German Bakery blast in Pune. Delhi, too, was not left untouched by terror. Even before the Parliament attack, an Army garrison within the Red Fort was targeted on December 22, 2000 by Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT) terrorists, resulting in the deaths of three soldiers. In October 2005, over 60 people were killed in serial blasts that rocked popular Delhi markets, including Sarojini Nagar and Paharganj. Again, in September 2008, months before the 26/11 Mumbai attacks, multiple blasts rocked commercial areas of Delhi, including Connaught Place, Greater Kailash, and Karol Bagh. On September 7, 2011, a briefcase bomb exploded outside the Delhi High Court, killing 15 people. The attack was claimed by Harkat-ul-Jihad Islami (HUJI), a terror group affiliated with al-Qaeda and largely based in Pakistan. In all these cases, and many others, India chose not to respond directly and decisively, even after conclusive proof of Pakistan's direct support for these attacks. How and when, then, did India change its strategy?

Taking the fight across the border

It was after a change of government at the Centre in May 2014, and its resolve not to let terror go unpunished, that India changed its strategy towards cross-border terrorism. The terror attack on September 18, 2016 by Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM) terrorists on an Army camp in Uri, Kashmir, led to the first cross-border surgical strikes (September 28-29). The strikes not only sent a strong message but also served as a clear statement of intent. Soon thereafter, following the terror attack on a Central Reserve Police Force convoy in Pulwama, Kashmir, on February 14, 2019, the Indian Air Force (IAF) launched strikes on a JeM terror camp in Balakot. This marked the first time that the IAF had crossed into Pakistani airspace to carry out a strike against a terror target.

However, it was the terror attack in Pahalgam on April 22, 2025 that outraged the nation like never before. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who was on a visit to Saudi Arabia, returned to India and soon after, the Indian armed forces

Pakistan's westward turn — strategic depth or overstretch

The defence cooperation agreement signed by Pakistan and Kuwait on August 27, 2026, is the latest manifestation of Pakistan's rapidly expanding strategic footprint in West Asia. The agreement assumes greater significance when viewed alongside Pakistan's membership of the Saudi Arabia-Türkiye-Pakistan defence arrangement and its recent role as an intermediary between Iran and the United States.

Enduring links

Pakistan's West Asian orientation has deep historical roots. From its inception, it attempted to combine its South Asian geopolitical identity with that of a major Muslim power. During the Cold War, Pakistan, Iran and Türkiye were linked through the Central Treaty Organization (CENTO) and subsequently through the Regional Cooperation for Development.

The decisive turn towards the Arab world came after Pakistan's defeat and dismemberment in 1971. It sought to compensate for its diminished position in South Asia by emphasising its Islamic identity, symbolised by the Islamic summit held in Lahore in 1974. Pakistan simultaneously developed extensive military relationships with Saudi Arabia and the Gulf monarchies.

What is new, therefore, is not Pakistan's involvement in West Asia but its increasing institutionalisation. The Makkah Agreement of August 7 stipulated that an armed attack against one member would be regarded as an attack against all. The three countries moved quickly to give the arrangement institutional substance. At the August 31 meeting in Istanbul, their Foreign and Defence Ministers and military chiefs decided to establish a permanent secretariat in Saudi Arabia, with a Pakistani serving as its first Secretary-General for three years. They also agreed to strengthen military interoperability and pursue defence-industrial cooperation, including



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Pakistan's expanding West Asian role brings influence and opportunity, but also strategic risks

joint technology development and production.

But the new arrangement is already confronting Pakistan with the contradictions inherent in its expanding West Asian role. Renewed Houthi missile and drone attacks against Saudi Arabia created the first serious test of the Makkah pact. The Houthis' recent capture of Mocha port and Perim island have further added to their capability to choke off Saudi shipping through the Bab al-Mandab. With the Strait of Hormuz effectively closed by Iran, a frustrated Saudi Arabia may re-launch a full-fledged war against the Houthis. This could create a major dilemma for Pakistan especially if Riyadh decides to invoke the collective-defence provision of the Makkah agreement.

Pakistan wants to be Saudi Arabia's security partner, Türkiye's strategic ally, Iran's friend and interlocutor, Washington's useful intermediary, and an increasingly important security provider to the Gulf monarchies. These roles are compatible when regional tensions are manageable. They become irreconcilable when they are not.

What it means for India

For India, Pakistan's westward turn presents both a challenge and a potential relief. A Pakistan embedded in a network of West Asian security relationships may acquire defence in depth. Saudi financial resources, Turkish defence technology and Pakistan's expanding relationships with Gulf militaries can theoretically increase Islamabad's resilience in a confrontation with India. Türkiye is already Pakistan's most vocal major supporter on Kashmir. Pakistan's nuclear status also enhances its strategic value to Arab states concerned about an increasingly unstable regional order because of nuclear-armed Israel's aggressive policies.

But strategic depth can easily become strategic overstretch. Pakistan's security establishment has

launched Operation Sindoor on May 6-7, hitting the heart of the Pakistan-based terror network. In a matter of 96 hours, the leaders and headquarters of the terror networks (LeT and JeM) were destroyed and Pakistani military assets were pulverised.

Where India stands on terror now

India has come a long way since the menace of cross-border terrorism took root in Kashmir in the early 1990s. From a passive and reactive policy, India has emerged as a leading voice in the global fight against terrorism. Soon after Operation Sindoor, India declared three clear intentions – first, that the era of restraint and patience is over, and Pakistan will have to pay a direct and heavy price for any terror attack in the future. Second, that any future act of cross-border terrorism emanating from Pakistan will be treated as an 'act of war'. Third, that Pakistani nuclear blackmail will no longer be a restraining factor.

India also unveiled 'PRAHAAR', its first comprehensive National Counter-Terrorism Policy and Strategy, on February 23, 2026. The policy provides a national counter-terrorism framework for preventing and responding to terrorist activities and radicalisation through coordinated "whole-of-government" and "whole-of-society" approaches.

Although the number of terror-related incidents in Kashmir has declined drastically, the possibility of a few terrorists infiltrating across the Line of Control (LoC) and evading intelligence and security agencies remains. The answer lies in a four-fold strategy. First, continue to hunt down and eliminate the remnants of the terror network in the country, particularly in Kashmir. Second, take pre-emptive military action against any potential terror threat building across the LoC, including at terrorist launch pads. With years of experience and a deeply embedded intelligence network, this is possible. Third, undertake an exhaustive de-radicalisation programme across the country that not only motivates young people to join the mainstream but also makes the prospect of joining or supporting a terror outfit unattractive and prohibitively costly. Fourth, take all necessary steps to cut off terror financing, in close coordination with friendly countries.

Twenty-five years after 9/11, the threat of terrorism across the globe has not been eliminated but has instead morphed into new forms. At the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation Summit in Bishkek on September 1, Mr. Modi called out the double standards on terrorism and said, "We must send a strong message to countries that use terrorism as an instrument of policy and provide safe haven and support to terrorists that terrorism can never be a strategic asset for anyone." At the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi, an exclusive paragraph on the Pahalgam terror attack was included in the Delhi Declaration, clearly underscoring the growing global consensus on combating terrorism.

historically concentrated overwhelmingly on India. A Pakistan increasingly required to devote diplomatic, military and intelligence resources to Iran, Saudi Arabia, the Gulf, Yemen and the Red Sea may have fewer resources to concentrate on India.

The current Saudi-Houthi confrontation and the distinct possibility of it spawning a war clearly demonstrate the danger of Pakistan's strategic overstretch. The deeper Pakistan becomes embedded in West Asian security arrangements, the harder it will become to remain aloof from the region's conflicts. If the Houthi-Saudi confrontation escalates, Islamabad may eventually have to choose between honouring the credibility of its collective-defence commitments and maintaining its carefully cultivated relationship with Tehran, the Houthis' principal ally.

India should therefore resist interpreting Pakistan's growing West Asian role in purely negative terms. Saudi Arabia, the United Arab Emirates and the other Gulf states have major economic and strategic relationships with India that they are unlikely to sacrifice for Pakistan. New Delhi should continue deepening these relationships as a counter to Pakistan's expanding footprint in West Asia.

The consolidation of Pakistan's West Asian relationships undoubtedly provides it with greater strategic depth *vis-à-vis* India. But those very relationships expose it to some of the world's most combustible rivalries. For India, therefore, Pakistan's westward turn contains a paradox. A Pakistan more deeply embedded in a West Asian security structure may in theory look strategically stronger. But a Pakistan entangled in mutually contradictory West Asian commitments will soon discover that it could be indefinitely stuck in a quagmire of its own choosing. It is far more difficult to get off the tiger than to get on it.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

India's BRICS moment

The high-profile 18th BRICS Summit could not have come at a more opportune time, with the United States flexing its muscles, adopting a belligerent, obstinate and defiant stand across a raft of issues, and treating a galaxy of countries across the world with disdain and contempt (Front page,

September 13). The successful summit is, undeniably, a testament to India's steadfast commitment and desire to usher in an era of durable peace, stability and security in the world. One positive aspect was the interaction between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping, which,

it is hoped, will pave the way for a ratcheting up of relations between the two countries, which are currently far from rosy. Whether the outcome of the Summit will lead to an enhanced level of cooperation and coordination among the participating nations across a plethora of spheres, and

whether it will have an impact on Washington's style of functioning, only the days ahead will reveal.
V. Johan Dhanakumar,
Chennai

Statesmanship vs theatre

The dignified response by DMK president M.K. Stalin to Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay's recent

visual gesture in the Assembly serves as a profound lesson in political maturity. Mr. Stalin's injury should not have been a punchline or a subject for mimicry; it was a physical scar from 1976. By choosing to offer statesmanship and constructive advice, Mr. Stalin held up a mirror to the current administration.

True leadership is earned through decades of public struggle and administrative execution, not through social media reels or theatrical swipes meant to mask governance deficits.
R. Sivakumar,
Chennai

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

Revisiting Kuwait’s invasion amid war

As the world witnesses yet another war in West Asia, the passage of August revives the haunting memory of Iraqi troops invading Kuwait on August 2, 1990. As Kuwait remembers that sordid day, another story, which has largely been forgotten, also needs to be remembered – the story of the migrant workers. For them, the war was not an abstract international crisis; it meant unemployment and the loss of everything they had built abroad.

The labourers and domestic workers were the most hit, being abandoned when employers fled. Many returned empty-handed, leaving behind wages, savings, and possessions. And while some chose to undertake the arduous return journey, others had no choice but to stay back.

There were also cases of employers utilising the war as a pretext to withhold dues. While a UN Compensation Commission was set up to retrieve wages, it was fruitful in compensating only white-collar workers and high-skilled blue-collar workers while labourers, domestic workers and other low-skilled workers lost all their hard-earned wages. This is the same story that unfolded decades later during the COVID-19 crisis which triggered the Justice for Wage Theft Campaign.

However, because of their dire circumstances, when the war ended, migrants went back to the same jobs and in many cases to the same employers, proving that the Gulf Dream was only a mirage for many.

After the invasion, some undertook extraordinary journeys to return home;



Ginu Zacharia Oommen

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The legacy of the invasion extended well beyond 1991, with the war reshaping not only migration strategies but also the social geography of the Malayali diaspora in Kuwait

some of them travelled via roads in cars, crossing many international borders over days, and were able to reach Keralam through informal networks of assistance.

Many others were evacuated via civilian-led airlifts, made possible by the efforts of diaspora leaders.

However, some stayed back in the war rather than returning home to debt, and adapted in remarkable ways. One of our respondents who had then just opened an electrical shop, remained in Kuwait, taking on odd jobs; he sheltered quite a few fellow migrants and was briefly detained by Iraqi soldiers. When the war ended, he reopened his shop under skies darkened by burning oil wells, hoping for a brighter future. A tailor, who was stranded after his employer disappeared without paying his wages, survived through casual labour, and sheltered in basements during the war.

Community as resilience

The invasion also saw stories of resilience and courage. When Kuwait was occupied by Iraq, the Indian embassy could not continue its operations and was formally withdrawn and the staff relocated to Basra. One of the migrants recalls how a voluntary committee of Indian businessmen assumed critical roles, coordinating evacuations, liaising with officials in Basra, and arranging buses, ships, and flights to ensure that migrants were not left to fend for themselves. In an extraordinary move, they were entrusted to issue travel documents using official seals.

Despite logistical hurdles and long desert waits, these leaders were able to

evacuate 1,70,000 Indians – an exceptional instance of diaspora-led crisis management in the absence of state infrastructure and embassy guidance.

Another striking manifestation of the war was the contrasting response of migrants after returning to Keralam. In south Keralam, large public rallies expressed support for the Emir of Kuwait, while in north Keralam, especially Kozhikode, massive demonstrations backed the Iraqi leadership.

The legacy of the invasion extended well beyond 1991, with the war reshaping not only migration strategies but also the social geography of the Malayali diaspora in Kuwait. A lingering sense of insecurity took hold, with workers beginning to save more aggressively; transferring money home quickly; and investing in land and houses back home. The social geography of Kuwait also changed.

Migrants from Keralam who were never ghettoised, started clustering in neighbourhoods such as Abbasiya – “mini-Kerala” – creating tightly knit communities, with community and religious organisations assuming more importance. This offered emotional support and a sense of stability to the migrants. Thus, the war not only reshaped individual lives but the collective outlook of migrant groups across the Gulf.

As war once again unsettles West Asia, these memories acquire renewed relevance. Migrant workers continue to build the economies of the Gulf while remaining among those least protected when conflict erupts.

The evidence gap in dole politics

In May 1795, English magistrates met at the Pelican Inn in Speenhamland, Berkshire. With food prices rising and the French Revolution unsettling the English establishment, they decided to top up agricultural wages from parish funds, linking payouts to bread prices and family size. Hungarian economic historian Karl Polanyi later saw this as an early assertion of a human “right to live” against the harshness of the market.

Critics, however, held a different view. Once wage support, relief for the poor, and public finance were folded into one instrument, it became unclear what the system was protecting: poor families, the wage structure, employers, or social peace. By subsidising wages from public funds, the Speenhamland system blurred price signals and weakened incentives. While relief could be justified, the instrument still had to be judged by its effects. India’s dole politics must now face the same test.

Cash support can indeed be essential in a poor, informal economy. The Economic Survey 2025-26 notes that transfers to women amount to 11-24% of the monthly income of women daily-wage workers, and 11-87% of self-employed women. But a transfer that begins as relief can also become a permanent fiscal commitment unless there is a clear account of who receives it, what it changes, and what it displaces.

These concerns assume importance because dole politics is now a regular feature of Indian statecraft. It appears as free electricity, free bus travel, monthly cash transfers, subsidised



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food, and utility subsidies.

PRS Legislative Research estimates that unconditional cash transfers to women alone rose from two States in 2022-23 to 12 states in 2025-26, with an estimated annual cost of ₹1.68 lakh crore (about 0.5% of GDP). For example, West Bengal has moved from Lakshmir Bhandar to Annapurna Yojana, budgeting ₹36,000 crore for a ₹3,000 monthly transfer to about 1.3 crore women. Tamil Nadu allocated ₹14,412 crore for the Kalaigarn Magalir Urimai Thogai in its 2026-27 interim budget, and Assam set aside ₹5,000 crore for Orunodoi. Such schemes stake major claims on State finances.

Need for accountability

Cash may improve welfare, but it should not become a substitute for the public goods that make welfare durable. The same woman who values ₹1,500-₹3,000 may also need a functioning health centre, childcare, a good government school, or access to better work. A cash transfer may soften the strain created by weak institutions, but it cannot, by itself, address them.

Governments often attach lofty social purposes such as dignity and empowerment to these transfers, but rarely publish the model that links payments to outcomes. Who exactly is being targeted? What baseline data justifies the scheme? What effect is anticipated on consumption, debt, nutrition, schooling, health spending, labour supply, or women’s bargaining power? Without such answers, it is unsurprising that much of India’s dole politics today is defended by the moral language of welfare rather

than evidence. An ADB study, prepared for the 16th Finance Commission, found that India lacks a systematic dataset of government expenditure on cash-transfer schemes.

Other democracies also redistribute and are not immune to welfare politics. However, benefits such as unemployment insurance, food support, and healthcare subsidies are usually tied to eligibility rules, contribution records, job-search obligations, or periodic reassessment. India need not copy these systems mechanically. Some transfers, especially to women in poor households, may be better left unconditional. But the fewer the conditions placed, the greater must be the obligation on governments to provide evidence.

A large recurring transfer should therefore include a welfare impact statement before rollout, detailing the objective, eligibility rule, expected coverage, five-year fiscal cost, alternatives considered, likely leakage and exclusion errors, and measurable outcomes. After rollout, household surveys should record not only whether the transfer was received but also how it affected consumption, debt, health spending, schooling, mobility, work incentives, control over household expenditure, and subjective well-being. Anonymised microdata should then be made available for independent research. Schemes that spend public money on this scale must survive severe scrutiny.

The case for evidence is also one of democratic fairness. Evidence will not remove politics from welfare, but it could make that politics more honest.

SIR: Glaring oddities in Maharashtra’s deletion patterns

A total of 2.07 crore names have been deleted from Maharashtra’s electoral rolls; the figure is higher than Chhattisgarh’s entire electorate

DATA POINT

Pon Vasanth B.A. Nitika Francis

Analyses of constituency-wise deletions and lists of deletions in Maharashtra after the enumeration phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls have revealed several oddities, indicating high chances of aggressive and arbitrary deletions. The draft SIR roll released on August 31, showed that a total of 2.07 crore electors have been dropped from the 288 Assembly Constituencies (ACs) of Maharashtra, which is 21.14% of the 9.79 crore electors whose names were there on the pre-SIR rolls.

To place Maharashtra’s deletions in context, the 2.07 crore names dropped is higher than Chhattisgarh’s entire electorate. More surprisingly, it is higher than even the 2.04 crore deletions in Uttar Pradesh, during the SIR; U.P. is India’s largest State with 13.4 crore electors – which is bigger than the number of electors in the draft rolls of Maharashtra, Karnataka and Delhi combined.

The Election Commission of India (EC) has desisted from releasing the Elector to Population (EP) ratio for any State during the ongoing SIR process despite its own Manual on Electoral Rolls mandating it to do so during and after every revision. An estimate of EP ratio based on the projected population in the 18-plus age-group as per the report of Government of India’s Technical Group on Population Projections showed that Maharashtra’s draft rolls are short of 1.92 crore electors, which is roughly the same as the number of deletions (**Table 1**).

As seen in other States, deletions in Maharashtra were also highly concentrated in urban areas (**MAP 1**). A total of 58 ACs saw at least one-third of names (33%) in the rolls getting deleted, of which 25 ACs saw deletions of 40% or

more. Almost all of these were in and around the Mumbai, Pune, Thane and Nashik districts. Bhivandi East in Thane recorded the highest deletions (49.1%). Of the 3.76 lakh voters, 1.85 lakh names were deleted.

“Permanently Shifted” and “Untraceable or Absent” seem to have been used as blanket categories to delete large number of names from the rolls. **Table 2** shows a sample of a few constituencies that saw deletions due to widely different reasons. Kalyan Rural in Thane saw 2.52 lakh deletions, of which 2.39 lakh (96.5%) were marked as shifted or absent – that is 96-97 in every 100 deleted voters had either shifted or were untraceable, as per the EC. But the constituency saw only 4,882 deletions marked as ‘Deceased’.

In 85 ACs, shifted and absent accounted for anywhere between 75% to 96.5% of all deletions. These 85 had 3.21 crore electors before SIR, of which 1.17 crore (36.3%) were deleted. Of these 1.17 crore deletions, 97.9 lakh (84%) were marked as shifted or absent.

The Hindu had pointed out how the EC’s own manual says that an absentee voter cannot be deleted from the rolls as they continued to be an ordinary resident of the place where they are enrolled. An FAQ published by the Chief Electoral Officer of Maharashtra says ‘Absent’ means “the elector was unavailable”. Analysis indicated that these two reasons were applied arbitrarily and interchangeably in several constituencies.

Table 3 shows the top five districts that saw extreme variations in the per cent of electors deleted for being absent. Pune exemplified this problem, as shown in **Chart 1**. Within the same district and among ACs located nearby, the share of electors marked as shifted or absent widely varied. Maval saw just 322 names (0.4%) marked as Absent while over 77,000 were marked as shifted. Hadapsar, on the other hand, saw 86% of its 2.98 lakh voters marked as absent.

Counting out en masse

The data were sourced from the Election Commission of India. Night-time light intensity from the Socio-economic High-resolution Rural-Urban Geographic Platform for India (SHRUG) database maintained by the Development Data Lab, drawn from satellite readings from the year 2023 was used to classify constituencies as urban or rural.

TABLE 1: An estimate of Elector-to-Population ratio shows that the draft SIR roll is short of roughly the same number of electors deleted during the enumeration phase

Metric	Value
Electors before SIR	9,78,54,049
Deletions	2,06,88,487
Electors in draft SIR rolls	7,71,65,562 (-21.14%)
Projected voter population	9,65,00,000
Shortfall	-19,334,438 (-20%)
ACs with >33% deletions	58
ACs with >40% deletions	25

Deletion of **2.07 crore** names in Maharashtra is higher than deletions in U.P.’s final SIR rolls

About **75%** of all deletions happened in the 147 constituencies that are highly or moderately urban



Double check: Booth Level Officers sort enumeration forms as voter enumeration drive commences in Nagpur. ANI

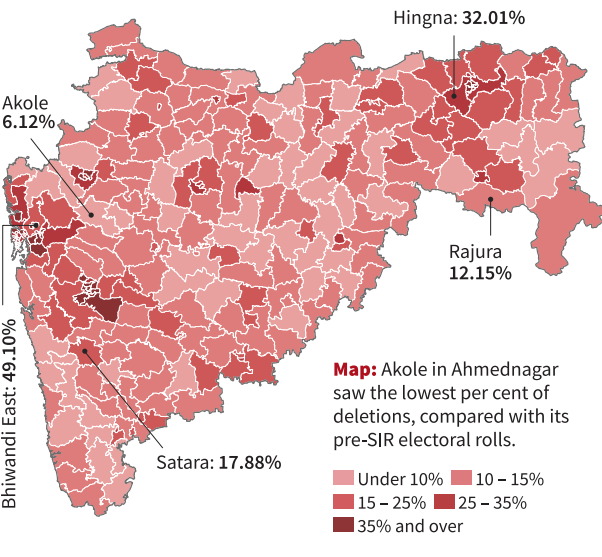


TABLE 3: The top five districts that saw extreme variations in the per cent of electors being deleted for being ‘Absent’

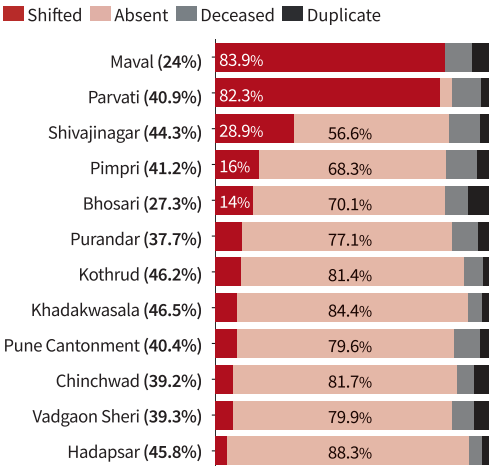
District	No of ACs	How widely did % of deletions marked as ‘Absent’ vary? Min → Max
Palghar	6	3.3 → 85.5%
Pune	21	0.4 → 88.3%
Nashik	15	8.1 → 86.5%
Aurangabad	9	7.3 → 67.3%
Nagpur	12	4.4 → 59.7%

Wide variations were observed in constituencies within districts that are largely of similar urban or rural character. In the 15 constituencies in Nashik, electors deleted for being ‘Absent’ varied from **8.1 to 86.5%**

TABLE 2: A few constituencies that indicate widely different and non-uniform application of reasons for deletions

Assembly (District)	Pre-SIR electors	Deletions (%)	Why is it odd?
Kalyan Rural (Thane)	5.48 lakh	2,52,247 (46%)	Only 1.9% marked as Deceased, the lowest in the State
Shrigonda (Ahmednagar)	3.48 lakh	40,110 (11.5%)	Nearly 45% marked as Deceased, highest in the State
Solapur South (Solapur)	3.98 lakh	64,326 (16.2%)	Nearly 25% were Duplicates
Worli (Mumbai City)	2.68 lakh	1,05,575 (39.4%)	Only 1.3% (3,786) were Duplicates

CHART 1: Variations in the use of ‘Shifted’ vs ‘Absent’ within Pune’s ACs. Values (%) in brackets are deletions in the ACs



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The *Hindu*

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 14, 1976

Himalaya seminar may help quake forecasts

New Delhi, September 13: Mr. Chandrajit Yadav, Union Minister for Steel and Mines while inaugurating the five-day international seminar on Himalayan Geology which commenced here to-day, expressed the hope that the deliberations at the seminar would lead to some ‘dependable clues’ for the prediction of earthquakes for future lines of action.

Stressing the importance of earthquake prediction and the science of seismology for an agricultural country in India where a large number of irrigation projects has to be built to harness its available water resources, the Minister said “recent earthquakes in some parts of Asia are reminder to us that at least in India very little has been done in the way of predicting earthquakes. Some of the countries have made remarkable progress in this direction and can save humanity by sharing their knowledge. The world community of scientists has to work collectively. These calamities do not respect national boundaries.”

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 14, 1926

Encouraging British films in India

London, September 13: In connection with the British film scheme mentioned in the message of the 11th September, it is stated that the six Indian rulers mentioned already have contributed quarter a million sterling in money, land and buildings.

Maharaja of Alwar has offered £100,000 and free sites for cinema in India.

The Maharaja of Patiala has offered £30,000 H.H. the Aga Khan £35,000 to £40,000.

The remaining princes have not yet decided on the cash offers but will supply sites and are in some cases building cinemas.

It is hoped that by the middle of 1927 there will be a chain of 300 cinemas across India showing films from Britain and from Dominions in the proportion of 6 British films for one screened in other parts of the Empire.

Mr. Nirranjan Pal states that the Princes do not expect any reward for their munificence.

The profits will go to a trust or endowment fund for the development of films in India.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Persons missing after ferry capsizes off Java in Indonesia

140 Rescuers in Indonesia said at least 140 passengers and crew were missing on Sunday after a ferry sailing between the islands of Java and Borneo was hit by bad weather and capsized. The Virgo Transport 8, carrying 243 passengers and crew, had lost contact with its shipping company on Sunday after departing from Surabaya in East Java. AFP

Surge in Vinayaka Chathurthi bus travel recorded in T.N.

38 in per cent. State Transport Undertakings in Tamil Nadu recorded a massive 38% surge in bus deployments during the Vinayaka Chathurthi festival weekend, with over 4,600 State-run vehicles pressed into service. However, the State's transport operations were heavily overshadowed by a steep fare hike by private transport operators, drawing severe backlash. PTI

Grievances taken up by Delhi Police during Thana Divas hearings

2,333 The Delhi Police took up 2,333 complaints and grievances during its weekly 'Thana Divas - Jansunwai' public hearing sessions held across stations in all six ranges of the national capital. The hearings were held as part of an initiative aimed at strengthening police-public interaction and improving grievance redressal, officials said. PTI

Number of people evacuated overnight from island of Brač

230 Around 230 people were evacuated overnight Sunday on the Croatian Adriatic island of Brač because of a fire that has ravaged some 3,500 hectares, according to authorities. With the wildfire threatening people's houses after being fanned by strong winds, the authorities sounded the alarm shortly before midnight. AFP

India's steel quota for exports under India-EU trade pact

6.94 in lakh tonnes. India will get country-specific tariff-rate quotas (TRQs) totalling 1.64 million tonnes annually for exporting steel products to the European Union, of which 6,94,853 tonnes will be under the free trade agreement, according to the draft text of the pact released by the EU. PTI

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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At BRICS, India must bank on the NDB

India should use BRICS to maximise the grouping's potential without strengthening Beijing, with the New Development Bank offering a practical avenue for cooperation; strengthening the NDB through greater capital, membership and local-currency lending can make BRICS more relevant

ECONOMIC NOTES

Amit Kumar
Anushka Saxena

In September 12, leaders of the BRICS grouping gathered at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi, with India holding the chair and, by extension, the pen. When BRICS came together in 2011, its five members contributed 20% of global GDP but held just 11% of the voting share at the International Monetary Fund (IMF). Today, the expanded grouping accounts for nearly 40% of global GDP and 55% of the world's population, but the voting share has barely expanded.

Beyond that grievance, BRICS does not, and will never, possess a coherent geopolitical identity. Russia, China and Iran would like it to be anti-West, while India, Brazil and South Africa insist it is better understood as non-West. Given these divergences and the importance of the India-U.S. ties, Delhi cannot lend itself to the Beijing-Moscow de-dollarisation crusade. Not only would that add fuel to the fire at a time when ties with Washington are already strained, but it would also be an unsustainable proposition to advocate in the medium term.

India's approach to BRICS has to conform to the broader constraints and contradictions that its membership poses – maximising the grouping's potential without strengthening Beijing's overall strategic position. Within these constraints, there are still possibilities to keep the grouping relevant.

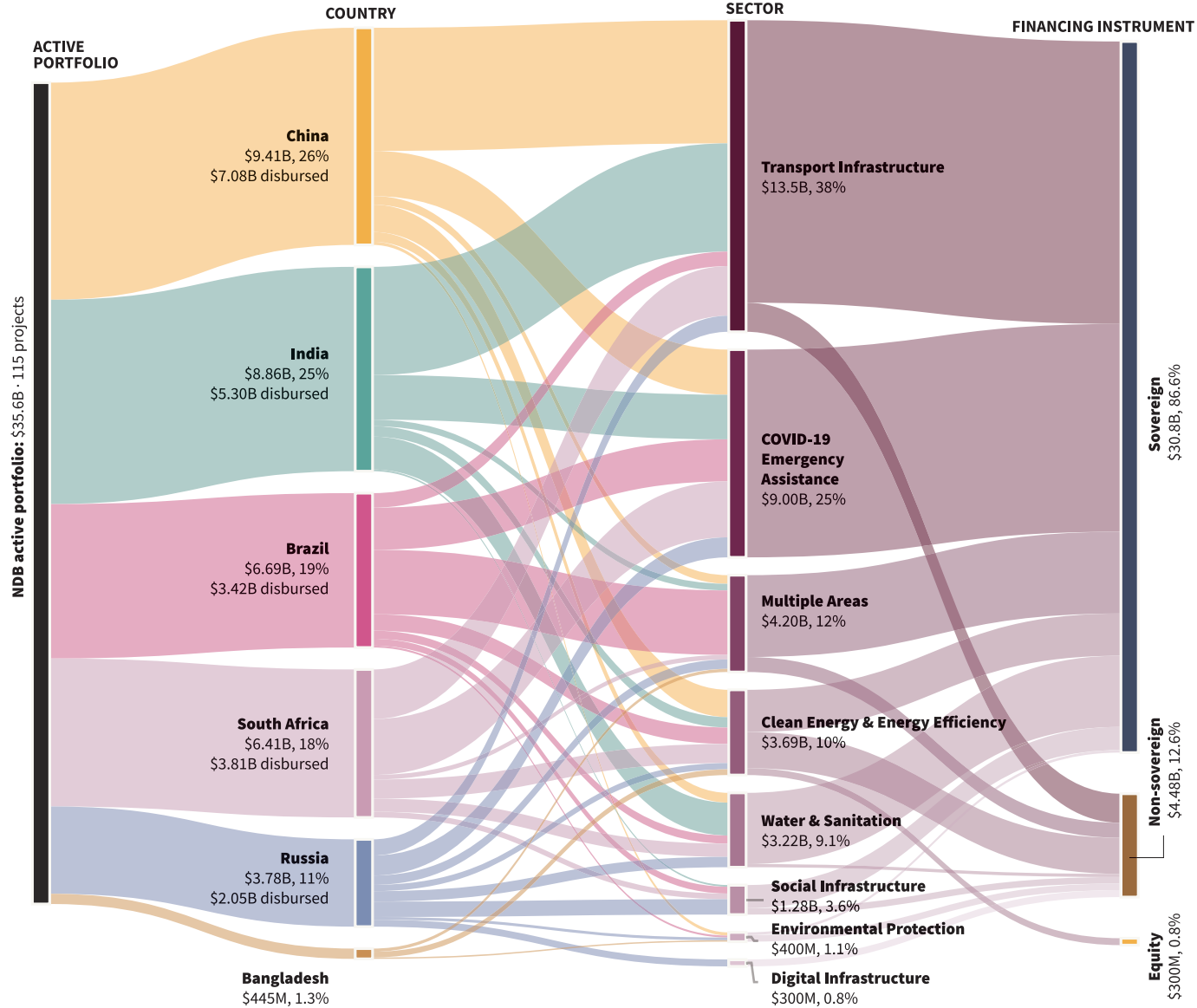
Making the NDB count
One area where BRICS can contribute the most meaningfully to the global financial order, without overtly threatening or challenging American predominance, is by expanding the efficiency and membership of the New Development Bank (NDB). Established by the BRICS countries in 2015 to “mobilise resources for infrastructure and sustainable development projects in BRICS and other emerging markets and developing countries,” the bank remains one of the grouping's most tangible tools.

Yet, despite a decade in operation, the NDB has approved only 139 projects worth about \$43 billion, distributed mostly among its core members. Its like-for-like counterpart, the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank (AIIB), established around the same time, has meanwhile gathered 111 approved members and committed about \$69 billion across 350 projects, backed by a AAA credit rating that the NDB cannot easily attain. Stagnant asset growth continues to restrict its lending capacity. This is coupled with an exceptionally slow disbursement rate; only about \$20 billion of approved loans had been disbursed, according to the bank's own count.

Breaking the asset bottleneck
One pathway to breaking this asset bottleneck would be for the five countries to increase their paid-up capital. However, severe domestic and geopolitical constraints mean that not all founders can match higher commitments – most notably, Russia, which is heavily sanctioned. Sanctions have also strained the bank's credit standing and dollar funding costs. What is ironic is that even as Moscow and Beijing champion de-dollarisation, including through the Bank, the NDB has extended no new credit to Russia since March 2022 to

Where the money flows

China and India together account for 51% of the New Development Bank's active portfolio, while transport infrastructure takes the largest share



This portfolio excludes loan amounts repaid and projects cancelled. NDB has approved \$43.0 billion across 139 projects in total since 2015; the difference is 24 projects and about \$7.4 billion that have been fully repaid or cancelled. Interior country-by-sector flows are estimated and scaled to NDB's published totals



The 18th BRICS Summit concluded on Sunday, in New Delhi. AP

protect its AA/AA+ credit rating. And since the bank's rules mandate equal voting shares among the founders, any capital expansion is effectively held hostage by its financially weakest link. The NDB has also opened its doors to new members, allowing for a fresh infusion of capital, but the founders' collective voting share cannot fall below 55%.

Regardless of how the bottleneck is resolved, there is merit in reprioritising the NDB within BRICS. So far, the bank has served Delhi well. It has secured commitments of nearly \$10 billion across 32 projects, including metro rail systems and the Delhi-Ghaziabad-Meerut RRTS corridor. It is not a small feat, but expanding the NDB's operations to be on par with other multilateral lenders would require extending such a bargain to many more emerging markets and developing

countries.

It is also a noteworthy strength of the NDB that it has a marked preference for local-currency lending. This mechanism appeals to emerging economies, especially at a time when the volatility in foreign-exchange markets is sustained because of global wars, both military and economic. It is an alternative way to reduce reliance on the dollar without replacing it as a currency for trade invoicing. The bank's 2022-26 General Strategy commits to 30% of its lending and borrowing in member countries' local currencies, even as the bulk of its lending and borrowing remains in dollars. Whatever local currency lending does exist is skewed heavily in favour of the Renminbi – just a few days ago, the NDB priced a ¥7 billion (-\$1.04 billion) three-year Panda bond in the China

Interbank bond market. In 2026, issuance of such bonds has gone up approximately 91% year-on-year, per Chinese data.

Pushing the rupee bond
It is time for India to push the long-delayed rupee bond over the line. First discussed in 2016, and subsequently slated for October 2023 and then for end-March 2026, the debut issuance was described by NDB President Dilma Rousseff in May as being at its “final stage,” two months after the bank floated a rupee bond programme to mobilise around ₹25,000 crore over five years. Further, given the fact that the 2026 New Delhi Declaration did not feature a meaningful agreement on mobilising the NDB, India's focus in BRICS next year should be on simpler fixes to local-currency challenges.

Unlike the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation, whose Summit recently concluded with bare-minimum outcomes, BRICS has tangible economic tools and a wider membership than ever before. In a world drifting towards subscription multilateralism, with Washington's pay-to-shape-the-rules Board of Peace as its latest specimen, these arrangements are the only way the grouping will truly set itself apart.

(Amit Kumar and Anushka Saxena are researchers at the Takshashila Institution. Views are personal to the authors and do not represent those of the Institution. Graphic Data Source: NDB; Investor Presentation June 2026 & Annual Report 2025; created by the authors)

THE GIST

BRICS' growing economic and demographic weight has not been matched by greater influence at institutions such as the IMF, while divisions among members prevent it from developing a coherent geopolitical identity

The NDB remains one of BRICS' most tangible economic instruments, but its lending and disbursement have lagged behind the AIIB, with weak asset growth and constraints arising from sanctions on Russia and the bank's voting structure

India should push for the long-delayed rupee bond and focus on practical local-currency measures, while using the NDB to extend development finance to more emerging markets and developing countries

CACHE



There is no steering wheel inside the Cybercab, raising questions about passenger safety. REUTERS

Why Tesla’s steering-less Cybercab is under investigation

Tesla has rolled out its two-seater Cybercab robotaxis in limited areas of Austin; while supporters see robotaxis as safer and more accessible, Tesla's Cybercabs face regulatory scrutiny and wider concerns over how driverless vehicles respond to emergencies and unexpected road situations

Sahana Venugopal

The story so far:
On September 3, Tesla announced the rollout of its new electric robotaxis, offering services in designated parts of Austin, Texas. According to news reports, the self-driving cars are almost impossible to ignore as their gold exterior and ‘Cybercab’ branding catch the eye. But the near-empty interior has sparked questions about the safety of passengers and their ability to intervene in case of emergencies.

What are the features of Tesla’s Cybercab?
The Cybercab is a self-driving car that has seating for two people. The ‘butterfly’ doors open upwards and the body boasts a sleek, cyberpunk-inspired design that contrasts sharply with the chunkier camera-mounted cars from rival Waymo. The golden exterior is meant to represent a “literal” golden age of transportation, according to Tesla CEO Elon Musk.
There are no steering controls or pedals inside the Cybercabs. Mr. Musk has declared that the cars were built for “maximally efficient autonomous operation.” On the absence of brake pedals, he said this would help in reducing the complexity of a hydraulic system, and that “plumbing” would not have to be routed all around the car. Regulators will need to confirm if Mr. Musk’s design choices comply with their safety requirements.
Mr. Musk described the Cybercab as

“basically a super comfortable lounge on wheels with a great TV and epic sound”. With upcoming Starlink integration, users would be able to watch 4 K live video while riding in the Cybercab, he said.
Switches under the touchscreen allow users to lower the windows. A cabin camera monitors the vehicle’s interior.
A Tesla Cybercab promotional video showed passengers sleeping, watching movies, playing games, teaching children, holding dogs, and handling conference calls while they were taking a ride.
A major perk for loyal passengers is that their climate and media settings are saved in a profile and will apply to new rides as well.
Children under the age of 13 are not permitted to ride in a Cybercab vehicle.
Passengers can stop a ride by either pressing a ‘Pull Over’ button on the touchscreen or a ‘STOP’ button overhead for non-emergency situations. In the event of an emergency, users will be able to pull the door lever to trigger an emergency mechanical release. The Cybercab is designed to also pull over instead of instantly braking, based on its surroundings. Passengers can reach Tesla representatives through the car’s communication system.

Have regulators approved the Tesla Cybercabs?
While the U.S. National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) is the regulator that enforces vehicle performance standards across the country, car makers have the option to self-certify their offerings.

The NHTSA confirmed it has opened an investigation into Tesla’s Cybercab self-certification to see if it meets the applicable Federal Motor Vehicle Safety Standards (FMVSS).
“When certified vehicles appear to not adhere to these requirements, NHTSA conducts an investigation,” stated the regulator.
The NHTSA explained that existing standards would remain in force even as the agency reviews rules related to standards for brake pedals, windshield wipers, lighting, and rearview mirrors, to enhance American innovation in automated vehicles.
The NHTSA is currently evaluating the Tesla Full Self-Driving (FSD) feature that is built into over three million vehicles. The assessment is related to impaired camera functions that have allegedly caused accidents in poor weather conditions.
In July, the NHTSA issued a more general warning about driverless automated vehicles “interfering,” as it noted that the cars drove into emergency scenes, blocked the way of ambulances and fire rescue vehicles, and were unable to respond properly when detecting flashing lights, fire, and traffic cones.
“This is unacceptable. To state it bluntly: an AV [automated vehicle] that cannot safely interact with first responders is a danger to the general public,” stated the NHTSA’s letter.
Cybercabs are not the first robotaxis launched by Tesla. The EV maker has already deployed its Model Y cars in Tampa and Miami, in Florida, and Austin, Dallas, and Houston, in Texas. Cybercabs

are currently available in limited areas only in Austin.
What are some concerns surrounding robotaxis?
Robotaxis or self-driving taxis have been hailed for a variety of reasons. They are often viewed as a safer option for female passengers, people who cannot communicate verbally, or passengers in vulnerable situations.
Supporters of robotaxis claim that they help lower accident rates (when compared to human-operated cars), prevent rash/fatigued/drunken driving, and that the AI systems supporting these cars are rapidly advancing.
Robotaxis have also been pitched as a win for accessibility and inclusion, as some customers complained that human-operated cabs cancel rides when passengers disclose disabilities, health conditions, and the use of wheelchairs or service animals. In fact, Tesla’s own Cybercab ad showed users of wheelchairs and crutches being able to store their belongings in the car boot. (This ad, however, did not cover how a non-mobile user would be able to make their way unassisted into the driverless car without their mobility aid.)
Still, robotaxis can pose safety risks when facing unexpected circumstances. Videos and posts shared on social media have recorded instances of driverless taxis being unable to move when held up by men blocking their path, leaving passengers fearful inside. Minor crashes and intrusions into protected areas have also been documented.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Questions on the much venerated and loved elephant-headed God on the occasion of Ganesha Chathurthi

V.V. Ramanan

- QUESTION 1**
According to the Padma Purana, how did Ganesha get his elephant head?
- QUESTION 2**
Because of what distinct features is Ganesha also called Lambodhara and Vakratunda?
- QUESTION 3**
In which form and which sage’s ‘kamandalu’ did Ganesha knock over to let Kaveri flow to the southern parts of India?
- QUESTION 4**
According to many accounts, Ganesha has two wives. Name them.
- QUESTION 5**
What is special about the idol of Ganesha

- located within the Muktheeswarar Temple complex in Thilatharpanapuri, Tamil Nadu?
- QUESTION 6**
Once, the Chandra (moon) laughed at Ganesha for falling after struggling with his pot belly. Initially, Ganesha cursed the moon to become invisible but later revoked the curse, partially resulting in which feature of the moon?
 - QUESTION 7**
One version of how Ganesha lost a part of a tusk is because of a duel with which avatar of Vishnu?
 - QUESTION 8**
According to the Ganesha Purana, Krauncha has become an integral part of the Ganesha myth. How?



Visual Question:
Identify this person and his single biggest contribution to modern-day worship of Ganesha. WIKIPEDIA COMMONS

- Questions and Answers to the previous day’s daily quiz:**
- 1. Which two Scottish commanders jointly led the forces at Stirling Bridge? **Ans: William Wallace and Andrew de Moray**
 - 2. How many horsemen could reportedly cross the bridge abreast? **Ans: Two**
 - 3. What type of Scottish formation played a crucial role in repelling the English cavalry? **Ans: Spearmen organised in schiltrons formations**
 - 4. Which English knight famously managed to fight his way back across the bridge after the Scottish attack? **Ans: Sir Marmaduke Thweng**
 - 5. According to the contemporary English chronicler Walter of Guisborough, approximately how many English infantry and cavalry were killed? **Ans: About 5,000 infantry and 100 cavalry. The figure is considered an overestimate by historians**
- Visual: Identify the actor in this scene from the famous 1995 film *Braveheart*, which depicts the life of William Wallace and the Battle of Stirling Bridge. **Ans: Mel Gibson**
- Early Birds:** Saniya | Abhijeet | Sadhan Panda | Jeelani Shaik | Sitaram Saharay



KNOW YOUR ENGLISH

The charming grifter fooled everyone

She remained impervious to criticism

S. Upendran

What is the meaning of ‘grifter’? (S. Geetha, Visakhapatnam)
The word ‘grift’ rhymes with ‘lift’, ‘sift’ and ‘gift’. Some of us in India became aware of this word when the media in the U.S. and U.K. reported that the CEO of a well-known company referred to Meghan Markle and her husband, Prince Harry, as ‘grifters’. This slang term is mostly used in informal contexts to show disapproval. When you refer to someone as being a ‘grifter’, what you are suggesting is that the individual, though charming, is not to be trusted, for he is a swindler. This clever individual will find a way to trick you out of your money without any threat of violence. Other terms used to refer to such an individual are: con artist, scammer, swindler, defrauder, etc. One of the theories about the word is that it is derived from ‘grafter’, meaning a corrupt individual.
The novel is about two grifters and their various scams.

How is the word impervious pronounced? What does it mean? (K. Arvind, Bengaluru)
The word consists of four syllables; the first is pronounced like the ‘im’ in ‘impossible’ and ‘important’. The following ‘er’ is like the ‘er’ in ‘stern’, ‘germ’ and ‘term’, while the ‘i’ sounds like the ‘i’ in ‘bit’, ‘hit’ and ‘sit’. The final ‘ou’ is like the ‘a’ in ‘china’. The word is pronounced ‘im-PER-vi-es’ with the stress on the second syllable. It comes from the Latin ‘impervius’, and it has been part of the English language since the mid 17th century. In Latin, ‘im’ means ‘not’ and ‘pervius’ means ‘passable’. The word ‘impervious’ literally means ‘not allowing anything to pass through’. An impervious surface, for example, is one that cannot be penetrated. During the monsoon season, some of us wear a raincoat because the material used to make the coat prevents water from seeping through; it is impervious to water. Similarly, we have material impervious to heat, while some are impervious to light. It is important to note that ‘impervious’ is usually followed by ‘to’ - one is always ‘impervious to’ something.
The new vest that the soldiers are wearing is impervious to bullets.
The tiles used on the space shuttle are impervious to extreme heat.
The word ‘impervious’ can be used figuratively in everyday contexts as well. When you say that an individual is impervious to criticism, what you are suggesting is that he is not affected by it; he is not bothered or influenced by what you or others say. Criticism bounces off him very much like raindrops off a raincoat.
Jain was impervious to my jokes. I just couldn’t make him laugh.

Which is correct? ‘Log in to’ an account or ‘Log into’ an account? (M Sridhar, Pune)
I don’t think it really matters nowadays - most people accept both. Native speakers of English seem to be happy with ‘log in to’ and ‘log into’. Purists, however, would argue that it should be ‘log in to’ and not ‘log into’ because according to them, ‘log in’ is a phrasal verb.
I couldn’t log in to my new account.
upendrankye@gmail.com

Word of the day

Ameliorate:
to make something better that was bad or not good enough
Synonyms: improve, enhance, help, enrich, refine
Usage: *The government hopes the scheme will ameliorate the impact of rising prices.*
Pronunciation: newsth.live/ameliorate
International Phonetic Alphabet: /əˈmiːliəreɪt/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject ‘Text & Context’

A ND-NDE

Unilateral sanctions impacting food security, people’s welfare: Pezeshkian

Iranian President calls for a stronger BRICS role in building a just international order; backs trade in national currencies and strengthening the New Development Bank to enhance economic resilience; stresses that people of Gaza, Lebanon continue to face consequences of crimes and genocide

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

BRICS must expand trade in national currencies and work towards an inclusive global economic framework as excessive dependence on existing financial and trade systems has made emerging economies vulnerable to political shocks, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian said on Sunday.

In an address at the concluding session of the two-day BRICS summit, Mr. Pezeshkian, taking a swipe at Western powers, was also critical of “unilateral sanctions”, saying they were directly impacting global food security and people’s welfare.

The Iranian leader’s remarks came weeks after the U.S. imposed new economic sanctions on Iran, tightening the squeeze on Tehran’s finances amid ongoing military hostilities between the two sides.

He said BRICS had evolved beyond being merely a framework for cooperation among emerging economies and had become a manifestation of growing demand for a more balanced and inclu-



Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian thanked Prime Minister Narendra Modi for hosting the summit, saying its theme, ‘Resilience, cooperation and sustainability’, reflected fundamental global needs. ANI

sive world in which “no centre of power has the right to determine the destiny of others”.

The BRICS now must play a greater role in building a more balanced, inclusive and just international order, the Iranian President said, stressing that resilience, cooperation and sustainability should be translated into practical action.

Military aggression

The Iranian President said economic resilience could not be sustained without security, referring to what

he described as the military aggression by the United States and Israel against Iran.

He said the attacks on Iran’s economic, energy and development infrastructure could have consequences beyond national borders, creating regional and global repercussions.

Mr. Pezeshkian said the Iranian people had paid a heavy price, with civilians killed and infrastructure built over decades damaged. He said the international community had a responsibility to protect civilians and prevent the

“normalisation of attacks on civilian targets”.

Mr. Pezeshkian thanked India, its people and Prime Minister Narendra Modi for hosting the summit, saying its theme – “Resilience, cooperation and sustainability” – reflected the fundamental global needs at a time when the destinies of nations were increasingly interconnected.

He said the international community’s challenge was not merely to manage current crises, but to build a system that strengthened nations against future cris-

es and create a fairer world.

Delving into pressing economic challenges, Mr. Pezeshkian said excessive dependence on limited financial and trade systems had made economies vulnerable to political shocks.

Unilateral sanctions directly affected food security and people’s welfare, he said, pitching for expanding trade in national currencies and strengthening the New Development Bank to enhance the economic resilience of BRICS members.

On the situation in Gaza and Lebanon, the Iranian President said the people of the region continued to face the consequences of “crimes and genocide”.

He called upon BRICS to play a more effective role in defending national sovereignty, territorial integrity and the prohibition of the use of force.

Elaborating on global challenges, Mr. Pezeshkian said no country could address them alone, and called for transforming the capacities of the Global South into shared capabilities.

He highlighted Iran’s geopolitical position and energy and transit capaci-

ties, saying they could contribute to the development of trade and energy corridors among BRICS members.

On sustainability, he warned that development that increases inequality or transfers today’s costs to future generations could not be sustainable.

The Iranian President also flagged concerns over the environmental consequences of war, saying damage to energy and industrial infrastructure could affect natural resources beyond economic losses.

Key elements

Mr. Pezeshkian identified knowledge and innovation as key elements of the BRICS agenda, stressing that AI and emerging technologies should serve as tools for empowering nations rather than instruments of domination.

The Iranian President also reaffirmed Iran’s readiness to contribute its capacities to BRICS cooperation, emphasising that resilience required sustained cooperation, cooperation required justice, and sustainability was impossible without peace and security.



Iranian Finance Minister Abbas Araghchi during a meeting with Mirwaiz Umar Farooq and others in New Delhi. PTI

Iran’s Araghchi holds talks with Kashmiri leaders

Peerzada Ashiq

SRINAGAR

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi held a separate meeting with senior Kashmiri religious leaders, including Mirwaiz Umar Farooq, Aga Syed Hassan, Muntazir Mehdi and Molvi Imran Raza Ansari, on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in New Delhi on Saturday.

The Kashmiri leaders pitched for “diplomacy over war as a means to resolve issues”.

Iranian official news agency, Islamic Republic News Agency (IRNA), also released photographs of the meeting. “A delegation of Indian clerics and religious leaders held a meeting with the Foreign Minister on the margins of the BRICS summit,” the IRNA said.

A spokesman of Mirwaiz said the religious leaders “exchanged views with Mr. Araghchi on the grave situation confronting the region”. The leaders called for “safeguarding unity within the Muslim Ummah”. The delegation also conveyed solidarity with the people of Iran and expressed deep concern over the loss of innocent lives, destruction of homes and infrastructure, and the “climate of fear and insecurity created by war”, said the spokesman.

The Kashmir leaders, according to the spokesman, also referred to the “continuing devastation in Palestine and the loss of life and instability in Lebanon”. “War only multiplies human suffering. However serious the differences may be, endless confrontation cannot resolve them. Ultimately, even the most difficult disputes have to return to dialogue, engagement and negotiation,” Mirwaiz told the Iranian Foreign Minister, according to the statement.

Mirwaiz also warned that the present conflicts “must not be allowed to deepen sectarian divisions within the Muslim world”. “The suffering of people in Iran, Palestine, Lebanon and elsewhere should bring us closer in compassion and responsibility, not push us further apart,” said Mirwaiz, as he mentioned Ayatollah Sayyid Ali Khamenei’s visit to Kashmir in the years following the Islamic Revolution in the 1980s.

Malaysian PM sings Kishore Kumar tune, wins Internet

Press Trust of India

NEW DELHI

Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim breaking into Kishore Kumar’s famous number, *Khwab Ho Tum Ya Koi Haqeeqat*, is winning hearts on the Internet.

On Saturday night, the Malaysian Prime Minister shared a video on X of him singing the 1960s Hindi film song from the Dev Anand-starrer *Teen Devian*. Dressed in a crisp grey suit, he sings to a piano tune being played by an accompanist. The clip has garnered over a million views and is being widely shared. However, it was not immediately known exactly when or where the video was shot.

Mr. Ibrahim attended the BRICS Summit in New Delhion Saturday and Sunday at the Bharat Mandapam complex.

Shahrizan Salian, a news editor at Malaysia’s *New Straits Times*, who is in India to cover the BRICS Summit, said the video appears to have been shot during the Malaysian Prime Minister’s stay at a luxury hotel in Delhi, as a colleague from his government sporting the BRICS Summit badge can be seen standing next to him, enjoying the moment.

“Prime Minister Ibrahim has in the past confessed to being a fan of Lata Mangeshkar and Kishore Kumar, both Indian singing legends,” Mr. Salian said.

The journalist explained that Ibrahim doesn’t know Hindi, yet he managed to sing along to a piano tune without any visual aid to the lyrics. “It all came from his heart. Music has no language,” he said.

In the video, Mr. Ibrahim is seen standing next to a guy playing a tune on the piano. And then, the Malaysian leader joins the musician to perform the Kishore Kumar number.

India engages in broad-based dialogue with African countries to consolidate strategic ties

Kallol Bhattacharjee

NEW DELHI

Months after postponing the India-Africa Forum Summit because of the Ebola crisis, New Delhi has started a broad-based dialogue with African countries, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi engaging multiple African leaders on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit that concluded on Sunday.

Mr. Modi hosted Ethiopian Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed Ali on Saturday, during which the two leaders discussed regional and global developments, and he met South African President Cyril Ramaphosa on Sunday.

On the meeting between the Prime Ministers of India and Ethiopia, the External Affairs Ministry said, “The two leaders held discussions aimed at further strengthening the bilateral strategic partnership. They reviewed progress across key sectors, including economic cooperation, defence and security partnership, and capacity building.”



Ethiopian Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed Ali boards his aircraft upon completing his visit to attend the BRICS Summit in New Delhi. PTI

In his remarks at the BRICS Summit, the Ethiopian Prime Minister had pitched his country as a frontrunner in digital public infrastructure in Africa, and urged the world to prepare to deal with “disruptions”. He said, “Africa should help build the next generation of AI. That requires research, computing capacity, skills and institutions able to lead that work.”

Mr. Modi met President Ramaphosa of South Africa on Sunday and reviewed the state of bilateral relations between their two countries. The New Delhi

Declaration issued on Saturday had taken note of the racial injustice that Africans have suffered historically, and also of the Brazilian-South African plan to start an “international panel on inequality”. The declaration also referred to decolonisation and Asian-African solidarity as displayed in the Bandung conference of 1955. It also particularly mentioned the South Africa-initiated legal process at the International Court of Justice against Israel for its military campaign in the Gaza Strip. Acknowledging South Africa’s leading role

in holding Israel accountable, the New Delhi Declaration said the proceedings “reaffirmed Israel’s legal obligation to ensure the provision of humanitarian aid in Gaza.”

In his discussion with Mr. Ramaphosa, Mr. Modi reviewed the “multi-faceted strategic partnership” between India and Africa. “The two leaders exchanged views on a range of global issues of mutual interest and agreed to maintain close coordination in multilateral fora,” the External Affairs Ministry said in a statement.

India-Africa Forum

India had also invited the President of Burundi, Évariste Ndayishimiye, in his capacity as the Chairperson of the African Union, to the BRICS Summit, and Mr. Modi hosted him for talks on Sunday and discussed the possibility of hosting the India-Africa Forum Summit “early”.

A statement issued by the External Affairs Ministry said the two sides acknowledged “India-African Union partnership is a key

pillar of cooperation within the Global South”. President Ndayishimiye acknowledged India’s assistance to African health authorities in dealing with the Ebola crisis, and Prime Minister Modi appreciated Africa’s successful handling of the outbreak. The Ministry said that “agricultural modernization, healthcare and capacity-building initiatives” were discussed during the meeting.

Mr. Modi on Sunday also met dignitaries from Uganda and Nigeria – both invited to the BRICS summit as “partner countries”. He met Vice President of Uganda Jessica Rose Epel Alupo and reaffirmed India’s support for the country’s “Vision 2040”. The discussion covered technology partnerships, capacity building, investment facilitation, and private sector collaboration. Mr. Modi also met Vice President of Nigeria Kashim Shettima Mustapha and discussed initiatives in trade, defence, agriculture, health and digital technologies.

Modi’s bilateral meets put defence, security cooperation in focus

Saurabh Trivedi

NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s bilateral engagements with leaders from Asia and Africa on the sidelines of the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi on Sunday emphasised defence and security cooperation, alongside trade, technology and strategic partnerships, as India sought to deepen its engagement with key partners across the Global South.

Mr. Modi held separate meetings with Kazakhstan President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, Philippines President Ferdinand R. Marcos

Jr., Ugandan Vice President Jessica Rose Epel Alupo, Nigerian Vice-President Kashim Shettima Mustapha, South African President Cyril Ramaphosa and the President of Burundi and chairperson of the African Union, Évariste Ndayishimiye.

Strategic partner

The meeting with Mr. Marcos of the Philippines assumes particular significance for India’s defence outreach in Southeast Asia. The two leaders agreed to further deepen cooperation in defence and security, along with trade and investment, space, railways,



Closer ties: Prime Minister Narendra Modi holds a meeting with Philippines’ President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr. in New Delhi. PTI

fintech, education, science and technology and innovation.

The Philippines, which became a strategic partner

of India in August 2025, is also a key defence partner in the region. The country has emerged as an important customer for Indian

defence equipment, particularly the BrahMos supersonic cruise missile system. It is the first foreign customer for BrahMos under a \$375-million deal, with deliveries and training under way.

Defence and security also figured prominently in Mr. Modi’s discussions with Kazakhstan President Tokayev, with the two sides reviewing cooperation in these fields as well as in connectivity, energy, critical minerals and emerging technologies.

The defence dimension of India’s engagement with Malaysia also received attention during BRICS-relat-

ed diplomacy. Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim said exploratory discussions were under way on Kuala Lumpur acquiring the BrahMos missile system, though no final decision had been taken.

Defence ties with Africa

With Nigeria, Mr. Modi discussed defence and security alongside trade, investment, energy, agriculture, health and digital technologies. Both sides reaffirmed their commitment to strengthening the strategic partnership.

The broader engagements also underlined India’s push for greater se-

curity cooperation with African partners. Discussions with Uganda focused on technology partnerships, capacity building and private-sector collaboration, while the meeting with the African Union Chairperson covered development partnership and capacity building.

Taken together, the meetings highlighted New Delhi’s effort to leverage the BRICS platform to reinforce defence partnerships, capacity building and indigenous defence exports, while expanding India’s strategic footprint across the Indo-Pacific, Central Asia and Africa.

INBRIEF



District Magistrate moves SC against Allahabad HC order

Gautam Buddha Nagar District Magistrate Medha Roopam has approached the Supreme Court against an Allahabad High Court order, which directed the recovery of ₹5 lakh from her salary and that of other officials to compensate Delhi University student Akriti Chaudhary for detaining her under the National Security Act (NSA) over a workers’ protest in Noida in April this year. A Division Bench of the High Court had quashed the nearly five-month detention as illegal. Ms. Roopam’s petition has arraigned Ms. Chaudhary as the primary respondent.

Will hold ‘Chhatron Ki Goonj’ on road if venue denied: Cong.

Madhya Pradesh Congress president Jitu Patwari on Sunday said the September 19 ‘Chhatron Ki Goonj’ event of Rahul Gandhi in Indore is a “non-political” programme and warned it would be held on the road if permission was denied for the proposed venue. The Congress has deposited ₹10.08 lakh with the Indore Development Authority for a three-day temporary lease of a nearly 12,000-square-metre ground opposite Regional Park for the event. The party, however, said it has not received final permission for the programme and the government process is under way. “Chhatron Ki Goonj is a non-political event. It should not be viewed through a political lens,” Mr. Patwari said.

UCC in all 21 NDA-ruled States by 2029, says Shah

Minister says government will deport all illegal immigrants; on the Gen Z protests, he says all must express opinions freely; Congress says Minister evaded questions on the Maharashtra coop ‘scam’

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

A Uniform Civil Code will be implemented by 2029 in the 21 States where the Bharatiya Janata Party and the NDA are in power, Union Home Minister Amit Shah said here on Sunday. He said the government was committed to deporting every illegal immigrant from the country.

Mr. Shah, who spoke to the press, refused to give a timeline for the implementation of the National Register of Citizens (NRC) in Manipur. However, he said the government was discussing with allies and political parties the use of the 1951 baseline for it.

Speaking about the Gen Z protests in July, he said everyone must express opinions in a democracy. “We want to communicate with everyone. We don’t want to run the country in an Emergency-like situation. Congress culture was different. Our culture is different,” he said.

Mr. Shah, who is on a two-day visit to Maharashtra, was speaking on the



Home Minister Amit Shah addressing a press conference with Devendra Fadnavis, left, and Eknath Shinde in Mumbai. PTI

occasion of the *Seva San- kalp Abhiyaan*, a month-long national drive from September 17 to October 17 to celebrate Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s birthday and the completion of his 25 years of service as a Chief Minister and as the Prime Minister.

The Congress slammed the Home Minister for evading questions on the allegations of corruption surrounding the Maharashtra State Cooperative Bank Limited ‘scam’ involving alleged financial irregularities of ₹25,000 crore through improper loan disbursals and distress sale of cooperative su-

gar factories. Mr. Shah is also the Union Minister of Cooperation, and when asked whether his Ministry planned to present a White Paper in the case, owing to the differences in the probe findings by the Central and the State agencies, he said, “Why should we? The agencies are doing their work. They will file a chargesheet in the court. I now request you all to limit yourselves to the topic of the 25 years of service.”

Maharashtra Congress president Harshawardhan Sapkal said the Union Minister “ran away” from the press conference as he did not have the “courage” to

answer questions on the multi-crore ‘scam’.

Mr. Shah’s visit to the State comes amid differences over making functional Marathi compulsory for cab and auto drivers. He will attend the Hindi Di-vas celebration here on Monday.

Asked about the conflicts over language and regional identity arising from migration, he said, “It is our government’s policy to prioritise the mother tongue, and the Constitution has issued specific directives to the States in this regard. I do not believe this will become a major issue. While isolated incidents may occur if certain individuals attempt to stoke tensions, the States have experienced leadership and will certainly find a way to resolve such issues.”

Mr. Shah, who presented the 52nd India Gem and Jewellery Awards at another event, urged the diamond industry to take a lead in the lab-grown diamond ecosystem. “The market for lab diamonds is poised to expand to nearly 50 times. This represents a huge opportunity.”

4 Kuki-Zo civilians killed in 2 Manipur shooting incidents

Rahul Karmakar
GUWAHATI

Unidentified gunmen killed four civilians from the Kuki-Zo community, including two women, in two incidents that took place in two Naga-majority districts of Manipur on Sunday.

Kuki-Zo organisations said the first attack was carried out around 4 a.m. at Tollen village in Tamenglong district. Seinheh Sing- sit and his wife, Lhingzan- gai, were killed, and their six-year-old son was injured.

The woman was killed on the spot, and her husband died of injuries in a nearby hospital. The six-year-old is receiving treatment.

The second incident occurred around 3 p.m. at Longpi village in Noney district. Residents said the gunmen ambushed three persons transporting rice, killing two of them on the spot.

The deceased have been identified as Julie Gangte and Thangroel Gangte. The third person, a woman, was reported missing.

Condemning the first attack, the Kuki Inpi JTN (Ji-ribam, Tamenglong, and



The attacks took place in Naga-dominated Noney and Tamenglong districts. ANI

Noney districts) said in a statement, “This inhuman act is not merely an attack on one family; it is an affront to humanity itself.”

The Western Village Volunteer (Jiribam, Tamenglong, and Noney), a Kuki-Zo organisation, demanded that the killers be identified, apprehended, and brought to justice within 24 hours. It warned that failing to ensure timely justice would compel it to “unleash all its anger to the perpetrators”.

Manipur Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh expressed deep anguish over the killings. He said that such cowardly acts of violence were unacceptable and have no place in society.

10 PLA combined arms brigades remain deployed along LAC: report

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

There was a significant reduction in the deployment of China’s People’s Liberation Army (PLA) along India’s northern borders in 2025, even as Beijing continued to maintain 10 combined arms brigade-sized formations in areas along the Line of Actual Control (LAC) and in traditional training areas, according to the Defence Ministry’s annual report for 2025-2026, released on Sunday.

The report said the Indian Army’s deployment across all sectors along the LAC remained robust and prepared to deal with any emerging contingency.

On India-China engagements, the Ministry said sustained political, diplomatic, and military interactions between the two countries had facilitated positive developments along the northern bor-



The report says the Indian Army’s deployment along the LAC remains robust and prepared to deal with any contingency.

ders and contributed to stability.

The year 2025 saw the resumption of key dialogue mechanisms, including the 33rd and 34th meetings of the Working Mechanism for Consultation and Coordination (WMCC), held in March and July respectively. The Special Representatives (SR) dialogue on the India-China boundary question also resumed, with rounds held in December 2024

and August 2025.

The report said the improvement in bilateral relations was further reinforced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s visit to China for the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit in Tianjin in August 2025.

Military engagement

The military-to-military engagement also saw a positive trajectory, with the 23rd Corps Commander-le-

vel meeting held in eastern Ladakh on October 25 and 26, 2025.

At the ground level, border personnel meetings between the Indian Army and the PLA continued across all sectors, with the report stating that these engagements were conducted in a cordial and friendly environment to address issues of concern.

The latest assessment indicates a gradual stabilisation of the situation following sustained diplomatic and military-level engagements.

On September 6, amid continuing concerns over conflicting territorial claims and military build-up along the LAC, the Indian and Chinese Armies held their first Corps Commander-level meeting in the Eastern Sector, marking a significant expansion of the military dialogue mechanism beyond the Ladakh sector.

‘S-400 destroyed Pak. plane 314 km away during Operation Sindoor’

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

An S-400 air-defence unit of the Indian Air Force destroyed a Pakistani special-mission aircraft at a distance of 314 km during Operation Sindoor, marking one of the longest surface-to-air engagements claimed by India, according to the Defence Ministry’s Annual Report for 2025-26 released on Sunday.

The report described the engagement as a demonstration of the IAF’s long-range air-defence capability, saying it challenged the adversary’s belief that distance could provide protection from Indian air-defence systems.

“Indian radars tracked the threat in silence”, and a long-range surface-to-air missile was guided to its target at the far end of its engagement envelope, the report said. The operation,



The report said the operation demonstrated that even distant targets were within the IAF’s air-defence architecture’s reach. AFP

it added, demonstrated that targets at considerable distances were within the reach of the IAF’s air-defence architecture.

Prime Minister’s visit

The report said Prime Minister Narendra Modi subsequently visited Air Force Station Adampur on May 12, 2025, and commended the air warriors involved in the operation. It also noted that 219 Presidential Gallantry Awards were award-

ed to IAF personnel on August 15, 2025, for their role during the operation.

The engagement was part of a broader integrated air-defence effort during the four-day conflict from May 7 to 10, 2025. The IAF, which is responsible for the country’s air defence, exercised centralised control and coordination through its indigenous Integrated Air Command and Control System (IACCS).

According to the report, the IACCS acted as the foundational framework for integrated air-defence operations by integrating military and civil surveillance sensors and providing stakeholders with a common Recognised Air Situation Picture.

Operations were centrally controlled through IAF Networked Tactical Nodes at multiple locations. These nodes played a key role in the identification and classification of aerial targets, with trained operators ensuring that civil aircraft were not engaged during the hostilities, the report said.

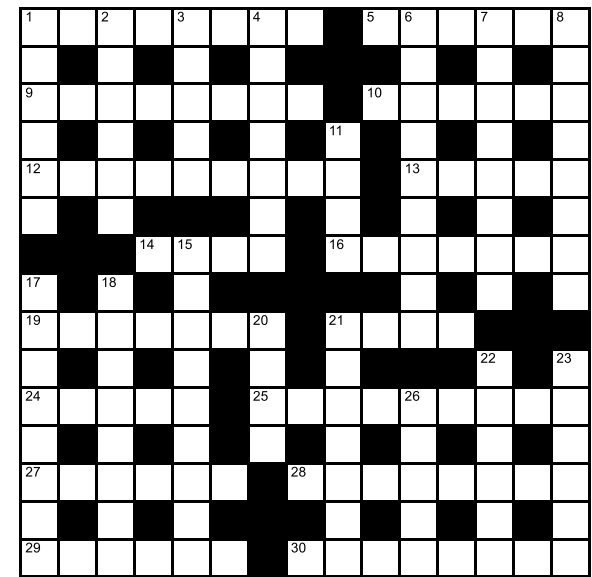
The report also alleged that Pakistan kept its civil airspace open during the conflict, including the operation of civil flights during hostile action. In contrast, India’s conduct was aimed at ensuring that international air traffic was not put at risk.

THE CROSSWORD+ 14898

(set by KrisKross)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

SCAN TO PLAY



- 13 Expression of pain from New Agra hospital (5)
- 14 Most ethical housing - let it stand (4)
- 16 Thrashing out new IIT coaching (7)
- 19 In the end, consuming drug minimally (2,5)
- 21 What many eateries never update primarily? (4)
- 24 Perhaps Jerry’s inspiration to win Tom’s heart (5)
- 25 Cunning tailors basically amending rates of dresses (9)
- 27 Counter the Muslim pilgrim and the French prophet (6)
- 28 Play with liberal approach in the auditorium (8)
- 29 Lakhs struggling to grasp old Sanskrit verse (6)
- 30 KrisKross is enthralled by mysterious saints - they believe in spirits (8)
- Down
- 1 Copy boarded by extremely secretive writer (6)
- 2 Mythical bird about to crack a couple of eggs in a flamboyant style (6)
- 3 Turn a precious stone over in conclusion (5)
- 4 Request to come in, remove shoe, finally have food (7)
- 6 Government and WHO ultimately contain spreading disease (9)
- 7 Brave lover, a bit upset, back to attack (8)
- 8 Treat this animal appallingly to get patent leather (8)
- 11 Bug in part of instrument (4)
- 15 Name two forms of transport around Delaware (9)
- 17 Safe house initially missing a member? (8)
- 18 Washed up mud essentially picked up by everyone with container (8)
- 20 Difficult job to eat last bit of murukku, lacking a tooth (4)
- 21 Plague is awful ... starting to ravage millions ... absolute ruin! (7)
- 22 Kindles with tips on reading (6)
- 23 Columns broken by large tools (6)
- 26 Priest leaves stand in disgrace (5)

- Across
- 1 After retirement, I could be surrounded by busy, cross, mean folks (8)
- 5 Blame one catching dogs right away (6)
- 9 Entertain soldiers active in part of Greece (8)
- 10 Breathe hot and strong (6)
- 12 Young reporter going around on beat exposed very ruthless robber (9)

SUDOKU

3	5		1	7				4
		6						
			3	2	5			
	2				4	7		
6		2		7		3		
3	4				6			
	3	7	8					
4			2	5		1	6	

Solution to previous puzzle

Solution to yesterday’s Sudoku

FAITH

Vinayaka, the protector

Hailed as the prime mover and remover of obstacles, Vinayaka is also revered as a protector. The ancient Vinayaka temple at Tiruppurambiyam, near Kumbakonam, stands testimony to this, with devotees thronging this temple on Vinayaka Chaturthi, said P. Swaminathan.

Puranas state that during the end of the Krita Yuga, when the cosmic deluge was imminent, petrified devotees in Tiruppurambiyam prayed to Lord Siva. Siva directed His younger son Vinayaka to protect the faithful. As the deluge neared the hamlet with terrifying force, Vinayaka rushed to the place. He used his yogic powers to create a deep channel (well) into which the flood waters were directed and contained within. Known as the *sapta sagara coom*, the presence of this well within the temple has been recorded. The town itself came to be referred to as Tiruppurabiyam (surviving the deluge). Relieved at the containment of the deluge, Varuna, the rain god, is said to have fashioned an idol of Vinayaka made of conch shells, sea shells, sea foam and sand: materials that are part of the waterbody and consecrated it at Tiruppurambiyam. While modak offering is the normal practice in most Vinayaka temples on the occasion of Vinayaka Chaturthi, at the Tiruppurambiyam temple, the offering is entirely different. Unlike other temples where milk, curd and other offerings are poured over the idol, at Tiruppurambiyam a cloth is dipped in honey after which it is draped over the idol. It is a way of reminding devotees that when problems threaten to overwhelm them, they should pray to Vinayaka to remove the obstacles and protect them. He will oblige with a smoothness that one associates with honey.

ETFs: A one-click route to diversified investing

Vaishali R Venkat

What if I say that you can gain exposure to 50 or 500 stocks, a basket of commodities or even a few sectors in one click? This is what an Exchange Traded Fund (ETF) offers. ETFs are traded on stock exchanges just like shares, allowing investors to buy a basket of securities in a single transaction and thereby “reduce the impact of poor performance” by any one company, unlike investing in a single share. But before jumping to buy the ETFs, it’s crucial to understand how they work?

An ETF offers investors a way to participate in a basket of investments through a single tradable unit. Depending on its mandate, it might mirror a benchmark index such as the Nifty or Sensex, or provide exposure to assets such as gold, silver and bonds. ETF products can also focus on sectors such as defence, pharmaceuticals, FMCG, technology and banking. Currency ETFs are available in overseas markets, though such products are not currently available to Indian retail investors. Therefore, buying units of ETFs offers an investor a proportionate exposure to the underlying basket of equities. In the case of an index ETF, the aim is simple: to stay as close as possible to the performance of the benchmark, rather than attempt to beat it.

Unlike a traditional mutual fund or index fund, an ETF trades throughout the market hours on the stock exchanges. You can place an order through a broker whenever the market is open, and its spot price keeps changing in response to the value of its underlying assets. Thus, to buy ETFs, a demat and trading account are essential. This stock-like feature also gives ETFs greater flexibility: besides holding them for the long term, eligible investors can short-sell or buy them using margin, subject to applicable rules and regulations of your broker. Besides the ETF’s expense ratio, investors should also factor in transaction-related costs such as brokerage, where applicable, and the bid-ask spread. Statutory charges such as Securities Transaction Tax (STT) may also apply depending on the ETF and transaction.

Most index ETFs follow a passive investment approach. Instead of trying to identify stocks that could outperform the market or the benchmark itself, the ETF is designed to mirror a predetermined index. The fund manager’s job is largely to keep the portfolio aligned with the benchmark. It reduces the dependence on a fund manager’s stock-picking ability and, because there is less active buying and selling, can also help keep costs lower.

Another attraction is cost. Since a passive ETF does not rely on continuous stock selection by a fund manager, its management expenses are generally lower than those of actively managed funds. The bigger advantage is diversification: a Nifty 50 ETF, for instance, gives exposure to all the constituents of the index instead of putting the entire investment into one company.

Dividends received from the underlying companies also form part of the ETF’s returns; depending on the scheme structure, they may be distributed or reflected through reinvestment. But an ETF will not always deliver exactly the index’s return. The difference between the ETF’s performance and that of its benchmark is known as tracking difference, while tracking error measures the consistency of this difference over time, which can arise from expenses, transaction costs, cash holdings, dividend timing, corporate actions and changes in index constituents. Generally, a lower tracking error indicates that the ETF is following its benchmark more closely. When an index is rebalanced and companies are added or removed, the ETF adjusts its underlying portfolio to reflect those changes, that is, the investor does not have to buy or sell the individual stocks. Thus, ETFs can be a simple, cost-efficient way to diversify and participate in market returns.

(The writer is an NISM & CRISIL-certified Wealth Manager and certified in NISM’s Research Analyst module)



SIFs were introduced by SEBI as a product sitting between mutual funds and portfolio management services. ILLUSTRATION: SAINATH B.

Specialised investment funds vs mutual funds

A conventional mutual fund is largely a long-only product, while an SIF has more room to manoeuvre; a more relevant question is what does an SIF do that a mutual fund cannot?

FUND MANAGEMENT

Joydeep Sen

Investors have a new choice in the investment space. But the question is not whether you should choose a Specialised Investment Fund, or SIF, over a mutual fund. The more relevant question is: what does an SIF do that a mutual fund cannot? That is where the difference lies.

SIFs were introduced by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) as a product sitting between mutual funds and portfolio management services (PMS). Mutual funds are accessible with very small amounts, while PMS requires a minimum investment of ₹50 lakh. SIF comes in between, with a minimum investment of ₹10 lakh. That makes SIF a product for investors who have accumulated meaningful financial wealth but may not want to move into PMS. But the ₹10 lakh minimum is not the most important feature of SIF.

The important feature is what the fund manager is allowed to do with your money. A conventional mutual fund is largely a long-only product. An SIF has more room to manoeuvre. It can take unhedged short positions through derivatives, subject to the prescribed limits, up to 25% of net assets for certain strategies.

Going short means taking a position that benefits

Mutual funds are accessible with very small amounts, while PMS requires a minimum investment of ₹50 lakh

if the price falls. Therefore, if the fund manager believes a stock, sector or market is likely to decline, the SIF has a tool that a conventional mutual fund does not have. This can act as a brake when markets are falling. There is a catch. A tool is useful only if the fund manager uses it correctly. A wrong short call can hurt returns just as a wrong long call can.

SIFs are still a nascent product, but the early numbers are striking. As on July 31, 2026, SIF assets under management were ₹23,177 crore, with 94,447 folios. At the end of December 2025, AUM was ₹4,892 crore and folios were 20,779.

The ₹10 lakh minimum investment clearly has not stopped investors from coming in. A simple calculation makes the point.

Divide the ₹23,177 crore of AUM by 94,447 folios and the average comes to about ₹24.5 lakh per folio. This is more than twice the regulatory minimum.

A folio is not the same as a unique investor, since one investor can have several folios.

There were 30 SIF funds across fund houses as on

SIF comes with a minimum investment of ₹10 lakh, making it a product for investors who have accumulated meaningful wealth

July 31, 2026. Of these, 16 were equity-oriented and 14 were hybrid. There is no debt SIF, although SEBI has provided for debt-oriented SIF strategies.

How to evaluate an SIF? Do not compare an SIF with all mutual funds. Compare it with the closest mutual fund strategy.

And then ask what the SIF does differently.

Take an Equity Long-Short SIF. The closest mutual fund comparison could be a flexi-cap, large and mid-cap or focused equity fund. All can take meaningful equity exposure and attempt to generate returns through stock selection. But there is a crucial difference. The mutual fund manager is predominantly playing on the upside. If the manager believes that a particular stock is going to fall, the usual response is to reduce or exit the position. The SIF manager has another option: take a short position, within the permitted limit. The manager can potentially make money not only by identifying what should go up, but also by identifying what should go down. An Equity Ex-Top

100 Long-Short SIF is broadly comparable with mid-cap, small-cap or flexi-cap mutual funds. The commonality is that the portfolio can look beyond the largest companies.

The difference again is the ability to use short exposure. This matters because the further you move down the market-cap curve, the greater the dispersion between winners and losers can be.

Is SIF better than MF?

There is no such simple answer. For most investors, mutual funds will continue to be the basic building blocks of a portfolio. They are accessible, diversified and available across a wide range of strategies. SIF is meant for a different investor.

If you have ₹10 lakh or more to allocate to a single strategy and want something beyond the conventional long-only approach, SIF deserves a look.

But do not buy an SIF simply because it is sophisticated. And do not buy it merely because the manager can short.

The right approach is to compare the SIF with its closest MF proxy. Look at the portfolio, investment mandate and how the strategy behaved in rising as well as falling markets. Look at costs. And, most importantly, examine how the fund manager has actually used the additional flexibility.

(Joydeep Sen is a corporate trainer (financial markets) and author)

Keep track of your insurance renewals

COVERNOTE

K. Nitva Kalyani

Not having insurance is risky. Riskier still is not having it but thinking you do. Ignorance about his motor insurance renewal date has landed the friend of a neighbour in a very difficult spot. The car he bought two years ago crashed badly and the repair bill came to a few lakhs.

What about insurance? He was told that the insurance was for only one year and was not renewed.

He called his car dealer who had assured him at the time of purchase that insurance had been done for three years.

Who was right? Both. And it was quite the effort to make the gentleman understand the Catch-22 situation he was, well, caught in.

There are two types of Motor insurance. Third-party liability insurance (TP) is statutory under the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988.

The Supreme Court mandated this cover to be issued for three years for new cars, and so this gentleman’s TP policy was indeed for three years.

So where was the problem? This is not the cover that pays for damages to his car.

The TP cover protects you against claims OTHER people may make against you if your vehicle causes damage, injury or death. It is the Own Damage (OD) cover that pays for repairing your vehicle and this is a one-year cover and the gentleman failed to renew it, unfortunately, relying on his dealer’s statement.

He only had to glance at his policy to see that one other component had to be renewed at the end of the first year. Dealers usually issue a Motor Comprehensive policy that bundles both these covers. TP for three years renewable thereafter a year at a time, and OD for one year cover renewable one year at aa time.

Common mistake

This confusion led to an expired insurance policy for a former colleague as well, thankfully without the accident. He read the policy cursorily and thought he was covered for three years since he saw some date on the document that said so.

Puzzled by the spate of renewal calls, he looked at his policy finally and found the OD cover had expired already. He could have clicked a link to renew if he had done it on time, but now the car has to be inspected by the insurer for renewal. While he was irked that he did not get a renewal notice from the insurer, remember, tracking renewals is the responsibility of the insured.

Moral of the story: Don’t rely on what the dealer told you, what you remember or whether a renewal message arrives. Check the policy itself. Know which covers you have, when each one expires and what needs to be renewed.

Insurance policies should highlight this critical distinction suitably on the policy. That would save the day!

(The writer is a business journalist specialising in insurance & corporate history)

Personal Loans

Rates and Charges		Loan amount 5 lakh Tenure 5 years	Loan amount 1 lakh Tenure 5 years	(% of loan amount)
Name of Lender	Interest Rate (%)	EMI (Rs)	EMI (Rs)	Processing fee
Axis Bank	8.90 onwards	10,355 onwards	2,071 onwards	Up to 2%
Bajaj Finserv	10.00-30.50	10,624-16,177	2,125-3,235	Up to 4.13%
Bank of Baroda*	10.15-18.00	10,660-12,697	2,132-2,539	Up to 2% (Max. Rs 10,000)
Bank of India	10.85-16.15	10,834-12,199	2,167-2,440	Up to 1% (Min. Rs 250; Max. Rs 15,000)
Bank of Maharashtra	9.75-15.00	10,562-11,895	2,112-2,379	Up to 1% (Max. Rs 10,000)
Canara Bank	9.70-15.15	10,550-11,934	2,110-2,387	0.25% (Rs. 500 - Rs. 2,500)
Central Bank of India	11.25 onwards	10,934 onwards	2,187 onwards	Up to 1%
Federal Bank	11.75 - 18.99	11,059 - 12,968	2,212 - 2,594	Up to 3%
HDFC Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to Rs 6,500
HSBC Bank	9.70 onwards	10,562 onwards	2,112 onwards	Up to 1%
ICICI Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 2%
IDFC FIRST Bank	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 3.5%
Indian Overseas Bank	10.25 onwards	10,685 onwards	2,137 onwards	Up to 0.75%
IndusInd Bank	10.49 onwards	10,744 onwards	2,149 onwards	Up to 3.5% (2% for instant personal loans for limited period)
Kotak Mahindra Bank	10.99 onwards	10,869 onwards	2,174 onwards	Up to 5%
Poonawalla Fincorp	9.99 onwards	10,621 onwards	2,124 onwards	Up to 4%
Punjab & Sind Bank	9.65-13.90	10,538-11,608	2,108-2,322	0.50%-1%
Punjab National Bank	10.25-16.80	10,685-12,373	2,137-2,475	Up to 1%
State Bank of India	10.00-15.00	10,624-11,895	2,125-2,379	Up to 1.50% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 15,000)
Tata Capital	10.99 onwards	10,869 onwards	2,174 onwards	Flat Rs. 49
UCO Bank	9.95 - 13.20	10,611-11,428	2,122-2,286	Up to 1% (Min. Rs 750)
Union Bank of India	8.90 - 12.65	10,355-11,287	2,071-2,257	Up to 1% (Max. Rs 7,500)

*Interest concession of 0.10% to customers opting for group credit life insurance.

Car Loans

Rates and Charges		Loan amount 5 lakh Tenure 5 years	(% of loan amount)
Name of Lender	Interest Rate (%)	EMI (Rs)	Processing fee
Bank of Baroda	7.60 - 11.35	10,043 - 10,959	Up to Rs. 2,000
Bank of India	7.60-12.55	10,043 - 11,262	Up to 0.25% (Rs. 2,500 - Rs. 10,000)
Bank of Maharashtra*	7.45-11.75	10,007 - 11,059	Up to 0.25%
Canara Bank**	7.45-11.45	10,007 - 10,984	0.25% (Rs 1,000 - Rs 5,000)
Central Bank of India	7.50-9.30	10,019 - 10,452	NIL (Till 31.12.2026)
Federal Bank	7.90-9.00	10,114 onwards	1% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 50,000)
HDFC Bank	8.15 onwards	10,174 onwards	Up to 0.5% (Rs. 3,500 - Rs. 8,000)
ICICI Bank	8.40 onwards	10,234 onwards	Up to Rs. 8,500
Indian Bank	7.50-9.65	10,019 - 10,513	Rs. 1,200
Indian Overseas Bank	7.55-12.00	10,031 - 11,122	NIL
Karnataka Bank	8.13-11.63	10,169 - 11,029	Up to 0.60% (Rs. 2,500 - Rs. 11,000)
Punjab and Sind Bank***	7.55-14.05	10,031 - 11,647	0.25% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 15,000)
Punjab National Bank	7.60-10.70	10,043 - 10,797	Up to 0.25% (Rs. 1,000 - Rs. 1,500)
State Bank of India	8.70 - 9.85	10,307 - 10,587	Rs. 500 - Rs. 2,000
UCO Bank	7.35-10.00	9,983 - 10,624	0.5% (Max. Rs 5,000)
Union Bank of India	7.50-10.00	10,019 - 10,684	Up to Rs 1,000

*0.25% interest rate concession for existing home loan borrowers and other existing customers having at least 6 months of relationship with the bank.

**50% waiver on processing fee till September 30

***Concession of up to 50% on processing fee for PSB Apna Vahan Sugam.

Rates and charges as on September 9

Source: Paisabazaar.com

CAIRO

Two Palestinians killed in Israeli airstrike in Gaza Strip, medics say



AP
An Israeli airstrike on Sunday killed at least two Palestinians in a vehicle and wounded 13 others in the Gaza Strip, medical staff said. The strike occurred in the Tel Al-Hawa neighbourhood in western Gaza City. The Israeli military said the strike targeted two Hamas militants, without giving further information. REUTERS

DOONBEG

‘Negative forces’: Trump slams AI critics, says U.S. leads China in tech



AFF
U.S. President Donald Trump said on Sunday a lot of “very negative forces” are bringing things up about AI that won’t happen and said that he wanted to make sure that the U.S. remains the industry leader. “We’re leading China in AI. We’re the most sophisticated country in the world... I want to keep it that way,” Mr. Trump said.

JAKARTA

Search under way for 140 people after Indonesian vessel capsizes



AP
Indonesian rescuers were searching for 140 people from a ship that sank in the Java Sea after 103 others were evacuated, one of whom died, a search and rescue agency official said. An Indonesian passenger ship carrying 243 people had been reported missing after losing contact on Sunday during bad weather. REUTERS

STOCKHOLM

Swedes vote for a new Parliament as far right eyes government role



AFF
Sweden voted on Sunday in a tightly contested general election that could either bring the far right into government for the first time or return the left-wing Opposition to power. Prime Minister Ulf Kristersson said he was optimistic that his right-wing alliance, which includes the Sweden Democrats, would emerge victorious. AFP

Pezeshkian says Iran and UAE want to ‘turn the page’ on war

Iranian President’s remarks follow his meeting with Abu Dhabi Crown Prince on the sidelines of a key summit in New Delhi; Iran says meeting planned with Oman today regarding the Strait of Hormuz and enhanced security cooperation in the Gulf

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran and the United Arab Emirates, whose relations have deteriorated since the start of the war in West Asia, want to “turn the page”, Iranian President Massoud Pezeshkian said on Sunday.

“For the first time since the war, we had a constructive exchange with the Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi,” said Mr. Pezeshkian a day after a meeting with Sheikh Khaled Bin Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan in New Delhi, on the sidelines of the BRICS summit. “It was agreed that we would turn the page, look to the future and build it together.”

After U.S.-Israeli attacks



Regional rumble: Iran carried retaliatory strikes against America’s allies in the region, with the UAE bearing much of the brunt. REUTERS

on Iran in February launched the war, Tehran retaliated against America’s allies in the region, with the UAE bearing much of the brunt.

Ship strike on Hormuz Meanwhile, Iranian state media reported that an Ira-

nian commercial ship was struck early on Sunday off the Qeshm Island in the Strait of Hormuz and one person was killed in the attack.

Iran’s state-run IRNA news agency quoted the governor of Qeshm, the island crucial for Iran assert-

ing control over the strait, as blaming a “terrorist enemy” for the attack.

Separately, the United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations monitor said a vessel was hit by a projectile while transiting the strait, with no further details.

The incident occurred a day before Tehran plans to brief countries in the region on its contested efforts to manage shipping traffic at the crucial waterway. The official IRNA news agency reported on Sunday that the meeting with Gulf states in Oman on Monday will be “the first step towards establishing a regional framework for security cooperation” in the region.

Iranian Foreign Ministry

spokesman Esmaeil Baqaei said “it will serve as an essential cornerstone for ensuring stability and security” in a statement.

Tehran has been pushing to formalise its control over the waterway, including charging fees for passage, and has been in negotiations with Muscat, whose territorial waters also cover Hormuz.

U.S. President Donald Trump said on Sunday he does not “care” about the proposed meeting between Iran and Gulf states, while suggesting that the U.S. could stay in Iran and “keep the oil”, drawing a parallel with a U.S. push to take control of a fifth of Venezuela’s vast oil reserves.

(With inputs from Associated Press)

Saudi Arabia pipeline outage puts global oil supply at risk

Reuters
LONDON

Saudi Arabia will run out of oil stocks for exports if it doesn’t restart its major pipeline to the Red Sea within days, leading to a loss of up to 4% of global supply, Saudi oil buyers and traders said.

Saudi Arabia shut its east-west oil pipeline on Friday following drone strikes by Iran-aligned Houthis in Yemen.

The world’s biggest exporter has used the pipeline to reroute around 4 million barrels per day – around 4% of global supply – to the port of Yanbu on the Red Sea. But with the pipeline out of service, Yanbu now has stocks to maintain exports for just five to seven days, according to three industry sources.

Saudi Arabia also has stocks to supply customers for several days from



Desert plume: Satellite image shows smoke rising from an area of Saudi Arabia’s East-West pipeline. AFP

Egypt’s ports of Ain Sukhna on the Red Sea and Sidi Kerir on the Mediterranean, a fourth source said.

Stocks are not full and will ultimately run out without the east-west pipeline resuming operations, the sources said.

New attacks Meanwhile, the Houthis on Sunday claimed more attacks on Saudi Arabia.

A Houthi military spokesperson, Brigadier General Yahya Saree, said in a

statement that the group targeted a military base in Sharurah province in Saudi Arabia’s Najran region. Houthi media reported on Sunday that Saudi Arabia had carried out two strikes on Saada, in the north of Yemen.

Tens of thousands have taken flight in the wake of escalating conflict. “Displacement in Yemen has now reached 85,818 people,” the International Organization for Migration said.

India slams attack on ship off Oman coast, one seafarer missing

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

India on Sunday condemned an attack on a Panama-flagged oil tanker off the coast of Oman that resulted in one Indian seafarer being reported missing.

The External Affairs Ministry said 13 other Indian crew members of the vessel, *MT El Gaia*, were rescued.

“We condemn the attack on the commercial vessel *MT El Gaia* off the coast of Oman earlier to-

day. Of the 14 Indian crew onboard, 13 Indians have been rescued so far,” it said.

“Search and rescue operations for the missing Indian national are continuing,” the Ministry said in a statement.

“We reiterate our call for immediate de-escalation of tensions and pursuance of dialogue and diplomacy to bring peace to the region,” it said.

Ten Indian seafarers have been killed so far in the West Asia conflict.

Myanmar revokes status of UN envoy, says official holding office illegitimately

Agence France-Presse
YANGON

Myanmar’s military-backed government said on Sunday their UN Ambassador – loyal to ousted leader Aung San Suu Kyi – is occupying the office illegitimately, as the organisation prepares to weigh his replacement.

Myanmar has been embroiled in civil war since a military coup in 2021 ousted the elected government of Nobel laureate Suu Kyi.

The United Nations formed a credentials committee this month to de-



Kyaw Moe Tun

cide whether to accept Naypyidaw’s candidate for UN ambassador or stick with Kyaw Moe Tun, who has rejected the coup and

for more than five years ignored the government’s claims that he no longer represents Myanmar.

Myanmar’s Foreign Ministry said Kyaw Moe Tun was “dismissed from civil service” effective February 27, 2021 for not complying with state orders, committing treason and colluding with “terrorist organisations”, according to a statement published in the state-run *Global New Light of Myanmar* newspaper.

The day before his dismissal, he made an emotional plea during an address at the UN General

Assembly for the “strongest possible action” against the military coup.

The Ministry accused Kyaw Moe Tun of misusing state funds and property, including the premises of the UN Permanent Mission of Myanmar in New York, and working with the exiled opposition “National Unity Government” (NUG), which the government has branded a terrorist group.

“Kyaw Moe Tun’s continued representation of Myanmar at the UN does not constitute formal recognition of his legitimacy,” the Ministry said.

Turkiye authorities launch crackdown on LGBTQ+ associations

Reuters
ISTANBUL

Turkish authorities have detained at least 47 people following a series of raids on the offices of LGBTQ+ associations in a probe into prostitution and obscenity, prosecutors said.

The Istanbul chief prosecutor’s office said operations were carried out over the weekend across 12 provinces against 38 suspects, and 26 of them were detained with authorities seizing drugs, digital

equipment, smuggled alcohol and a firearm.

LGBTQ+ association Kaos GL said at least 50 activists had been detained.

Dubbed “My Family is Safe”, the crackdown is part of a campaign that the Tayyip Erdogan-led government says is aimed at protecting family values.

“The real name of this operation is not ‘My Family is Safe’; it is state-led discrimination and the dismantling of civil society,” the Turkish Human Rights Association said on X.

Russian drone strikes Kyiv-Warsaw passenger train near Polish border

Agence France-Presse
KYIV

A Russian drone struck a Kyiv-to-Warsaw passenger train near the Polish border on Sunday but caused no casualties, Ukraine and Poland said, as Moscow steps up attacks in the fifth year of its invasion.

NATO member Poland said a second drone struck near a border crossing, prompting Foreign Minister Radoslaw Sikorski to accuse Russian President Vladimir Putin of “escalating” the conflict.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said Moscow struck the train “deliberately” and accused Russia of attacking rail and energy infrastructure as well as civilian buildings across the country.



Blaze battle: Firefighters extinguish a car of a train hit by a Russian drone strike at a railway station, in Lutsk, Ukraine. REUTERS

“It is precisely to prevent these strikes from spreading further into Europe that Ukrainian men and women fight every day, give their lives, and do not allow the aggression to expand,” Mr. Zelenskyy said.

“Putin is escalating,”

Polish Foreign Minister Sikorski said on social media.

The country’s PKP Inter-city rail service said the train was travelling from Kyiv to Warsaw with 206 passengers onboard.

With Ukrainian airspace closed, trains to neigh-

bouring Poland have been one of the main routes out of the war-torn country, often carrying refugees and packed with women and children.

Poland’s Interior Minister Marcin Kierwinski said one drone struck near the Dorohusk-Yagodyn border crossing, while the other hit the passenger train.

“Military cargo” Russia said on Sunday it struck “railway infrastructure” in western Ukraine used to “transport military cargo” from Europe.

“Strikes have continued on railway infrastructure in the western regions of Ukraine, which are used to transport military cargo from European countries,” Moscow’s Defence Ministry said in a statement.

Wheels India Limited

Regd Office : 21, Patullas Road, Chennai – 600 002
CIN : L35921TN1960PLC004175
Phone : 044-2623 4300; Fax : 044-26257121
Website : www.wheelsindia.com

Invites offers from interested parties for purchase of Mild Steel scrap items, for the two month period OCT–NOV 2026.
Details of the items available for disposal and tender terms and conditions can be had from the Company on written request.
Sealed offers can be submitted to the Sr. Vice President (Supply Chain), Wheels India Limited, Padi, Chennai - 600 050 to reach on or before 30th SEPTEMBER 2026.

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD

Office of the Chief Engineer (Central),
6th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G. Road, Bengaluru - 560 009.

IFT No.: BWSSB/CE(C)/ACE(C-1)/DCE(C)/TA-C/AE(C)/3252/2026-27 Date: 11.09.2026

INVITATION FOR TENDER
(Through KPP Portal Only)

BWSSB invites tenders in Two Stage System from eligible tenderers for the Work of providing and laying of 1100mm dia RCC NP-3 sewer pipeline from Kaggadasapura Main Road to HP Petrol Bunk coming under AEE(WWM-C)-1 sub division.
Amount put to tender: Rs. 179.34 Lakhs.
Bid Security Amount: Rs. 2,69,012/-.
Last date and time for receipt of tenders: 29.09.2026 upto 17:30Hrs. The Technical bids will be opened on: 01.10.2026 at 16:00Hrs. The details regarding the tender and participation in the e-procurement process can be obtained by logging on to https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. For further details contact the undersigned office during working hours.
Sd/-
Chief Engineer(Central).
DIPR/CP/RA/2712/2026-27

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Indian Overseas Bank

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Indian Overseas bank (IOB) invites bids for the following:
GOVERNMENT E – MARKET PORTAL – PROCUREMENT OF ENTERPRISE DISASTER RECOVERY MANAGEMENT AND RESILIENCY AUTOMATION TOOL
BID NO: GEM/2026/B/8020411 DATED 10.09.2026
The Above GEM Tender document is also available and can be downloaded from the following websites www.iob.bank.in & www.gem.gov.in For Tender details and future amendments, if any, keep referring to the following website www.gem.gov.in

कार्यालय मेलाधिकारी, कुम्भ मेला-2027, हरिद्वार।
फोन नं. 01334-224457 Email: procure.kumbhmela2027@gmail.com

संघीय प्रतिस्पर्धात्मक (ई-टेंडरिंग)
दिनांक: 11 सितम्बर 2026

पत्रांक: 1277 / कु.मे.-2027 / पी.एम.सी. / विज्ञापन
मेलाधिकारी, कुम्भ मेला 2027, हरिद्वार द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य हेतु ई-टेंडरिंग (ई-बिड सिस्टम) के अन्तर्गत निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा से सम्बन्धित सभी सूचना https://uktenders.gov.in पर दिनांक 12.09.2026 से उपलब्ध होंगी। कार्य का विवरण निम्नानुसार है:-

1. Selection of an Agency for Social Media Management for Haridwar Kumbh Mela-2027

2. Appointment of a Service provider for Installation, Operation and Maintenance of Digital Screens at various Locations for Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027 on a License fee basis.

3. Selection of an Agency for Conceptualization, Design, Fabrication, Installation, Operation & Maintenance and Deinstallation of Thematic Temporary Gates at Various Locations During Haridwar Kumbh Mela-2027

4. Selection of Service Provider for Development, Operation and Maintenance of Temporary Way Side Amenities and Parking Infrastructure in The Identified Peripheral Land Units During Kumbh Mela 2027 In Haridwar.

ई-निविदा की विस्तृत शर्तें एवं ई-निविदा प्रपत्र वेबसाइट www.uktenders.gov.in पर उपलब्ध है।
अपर मेलाधिकारी,
कुम्भ मेला-2027, हरिद्वार

GOOD TIDINGS

Great to see someone like Shafali take responsibility: Harmanpreet



GETTY IMAGES

We know how much potential we have, and we have a great team. We set high standards for ourselves and wanted to keep matching them. The openers did a great job for us. It was great to see someone like Shafali Verma taking responsibility through the tournament with bat and ball — India captain Harmanpreet Kaur.

SPECIAL ONE

Amazing things have happened in the last two weeks, says Rybakina



GETTY IMAGES

So many things have happened in the past couple of weeks... becoming the No. 1-ranked player and lifting the US Open trophy. I have been coming to this tournament for so many years, and it was never a successful Grand Slam for me. Now things have changed. This one means a lot to me — Elena Rybakina.

MEMORABLE

Dhiraj claims historic recurve gold in Saltillo World Cup Final



FILE PHOTO

B. Dhiraj secured his maiden World Cup Final medal as he won the recurve men's gold at Saltillo, Mexico, on Sunday. In a thrilling clash against Japanese World championships medallist Nakanishi Junya, the Indian archer, competing in his third WCF, posted a 6-5 (28-28, 28-29, 29-28, 28-30, 28-27, shoot-off: 10-9) win via the tie-breaker.

NOT SO GOOD

Afghanistan coach Pybus laments his team's sub-par batting show



SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Afghanistan coach Richard Pybus lamented his team's sub-par batting display after a seven-wicket loss to India in the first T20I on Sunday. "The issue was the batting. We were considerably short of the kind of target we needed to set. There is no lack of skill, but the execution was disappointing," Pybus said.

Shafali and Smriti dazzle as India regains crown

The openers add 129 inside 13 overs after Harmanpreet opts to bat; spinners Shree Charani and Deepti choke the Sri Lankans as the Women in Blue clinch a record-extending eighth title

ASIA CUP

Press Trust of India
DUBAI

Shafali Verma and vice-captain Smriti Mandhana struck forceful fifties, while the bowlers led by Sree Charani produced an equally intense effort as India crushed Sri Lanka by 72 runs to clinch a record-extending eighth women's Asia Cup here on Sunday. Openers Shafali (68, 39b, 9x4, 2x6) and Smriti (59, 39b, 5x4, 3x6) produced a symphony of power and grace during their stand of 129 off just 12.5 overs as India made 183 for five in 20 overs. The Lankans managed to rein in the opposition's middle-order, but they were no match for the guile of the Indian bowlers. Left-arm spinner Charani took four for 20 as the Islanders were bowled out for 111 in 20 overs. Their main hope skipper Chamari Athapaththu (36, 32b, 4x4, 2x6) raised 58 runs for the second wicket with Vishmi Gunaratne (20).

Double blow But off-spinner Deepti Sharma (three for 19) dealt a body blow to Lanka's aspirations, dismissing both batters in the 10th over. At 63 for three after 10



Seizing the initiative: Shafali and Smriti took the game away from the Lankans. GETTY IMAGES

overs, with the asking rate soaring over 12, the match was as good as over for the defending champion. Earlier, after Harmanpreet Kaur elected to bat,

Smriti, who hit her 36th T20I half-century, and Shafali, whose 24-ball fifty was the fastest in the tournament's history, shut the Lankans out of the match.

The scores: India 183/5 in 20 overs (Smriti 59, Shafali 68) bt Sri Lanka 111 in 20 overs (Chamari 36, Shree Charani 4/20, Deepti 3/19). **Toss:** India.

Abhishek blitz makes it a no-contest

CRICKET

Vivek Krishnan
NEW DELHI

The status of host has been accorded to Afghanistan for these three T20Is. It is perhaps a trivial detail, for the Arun Jaitley Stadium on Sunday swerved to India's beats as the Men in Blue sauntered to a seven-wicket win in the opener. Barring a small section of Afghan fans, the 25,165-strong crowd roared as and when Abhishek Sharma (82, 32b, 7x4, 7x6) and Ishan Kishan sparkled on their way to a successful chase of 157 in 13.4 overs. The two southpaws forged a 121-run partnership for the second wicket. Abhishek was in delightful touch from the get-go. From inside-out drives to power-packed pulls, many of his signature shots bore fruit. Kishan wasn't as gung-ho, but still made a 33-ball 42 (5x4, 1x6). They came together once Sanju Samson, back in the XI in place of Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, mistimed a pull off Azmatullah Omarzai to Darwish Rasooli at deep square-leg. A contribution of 10 will do little to bolster Samson's spirits, a minor blemish in an otherwise dominant display by Shreyas Iyer & Co. India's frontline bowlers also came good. While Arshdeep Singh took three wickets, Jasprit Bumrah, Axar Patel and Varun Chakravarthy scalped one each. The lone bright spot for the Afghans was an 83-run



Demolition: Abhishek went on the rampage. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

sixth-wicket stand between Omarzai and Mohammad Nabi. The former finished unbeaten on 64 (44b, 4x4, 4x6). Having won the toss on a balmy evening, India set the tone through Bumrah. Returning from an injury layoff, the spearhead quickly made his mark. Though he started with a wide down the leg side that raced to the ropes, he struck off his second legitimate delivery. A back-of-a-length ball cramped Rahmanullah Gurbaz as the opener steered it to Abhishek at slip. Afghanistan was reduced to 43 for five in seven overs, much of its misery self-inflicted. In the

fourth over, Ibrahim Zadran flicked Axar towards midwicket and charged for a second run when Sediqullah Atal sent the skipper back halfway through. It was too late for Zadran to reach the safety of the crease, with Axar collecting a pinpoint throw from Kishan to dislodge the bails. Afghanistan's situation portended a capitulation, but Omarzai and Nabi didn't give in. Omarzai's cover drive off Bumrah for a four stood out for its majesty. Naib was a suitable ally, ensuring that the partnership swelled steadily. A forehand slap off Arshdeep, which soared over long-on

SCOREBOARD

AFGHANISTAN Rahmanullah Gurbaz c Abhishek b Bumrah 0 (2b), Ibrahim Zadran run out 11 (10b, 2x4), Sediqullah Atal c Bumrah b Arshdeep 13 (13b, 1x4, 1x6), Gulbadin Naib c Nitish b Axar 2 (6b), Darwish Rasooli b Varun 2 (6b), Azmatullah Omarzai (not out) 64 (44b, 4x4, 4x6), Mohammad Nabi b Arshdeep 33 (27b, 2x4, 2x6), Rashid Khan c Axar b Arshdeep 1 (10b), Noor Ahmad run out 0 (1b), Mujeeb Ur Rahman (not out) 9 (3b, 2x4); Extras (b-1, lb-8, nb-2, w-10): 21; Total (for eight wkts. in 20 overs): 156. **FALL OF WICKETS** 1-5 (Gurbaz, 0.2 overs), 2-38 (Ibrahim, 3.6) 3-39 (Sediqullah, 4.5), 4-41 (Gulbadin, 5.4), 5-43 (Rasooli, 6.6), 6-126 (Nabi, 16.2), 7-131 (Rashid, 18.2), 8-131 (Noor, 18.3) **INDIA BOWLING** Bumrah 4-0-26-1, Arshdeep 4-0-19-3, Axar 4-0-27-1, Varun 4-0-16-1, Nitish 2-0-30-0, Abhishek 1-0-8-0, Dube 1-0-21-0. **INDIA** Sanju Samson c Rasooli b Omarzai 10 (8b, 2x4), Abhishek Sharma c Rashid b Nabi 82 (32b, 7x4, 7x6), Ishan Kishan c Rashid b Nabi 42 (33b, 5x4, 1x6), Shreyas Iyer (not out) 8 (5b, 1x4), Tilak Varma (not out) 3 (4b); Extras (lb-2, w-10): 12; Total (for three wkts. in 13.4 overs): 157. **FALL OF WICKETS** 1-18 (Samson, 2.1), 2-139 (Abhishek, 10.6), 3-152 (Kishan, 12.4). **AFGHANISTAN BOWLING** Farooqi 2-0-38-0, Mujeeb 2-0-16-0, Omarzai 1-0-14-1, Nabi 3-0-28-2, Rashid 3-4-0-34-0, Noor 2-0-25-0. **Toss:** India. *India won by seven wickets with 38 balls remaining to lead three-match series 1-0.* **Second T20I: September 15,** New Delhi, 7.30 p.m.

for a maximum, was the pick of Nabi's strokes. It was a source of mere so-lace at the close.

Rybakina denies Sabalenka a New York hat-trick



Remarkable run: Rybakina overcame a blip in the second set to go the distance. AFP

US OPEN

Agence France-Presse
NEW YORK

Elena Rybakina denied Aryna Sabalenka a third straight US Open title on Saturday, embellishing her rise to World No. 1 with a 6-4, 5-7, 6-2 victory over the player she's replacing at the summit. Kazakhstan's Rybakina, assured of supplanting Sabalenka atop the rankings by reaching the semifinals

in New York, won her third Grand Slam title to go with her 2022 Wimbledon crown and the Australian Open trophy she lifted this year with a win over Sabalenka. Rybakina has played three of her four Grand Slam finals against Sabalenka, winning two and losing one (2023 Australian Open). "I can't find the words now," Rybakina said as she accepted the trophy at a tournament where she had never before made it past

the fourth round. "I'm falling more and more in love with New York." Sabalenka, unbeaten in 20 prior matches at Flushing Meadows, clawed back courageously in the second set, breaking Rybakina for the first time in the final game to force the third. But with her trademark aplomb, Rybakina roared back to finish off a frustrated Sabalenka, who smashed her racket while sitting in her chair as her opponent was applauded by the crowd.

Game, Set, History

1 Rybakina is the first player to defeat the defending women's singles champion in the US Open final since Serena in 2002 (vs. Venus) and the first in any Slam since Keys at the 2025 Australian Open (vs. Sabalenka) 1 The Kazakh is the first to defeat the World No. 1 in the US Open final since Serena in 2012 (vs. Azarenka) which, incidentally, was the last time the top two seeds met in the final 1 Sabalenka has failed to win a Major in a year for the first time since 2022 1 Rybakina is the first woman to defeat former women's singles champions in the semifinal (Gauff) and final (Sabalenka) of a Slam since Azarenka (2012 Australian Open) 2 The Kazakh sealed the contest with an ace, the way she did against the same opponent in the Australian Open earlier this year 2 Rybakina is the second player to defeat the World

No. 1 in multiple Slam finals in a season after Graf in 1995 (vs. Sanchez Vicario, Roland-Garros and vs. Seles, US Open) 3 After ending Sabalenka's 99-week hold on the No. 1 ranking, the 27-year-old also denied the two-time defending champion a third straight US Open title 3 Rybakina, who clinched her third Major crown, needs to win the French Open to complete a Career Slam 3 She is the third player since 2000 to win the Australian Open and US Open in the same season after Kerber (2016) and Sabalenka (2024)

Compiled by ANIRUDH VELAMURI



Ashe Stadium crowd, her voice breaking, "but I guess next year."

10-man City beats United; Yamal stars for Barcelona

EURO LEAGUES

Agencies
MANCHESTER

Erling Haaland scored the winner as 10-man Manchester City defeated Manchester United 1-0 in the Premier League derby on Sunday to join Arsenal atop the standings. While Phil Foden was shown the marching orders for his aggressive action towards Bruno Fernandes in the 23rd minute, the sending-off did not dent City's hopes of maintaining its flawless start to the league season. On Saturday, Bruno Guimaraes' stunning strike and David Raya's second-half penalty save off Enzo Le Fee were the highlights of Arsenal's 2-0 win over Sunderland. Guimaraes silenced the Stadium of Light with his first Arsenal goal that arrowed into the top corner from long range. Bukayo Saka's penalty conversion with the final kick of the game sealed another im-



Truly one of a kind: Haaland was at the forefront of City's fighting performance. GETTY IMAGES

pressive victory. In LaLiga on Sunday, Lamine Yamal netted a brace in Barcelona's exciting 4-2 win over Levante, extending the Catalans' perfect start to the campaign. On Saturday, Kylian Mbappe struck twice to help Real Madrid beat Rayo Vallecano 4-1. Real took a commanding three-goal lead at half-time. **The results: Premier League:** Manchester United 0 lost to Manchester City 1 (Haaland 60); Coventry 0 lost to Brighton 5 (Kostoulas 35, Yalcouye 51, Gross 70-pen, Dunk 83, Ayari 90+4). **LaLiga:** Levante 2 (Romero 79, Brugue 88) lost to Barcelona 4

(Espart 5, Yamal 19, 48-pen, Adeyemi 90+2). **Serie A:** Napoli 1 (Lobotka 66) bt Bologna 0. **Bundesliga:** Elversberg 1 (Krattenmacher 61) lost to Bayern Munich 2 (Karl 26, Kane 72). **On Saturday: Premier League:** Sunderland 0 lost to Arsenal 2 (Guimaraes 58, Saka 90+8-pen); Tottenham 0 drew with Everton 0. **LaLiga:** Real Madrid 4 (Mbappe 14-pen, 90+1, Carreras 17, Bellingham 35) bt Rayo Vallecano 1 (Camello 51); Racing Santander 2 (Zabiri 38, 53) bt Alaves 1 (Koski 18). **Serie A:** Lazio 2 (Cancellieri 10, Nolasin 39) drew with AC Milan 2 (Moreira 65, 67); Atalanta 1 (Scamacca 41) lost to Cagliari 2 (Mendy 19, Maldini 61-pen).

INBRIEF



Tanvi pips Shaina, clinches Badminton Asia u-17 crown

Fifteen-year-old Tanvi Patri on Sunday secured the girls' under-17 title at the Badminton Asia junior championships in Chengdu (China) after overcoming fellow-Indian Shaina Manimuthu 11-15, 15-10, 15-12 in the final. The boys' pair of Aaditya Singh Negi and Tanmay Verma won a bronze.

Isharani ends runner-up at Vietnam Open badminton

Isharani Baruah finished runner-up at the Vietnam Open Super 100 badminton tournament after losing to Thailand's Sarunrak Vitidsarn 8-21, 15-21 in the final in Ho Chi Minh City on Sunday.

Anahat goes down fighting to Gilis in the second round

Belgian Tinne Gilis beat India's Anahat Singh 11-4, 8-11, 9-11, 11-4, 11-3 in the women's second round of the Qatar Classic squash.



Staying on top: The men's team was too good for Korea while the women's side had to dig deep to beat host China. HOCKEY INDIA

Indian teams assert supremacy at junior Asia Cup hockey

Press Trust of India
MOQI (CHINA)

India exerted its supremacy at the junior hockey Asia Cup, winning both the men's and women's titles on Sunday. While the men's team defeated South Korea 4-1 to bag a record

sixth crown, the women's side pipped China 1-0 to complete a hat-trick of trophies.

With the victories, both Indian teams sealed a spot at the junior World Cup.

After the title triumphs, Hockey India announced a prize of ₹3 lakh for each

player and ₹1.5 lakh for every member of the support staff.

The results: Men: India 4 (Ajeet Yadav 9, Anmol Ekka 13, Prabhdeep Singh 21, Ashu Maurya 50) bt Korea 1 (Lee Minhyeok 54). **Women:** India 1 (Sanika Chandrakant Mane 17) bt China 0.

Jefferson-Wooden and Bednarek emerge fastest; no stopping Werro

ULTIMATE C'SHIP

Agence France-Presse
BUDAPEST

Audrey Werro underlined her status as the queen of the 800m with a dominant victory at the Ultimate Championship here on Saturday as Melissa Jefferson-Wooden and Kenny Bednarek ensured American



golds in two electric 100m races. Switzerland's Werro led from gun to tape to out-strip rivals Keely Hodgkinson, Britain's Olympic champion, and Dutch Femke Broeders-Bol in

1:55.88s. A battle between two true sprint heavy-weights in the women's 100m saw World champion Jefferson-Wooden snatch victory from St. Lucia's Olympic champion Julien Alfred. Jefferson-Wooden pulled away in style in the final 50 metres to time 10.62 for victory.

Bednarek held off Jamaica's World champion Oblique Seville for victory in 9.85.

Corinthian takes the honours

RACING

HYDERABAD: C. Aryama Sudaram's Corinthian, ridden by Afroz Khan, claimed the S.N. Reddy Memorial Trophy, the chief event of Sunday's (Sept. 13) races. The winner is trained by D. Netto. 1. NAWAB SULTAN ALI KHAN MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,200M): CATCH THE WORM (B.R. Kumar) 1, Arthisha (D.S. Deora) 2, Warwick (P. Ajeeth K) 3 and Rival (Ajay K) 4. Neck, 3 and 1/2. Im, 14.35s. ₹19 (w), 20, 25 and 30 (p). SHP: 57, THP: 37, FP: 93, Q: 62, Tanala: 240. Favourite: Catch The Worm. Owner: Mr. H.S. Srikanth. Trainer: R.H. Sequeira. 2. RAJA SAHEB OF CHALLAPALLI MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,600M): TEAK (A. Ashad Asbar) 1, Evansville (P. Sai K) 2, Speedy Queen (D.S. Deora) 3 and Grit 'N' Grace (Afroz K) 4. 3 1/2, Neck and 5-1/2. Im, 39.57s. ₹14 (w), 11, 15 and 92 (p). SHP: 41, THP: 285, FP: 98, Q: 68, Tanala: 776. Favourite: Teak. Owner: Mr. Tegbir Singh Barh rep. Sarainaga Racing Pvt. Ltd.

Trainer: James Mckewon. 3. P.V.G. RAJU MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,400M): ZORINELLA (A.A. Vikrant) 1, Beech Wood (Vikram) 2, The Divinely (Rafique Sk.) 3 and Exclusive Luck (Bhawani) 4. Not run: Don Cherie. 4-1/2, 6-1/2 and 1/2. Im, 30.13s. ₹80 (w), 14, 12 and 10 (p). SHP: 17, THP: 33, FP: 119, Q: 62, Tanala: 720. Favourite: Beech Wood. Owners: M/S Ashok Kumar Gupta & Shankar Srinivas. Trainer: A. Imran Khan. 4. NAWAB SULTAN ALI KHAN MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,200M): AYUSHMAN (Surendra Singh) 1, Ek (Swarup) 2, Greif (P. Sai K) 3 and Lazarus (R.N. Darshan) 4. 1-1/4, 3 and 4-1/4. Im, 13.31s. ₹20 (w), 17, 13 and 10 (p). SHP: 69, THP: 30, FP: 112, Q: 73, Tanala: 386. Favourite: Ayushman. Owners: M/s. Dhruv Rajesh Sanghani, Mirza Ayub Baig & Awanindra Kumar Dandamudi. Trainer: D. Netto. 5. MAJOR GENERAL NAWAB KHUSRU JUNG BAHADUR MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,600M): SPECIAL STAR (P. Sai K) 1, Pride Aside (Vikram) 3 and La Fleuriere (Kuldeep Jr.) 4. 8-3/4, 1 Short Head. Im, 39.14s. ₹12 (w), 10 and

21 (p). SHP: 18, THP: 65, FP: 23, Q: 22, Tanala: 103. Favourite: Quattro. Owner: Mr. S. Pathy. Trainer: R.H. Sequeira. 6. S.N. REDDY MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,400M): CORINTHIAN (Afroz Khan) 1, Black Onyx (D.S. Deora) 2, Reigning Beauty (Md. Ismail) 2-3/4, Dead Heat and Neck. Im, 25.81s. ₹33 (w), 21, 10 and 30 (p). SHP: 29, 59, FP: 152, 398, Q: 85, 388, Tanala: 1,161, 2,177. Favourite: Cherie Chevalier. Owner: Mr. C. Aryama Sundaram. Trainer: D. Netto. 7. JATPROLE TROPHY (1,400M): DIVINE TIGER (V.S. Shekhawat) 1, Love In Paris (R.S. Jodha) 2, Varada (D.S. Deora) 3 and Power Of The Sea (Bhawani) 4. Not run: Nkalanzinzi. Neck, 2 and Neck. Im, 27.75s. ₹44 (w), 15, 13 and 15 (p). SHP: 23, THP: 29, FP: 91, Q: 37, Tanala: 272. Favourite: Love In Paris. Owner: Mr. Paramvir Singh. Trainer: L.V.R. Deshmukh. Jackpot: 70%: ₹17,309 (12 tkts.) & 30%: 847 (105 tkts.). Mini Jackpot: (i) 1,943 (18 tkts.), (ii) 1,290 (39 tkts.). Treble: (i) 487 (23 tkts.), (ii) 291 (79 tkts.).

Krystallos for first division of feature

HYDERABAD: The five-year-old grey gelding Krystallos, who ran second in his last start, should make amends in the K. Srinivas Reddy Memorial Trophy (Div. I), the chief event of Monday's (Sept. 14) races. 1. NEARCO PLATE (DIV. II) (1,100M), Terms, Maiden 3-y-o only (Cat. II), 1.55 p.m.: 1. Noble Fella (6) Arjun 56, 2. Svalpavirya-saktih (3) Md. Ismail 56, 3. Vinfast (9) Akshay K 56, 4. Wildstar (8) M.S. Deora 56, 5. Bodhi (2) Surya Prakash 54.5, 6. Divine Strides (1) P. Ajeeth K 54.5, 7. Lansing (7) P. Sai K 54.5, 8. Star Lit (5) Gaurav 54.5 and 9. Trend Setter (4) Imran Chisty 54.5. 1. VINFAST, 2. LANSING, 3. TREND SETTER. 2. NEARCO PLATE (DIV. I) (1,100M), Terms, Maiden 3-y-o only (Cat. II), 2.30: 1. Modin (6) P. Ajeeth K 56, 2. Rajendra (7) Kuldeep Sr. 56, 3. Vidyutprabhava (10) Santosh Raj 56, 4. War Captain (3) R.N. Darshan 56, 5. Callista Babe (8) Gaurav 54.5, 6. Costa Mesa (2) Akshay K 54.5, 7. Miss Lovely Angel (1) Rafique Sk. 54.5, 8. My Touch (9) Shivam 54.5, 9. Veera's Lakshmi (5) Md. Ismail

54.5 and 10. Vespucci (4) Arjun 54.5. 1. MODIN, 2. VEERA'S LAKSHMI, 3. COSTA MESA. 3. K. SRINIVAS REDDY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,400M), 5-y-o upward, rated 40 to 65, Cat. II, 3.05: 1. Bholi Punjabani (6) Surya Prakash 60, 2. Tiger Ruby (5) R.N. Darshan 57.5, 3. Armstrong (7) Kuldeep Sr. 56, 4. Catchme If You Can (8) D.S. Deora 56, 5. Sangreal (4) Swarup 55, 6. Lifes Journey (1) Ajay K 54.5, 7. Federer (2) V.S. Shekhawat 54 and 8. First Lady (3) Akshay K 53.5. 1. FIRST LADY, 2. LIFES JOURNEY, 3. TIGER RUBY. 4. MAKALU PLATE (DIV. I) (1,200M), 5-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45, Cat. III, 3.40: 1. Top In Class (8) Kuldeep Sr. 62.5, 2. Mix The Magic (3) Akshay K 60.5, 3. Great Giver (6) Sohan 59.5, 4. Swiss Girl (2) Rajpratap 59.5, 5. Inderdhanush (5) A.A. Vikrant 58.5, 6. Winning Attitude (7) Afroz K 57, 7. Golden Unicorn (9) Arjun 54, 8. Silver Lining (4) Surya Prakash 53 and 9. Aashritha Pet (1) Santosh Raj 50. 1. MIX THE MAGIC, 2. TOP IN CLASS, 3. WINNING ATTITUDE

5. K. SRINIVAS REDDY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,400M), 5-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65, Cat. II, 4.15: 1. Noble Heart (8) Akshay K 60, 2. Krystallos (1) P. Ajeeth K 58, 3. Vital Sign (3) Vikram 55, 4. Clefairy (5) A.A. Vikrant 54.5, 5. N.R. Range (9) G. Nareesh 53.5, 6. Blue Pantheress (2) Rafique Sk. 52.5, 7. Crimson Flame (7) Surya Prakash 52.5, 8. Torobravo (6) Kuldeep Sr. 51.5 and 9. Shah Of Iran (4) Uday Kiran 51. 1. KRYSTALLOS, 2. NOBLE HEART, 3. VITAL SIGN. 6. MAKALU PLATE (DIV. II) (1,200M), 5-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 4.50: 1. Emperors Charm (5) A.A. Vikrant 62, 2. Bold Beauty (8) P. Sai K 61.5, 3. Hurricane Wave (6) Afroz K 61.5, 4. Sargent (1) Sohan 58.5, 5. DAS (3) V.S. Shekhawat 58, 6. Una Paloma Blanca (7) Surya Prakash 58, 7. Dhanadeepa (2) B. Nikhil 54.5 and 8. Taaliyah (4) Uday Kiran 54.5. 1. EMPERORS CHARM, 2. BOLD BEAUTY, 3. HURRICANE WAVE Day's Best: KRYSTALLOS. Jackpot: 2, 3, 4, 5 & 6. Mini Jackpot: 3, 4, 5 & 6. Treble: (i) 1, 2 & 3, (ii) 4, 5 & 6. Tanala: All races.

Double for Sarthak, Jennifer and Kabilesh



Running in the family: Kabilesh with father and former National champ Rajini Krishnan, who tuned his bike. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Sarthak Chavan (Petronas TVS Racing) completed a double in the Super Sport 301-400cc Open class as the second round of the MRF Indian National Racing Challenge 2W concluded here on Sunday. Sarthak, who started from pole, overtook teammate Rakshith Dave at turn-4 on the final lap, with Rahil Pillarisetty finishing third.

Chennai's 16-year-old Kabilesh Rajini Krishnan (RACR Castrol Power1) came up with a double in the Super Stock 301-400cc Open class while Motul Sparks Racing's Ann Jennifer (Super Stock 165cc Intermediate) and Veedol C2 Racing's K.K. Anandhu (Stock 301-400cc Novice) posted victories in their respective races for the second time in the weekend.

Faruk Ali Sohtun (Motul Sparks Racing) won the Stock 165cc Novice class and Venkatesan Iyyappan (M3 Torque Motorsports) topped the Pro-Stock 200cc Open race.

The results (final, six laps not mentioned): Super Sport 301-400cc Open (Race-2): 1. Sarthak Chavan (Petronas TVS Racing) 10:59.565s; 2. Rakshith Dave (Petronas TVS Racing) 11:00.059; 3. Rahil Pillarisetty (RACR Castrol Power1) 11:00.590. **Pro-Stock 200cc Open (Race-2):** 1. Venkatesan Iyyappan (M3 Torque

Earlier, Fyers American Gambits had something to cheer about for the home fans, winning the third place, after beating Cheq Mumba Masters.

The results: Final: First Match: Ganges Grandmasters drew with Alpine APL Pipers 3-3 (Nepomniachtchi drew with Carlsen; Aronian bt Giri; Perez drew with Vidit; Shuvalova drew with Divya; Tsolakidou drew with Humpy; Mendonca lost to Murzin).

Second Match: Pipers lost to Grandmasters 2-4 (Carlsen lost to Nepomniachtchi; Giri drew with Aronian; Vidit drew with Perez; Divya drew with Shuvalova; Humpy lost to Tsolakidou; Murzin drew with Mendonca).

Third place playoff: First Match: Cheq Mumba Masters lost to Fyers American Gambits 2.5-3.5 (Vachier-Lagrave drew with Sindarov; Praneish lost to Nihal; Mamedyarov drew with Dubov; Harika bt Assaubayeva; Yip drew with Sarasadat; Daneshvar lost to Maurizzi).

Second Match: Gambits bt Masters 4-2 (Sindarov drew with Vachier-Lagrave; Nihal bt Praneish; Dubov drew with Mamedyarov; Assaubayeva drew with Harika; Sarasadat drew with Yip; Maurizzi bt Daneshvar).

Antonelli wins Spanish GP, extends lead over Russell

FORMULA ONE

Reuters
MADRID

Kimi Antonelli moved a mighty step closer to the Formula One title on Sunday after winning the first Spanish Grand Prix held at Madrid's new circuit with a slice of luck on the side.

The 20-year-old Italian's Madring victory, his eighth win of the season, stretched his championship lead to 81 points over teammate George Russell after 14 rounds.

Antonelli benefited from a well-timed virtual safety car (VSC) and calamitous McLaren pitstop on lap 16 of 57 that robbed pole-sitter and early leader

Lando Norris of a likely win on a track where overtaking proved almost impossible. "I think today it's good to win but it doesn't feel as good because I think Lando today deserved the win but overall, we take it," said Antonelli.

Red Bull's Max Verstappen was second with Norris third. Antonelli now has 292 points to Russell, who finished fifth, on 211.

"There was nothing I could do... just luck not on our side," said Norris. "I felt like we deserved it today but that's racing sometimes. "I feel like I drove a perfect race today, just luck wasn't with me."

Liam Lawson was sixth for Red Bull with Franco Colapinto seventh for Alpine and McLaren's Oscar Piastri eighth.

Arvid Lindblad secured precious points for Racing Bulls and Audi's Nico Hulkenberg was the final scorer in 10th.

The results: 1. Kimi Antonelli (Mercedes) 1:34:23.754s, 2. Max Verstappen (Red Bull) +4.351s, 3. Lando Norris (McLaren) 5.089, 4. Charles Leclerc (Ferrari) 29.116, 5. George Russell (Mercedes) 29.829, 6. Liam Lawson (Red Bull) 86.746, 7. Franco Colapinto (Alpine) 94.281, 8. Oscar Piastri (McLaren) 95.839. **+1 lap:** 9. Arvid Lindblad (RB), 10. Nico Hulkenberg (Audi), 11. Esteban Ocon (Haas), 12. Pierre Gasly (Alpine), 13. Gabriel Bortoleto (Audi), 14. Yuki Tsumoda (RB), 15. Alexander Albon (Williams), 16. Oliver Bearman (Haas). **+2 laps:** 17. Fernando Alonso (Aston Martin). **+3 laps:** 18. Valtteri Bottas (Cadillac). **DNF:** 19. Carlos Sainz Jr. (Williams), 20. Sergio Perez (Cadillac), 21. Lance Stroll (Aston Martin), 22. Lewis Hamilton (Ferrari). **Standings (top five): Drivers:** 1. Antonelli 292 points, 2. Russell 211, 3. Hamilton 191, 4. Norris 186, 5. Leclerc 167. **Constructors:** 1. Mercedes 503, 2. Ferrari 358, 3. McLaren 306, 4. Red Bull 230, 5. Racing Bulls 77.



Cashing in: Antonelli took advantage of Norris' calamitous pit-stop to win his second straight race. AFP

Series A: Unite8 Sports 1 & Z5 App, 10 p.m. & 12.15 a.m. (Tuesday)
LaLiga: FanCode, 12.30 a.m. (Tuesday)
Premier League: SS Select 1 & JioHotstar, 12.30 a.m. (Tuesday)
On Tuesday
Afghanistan vs India: 2nd T20I, Sony Sports Ten 5 & FanCode, 7.30 p.m.
England vs Sri Lanka: 1st T20I, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 11 p.m.

BCCI set to hold discussion with chief selector Agarkar over contract renewal

The Mumbai's tenure is scheduled to end this month; India's squad for the ODI series against the West Indies is likely to be picked on Wednesday



What's in store? Agarkar is eligible for a one-year extension under the BCCI regulations. FILE PHOTO: B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

CRICKET

Amol Karhadkar
MUMBAI

Ajit Agarkar's fate as chief selector is set to be decided over the next two days, with the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) hierarchy and the former fast bowler expected to sit down for discussions over his impending contract renewal. *The Hindu* understands that Agarkar and the BCCI office-bearers will hold a

round of discussion to chart out a roadmap for his extension. A BCCI functionary, speaking on condition of anonymity, said both parties were "positively looking at extension" and hoped that "a few teething issues" could be sorted out at the earliest. Agarkar's tenure is scheduled to end this month, although he is eligible to continue for another year under the BCCI regulations. It is believed that the BCCI office-bearers and the selection committee have

been involved in a cold war over the last couple of months. Agarkar's absence from the BCCI's performance review meeting on September 3 had further fuelled speculation over his future. Clarity over the Mumbai's tenure has assumed significance with the selection committee likely to pick India's squad for the ODI series against the West Indies, starting in Thiruvananthapuram on September 27, on Wednesday. The selectors will also

have to finalise the squad for the all-format tour of New Zealand, beginning October 22, before the end of the month. **Chance for the hopefuls** As the West Indies ODI series overlaps with the Asian Games, the selectors will be forced to look at several fringe players. The likes of Rituraj Gaikwad and others currently part of the India-A squad for the one-dayers against Australia-A are set to get a rare opportunity to don India colours.

Decoding Pakistan cricket's free fall

Agence France-Presse
KARACHI



Razzaullah. REUTERS

Pakistan cricket hit a fresh low during the dismal 3-0 Test whitewash in England, even if a dazzling cameo by debutant Razzaullah at least ensured a tour marred by mid-series sackings ended with a flicker of hope. Described as the worst team to tour England in the last 50 years, Pakistan's cycle of chopping and changing continued when head coach Sarfaraz Ahmed and bowling chief Umar Gul were sacked from their posts. Seven players were expelled from the squad as the often vulnerable batting fell to a new low, failing to cross 200 in five of the six innings. White-ball coach Mike Hesson was brought in to take charge of the side for the third and final Test, a move which failed to reverse Pakistan's fortunes.



It's a disappointing state but I could see this coming for the last five years and you can't blame one particular person or one factor because there are many – WASIM AKRAM

coaches for Tests over the last three years. The third Test defeat to England at Edgbaston was Pakistan's 16th in its last 21 Tests, leaving it last on the World Test Championship (WTC) table. Results in white-ball cricket have not been encouraging either. Pakistan crashed out in the first round of the ODI Champions Trophy last year. Its T20I fortunes has also gone into free fall. With a flawed and inconsistent domestic system failing to prepare players for the demands of international cricket, an immediate solution appears unlikely.

Our position on Russia hasn't changed: Coe

Reuters
BUDAPEST

World Athletics president Sebastian Coe said on Sunday that the governing body's position on the exclusion of Russian athletes had not changed ahead of an upcoming Court of Arbitration for Sport (CAS) case, while acknowledging the need for a resolution. Russian Athletics last month filed a fresh appeal with CAS challenging sanctions imposed by World Athletics, which has barred Russian and Belarusian athletes from international competition since Russia's invasion of Ukraine in 2022.

"Our position hasn't changed, and this isn't about politics or passports. It's about the integrity of competition," said Coe on the final day of the inaugural Ultimate Championship here. **It's about integrity** "From the age of 18, I believe that every position I've taken... it's about integrity and it's about competition, and that matters to me." Coe declined to discuss the legal strategy ahead of the arbitration proceedings but said World Athletics would continue to defend its stance. "Our position won't change".

Deepika, Atanu, Dhiraj among stars for APL

ARCHERY

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Four-time Olympian Deepika Kumari and World championships silver medalist Atanu Das will lead the home recurve contingent in the second edition of the Archery Premier League (APL). The league will feature World No. 1 Marcus D'Almeida (Brazil) and Dutch compound legend Mike Schloesser. India's 36 best archers, including reigning Asian champion B. Dhiraj, will compete alongside 12 international stars from 10 countries in Hyderabad next month. Selected on the basis of



Experience matters: Veteran Deepika will be keen to come up with a good show. FILE PHOTO

World Archery and National rankings, the Indian roster has a mix of established names and emerging ta-

lent. India's compound section is equally stacked, anchored by multi-time World Cup and Asian

Games champion Jyothi Surekha Vennam and Abhishek Verma. The international lineup also includes Tokyo Olympics champion Mete Gazoz of Türkiye, Paris bronze medalist Casey Kaufhold from the United States and World No. 2 Ella Gibson of Great Britain. "After an incredible response to our inaugural edition, we are ready to deliver an even bigger Season 2. Having the world's top international archers join our league transforms the APL into a truly global spectacle. We will continue to give our Indian archers an invaluable competitive platform to test themselves against the best in the world," said Anil Kamini, director, APL.

EDUCATIONPLUS

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Vipin Benny

India is currently witnessing a paradox in Commerce education. Every year, lakhs of students aspiring to build careers in accounting, banking, finance, taxation, business analytics, and management enrol in B.Com programmes across thousands of colleges affiliated to central and state universities. But a growing number have never studied Maths in Classes 11 and 12 due to the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and its multidisciplinary spirit.

Policy in practice

What sounds like an inclusive policy on paper is, in practice, producing graduates who are structurally unprepared for the quantitative demands of modern commerce. The consequences of this are being felt in classrooms, in placement cells, and in the corridors of India's banking and financial services industry. The time has come for educators, policymakers, and institutions to confront this inconvenient reality with urgency and honesty.

Commerce education is fundamentally mathematical. The B. Com curriculum across the country includes subjects demanding rigorous numerical reasoning: Financial Accounting, Cost Accounting, Business Statistics, Economics, Corporate Finance, Income Tax, Auditing, and Business Analytics. These subjects presuppose comfort



Numbers are crucial

Commerce education is fundamentally mathematical, and students who have not studied Maths in higher secondary school struggle with the B.Com syllabus

with algebra, percentages, ratios, logarithms, and basic calculus. Academic surveys and faculty observations consistently show that students who have not studied Maths in Class 11-12 struggle with ratio analysis, index numbers, regression, and fundamental concepts like elasticity, marginal utility, and national income aggregates. The UGC's B.Com framework under NEP 2020 intensifies this crisis by mandating Data Analytics,

Computational Finance, and Quantitative Methods as core credits. Faculty face an impossible choice: dilute the curriculum or watch unprepared students fail. Neither outcome serves the nation's educational or economic interests. **New demands** Due to India's economic transformation, the B. Com degree no longer leads to clerical roles. Today's BFSI sector, reshaped

by algorithmic trading, digital lending, GST software, and AI-driven risk assessment, demands far more. Companies expect even entry-level professionals to demonstrate Excel modelling, financial ratios, statistical forecasting, and Python proficiency. A 2024 NSDC report revealed that 38% of Commerce and Management graduates lack quantitative skills for immediate industry deployment; strongly correlated with the rise of

non-Maths Commerce tracks at the Plus Two level. The pass rates of the CA Foundation level in Quantitative Aptitude have declined notably among non-Maths candidates, a trend ICAI has formally acknowledged. Addressing this crisis demands a frank acknowledgement that the current approach to Maths in Commerce education is fundamentally unsustainable, and making Commerce Maths – covering Financial

Mathematics, Business Statistics, Matrices, Linear Programming, and Probability – a compulsory Higher Secondary subject for all students intending to pursue B. Com or allied programmes. Several state boards already offer or mandate Commerce Maths as a distinct paper, and early data from these states consistently indicate better performance and retention in undergraduate courses. Simultaneously, B. Com admission norms require urgent revision. Universities should introduce a minimum Maths competency as a formal eligibility criterion or at least mandate compulsory bridge or remedial modules for students without a Maths background in the first semester. The UGC, which has been admirably proactive in reforming the curriculum under NEP 2020, must take cognisance of this structural gap and issue clear and enforceable advisories. India's ambition to become a knowledge economy and global services hub ultimately depends on the quality of its commerce and finance workforce. That workforce is built in classrooms, and that is where Maths must reclaim its essential and indispensable place in Commerce education. *Views expressed in this article are personal*

The writer is an Assistant Professor and a Research Supervisor at St. Thomas College (Autonomous), Thrissur, Kerala.

SCHOLARSHIPS

Tata Capital Pankh Scholarship

An initiative of Tata Capital **Eligibility:** Indian students in Classes 11 and 12 or pursuing UG, Diploma, or ITI courses at recognised institutions, with minimum 60% marks in the previous year and annual parental income not exceeding ₹400,00. **Rewards:** Up to ₹15,000 (school) and up to ₹18,000 (UG, diploma, and ITI) **Application:** Online **Deadline:** October 26 www.b4s.in/edge/TCPS37

NSP Central Sector Scholarship of Top Class Education for SC Students

Offered by the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment, Government of India. **Eligibility:** Students from Scheduled Caste communities who have

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Courtesy: Buddy4study.com

Money matters

Bitget has partnered with UNICEF to create an online financial literacy module for the Game Changers Coalition curriculum. Developed as an interactive self-paced online course, the module uses short videos, visual content, and quizzes to cover supply and demand, budgeting, credit,

loans, interest rates, and blockchain basics. The programme is designed primarily for young learners and is accessible free of charge through Agora, the UNICEF's learning platform. Participants who complete the course will receive a certificate. For more details about the course, visit <https://tinyurl.com/476yhafc>



RONIN



RONIN reimagines what belongs together-sitting at the perfect intersection of modern and retro, it offers the best of both worlds and opens up a new one for those who call it their own. How?

BY BREAKING BOUNDARIES AND RIDING BEYOND THE SCRIPT.

The world is full of directions. Turn here. Stop there. Take the familiar road. Follow the itinerary. But some of the best rides begin when you decide not to.

The TVS RONIN is made for those moments. For when you see a road you've never taken and choose to find out where it leads. For when a quick ride turns into an entire day. When the destination becomes less important than the detour. When you stop asking, "What's the plan?" and start asking, "What's next?"

Often, an unscripted ride isn't about getting somewhere. It's about being open to whatever comes your way. A quiet road that wasn't on the map. A turn taken on

instinct. A place you didn't know existed. A conversation with a stranger that becomes a story.

THE TVS RONIN IS MADE FOR ALL OF IT.

Because life rarely follows the route you planned. And neither should every ride.

So leave the map behind. Forget the familiar. Take the turn that wasn't supposed to be there. Because rides are more about journeys than destinations. And every ride is better #Unscripted.

Some things are timeless for a reason. The design language of the TVS RONIN takes cues from the motorcycles that came before, but gives them a distinctly modern interpretation.

Its sculpted fuel tank, signature T-shaped LED headlamp and tail lamp, 9-spoke alloy wheels and custom-built exhaust give it the unmistakable character of a classic. But beneath that retro-inspired silhouette lies

The 225cc oil-cooled engine delivers the performance to take on

everyday commutes and spontaneous escapes alike. Dual-Channel ABS, along with Rain and Urban riding modes, helps you stay confident as riding conditions change. The upside-down front fork and rear mono-shock add to its composed ride across different terrains, while Glide Through Technology makes navigating busy city streets smoother and more effortless.

Navigate your way with SmartXconnect, bringing your digital world along for the ride with turn-by-turn navigation, trip information, ride statistics, call alerts and more.

Because being retro doesn't mean being stuck in the past. The TVS RONIN takes the character, proportions and attitude of a retro motorcycle and combines them with technology built for the present, making it not just the ultimate modern-retro motorcycle, but a truly #Unscripted marvel.

Fire doesn't stay within the lines – it has a spirit of its own which flows freely. Just like the TVS RONIN, which

doesn't stick to maps or boundaries, but thrives in spontaneity.

Which is why the Charcoal Ember variant of the TVS RONIN is iconic. It features a stark contrast between the fiery orange of an ember and the slate grey of charcoal, creating a colour theme which is one-of-a-kind.

BECAUSE AN UNSCRIPTED LIFE

Isn't about choosing between one side or the other - it's about finding your own way between them. It's about going beyond the limitations and thriving #Unscripted

Some journeys are better when you have someone to share them with. Someone who gets the thrill of taking the unmapped route. The curiosity to turn where you weren't supposed to. The instinct to see what lies

That's where CuLT comes in. Short for Culture, Travel and Lifestyle, CuLT is the TVS RONIN tribe - a community built around people who see

life a little differently and believe the best experiences are the ones you don't plan, but are rooted in spontaneity.

AS A TVS RONIN OWNER,

CuLT gives you a chance to find like-minded riders, make new connections and, most importantly, ride together. From discovering unfamiliar roads to experiencing new cultures, places and perspectives, every journey becomes an opportunity to step outside the expected. Because the world looks different when you stop travelling by the usual routes. A road trip can become an adventure. A chance meeting can become a friendship. A detour can become the story you tell for years.

Now with CuLT, you don't have to discover it all alone. Find your people. Pick a direction. Leave the itinerary behind. And ride #Unscripted.

RIDE #UNSCRIPTED

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SUDHAKARA JAIN

I am satisfied with being five-time World champion

The Norwegian rules out a return to the classical championship cycle; heaps praise on Praggnanandhaa and his playing style; says India is the team to beat in the Open section in the Olympiad

INTERVIEW

Magnus Carlsen

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Magnus Carlsen relinquished his crown four years ago. But he continues to rule the chess world. He drew the biggest applause at the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League, which concluded in Bengaluru on Sunday. On a fine evening at the Lalit Ashok, the World No. 1 from Norway spoke on a variety of topics. Excerpts:

On the newly launched Total Chess World Championship Tour

I think it is an important step for chess to rate slightly faster games as classical. We have needed a more universal system of rating every tournament game for a long time. Attempts have been made, but it has always been that the classical rating has been the gold standard.

And every tournament that doesn't have a classical rating for certain people matters less for this reason. So I am happy that Total Chess can both be classically rated and be a mix of formats that makes it harder for people to master weaknesses.

On D. Gukesh's defence of the World title in his upcoming match against Javokhir Sindarov

I think the word defence is really not a good place to begin. Because in terms of how Gukesh has played for the last couple of years, he should not be in a position where he has to defend anything. He should be in a position where he has everything to gain.

And yeah, he has shown previously in 2024 that he has, when things click, the potential to play at an extremely high level. And I don't think a lot of people believe that he will do it now, but I think it is even more of an interesting challenge for him to try and get back to that.

And chess is a highly psychological game. So it probably won't take a lot to potentially place some doubts in Sindarov's mind and for Gukesh to get some confidence. As it stands, there is no question that Sindarov is the favourite.

But in that World championship match, all you need is to win a game or to, as chess is such a drawish game. And Gukesh has shown that his ceiling is on par or better than Sindarov. There is no doubt about that.

And the other thing is that it is a short match. The first few games can determine a lot. If Sindarov is ahead early on, it is probably very, very bad news for Gukesh. If Gukesh is ahead early on, he automatically becomes a significant favourite. That is how these

matches work.

About R. Praggnanandhaa who has been in red-hot form on the chessboard

I think he has a very good foundation in chess. But he plays in a very aggressive way. And it has been working out really well for him recently. I don't think his approach has changed too much.

I am a fan. I love watching his chess. He pushes his opponents very, very hard. He manages to put pressure on basically everybody, including myself. But I think he is still not at a point where he can say that he has distanced himself from his peers. He is not quite consistent enough for that.

About the Global Chess League

It has a really good format. I have said from the start that we need team formats in chess that are genuinely exciting.

The lack of increments is very good. I would have preferred not to have the two-second increment after 40 moves as well. I think it was implemented on the request of us players who are incompetent and lazy at times.

Also this is the format where you have the very clear white against black. Matches are staggered, which is very good. The matches are always going to be decisive unless all six games are drawn.

There are just a lot of good things about the GCL. I would also like to come to India every second year or so. Because I need a year off to remind myself how crowded the tournaments are and all of that. But parts of it I really enjoy. There is no atmosphere or enthusiasm for chess in the rest of the world.

The impact of AI on chess

I am not a computer expert, so I don't know if chess is going to be solved (by the

computer). Chess is semi-solved in the sense that we are pretty sure that it is a draw. And it is a draw in a ton of ways. The margin is quite big.

AI and computers in general have made the game a lot more accessible. You are now able to follow it, see the score. For the pros, it has made it, after an initial period of excitement, even more egalitarian than it was before.

The possibility of coming back to the classical World championship cycle

After I became a father as well, I am even more certain that I will never come back to the classical World championship. There are so many things that I like about chess. There are a lot of tournaments that I like. There are a lot of formats that I like. Even classical, especially faster times of classical, maybe not as a steady diet, but at least once in a while. I can't justify spending a ton of time on something that I genuinely dislike.

Also, there is no competitive reason why I should. It makes zero sense for me. I am satisfied with being five-time World champion rather than a six-time World champion. Well, there are other world championship formats as well. Fifteen-time World champion in rapid and blitz - that is quite a lot more than everybody else.

The crowd at the GCL in Bengaluru

The crowd has been good. I love it when chess tournaments have good experiences for the public.

The favourites in the open section of the Chess Olympiad which begins

at Samarkand on Tuesday

India, Uzbekistan and the USA are all incredible teams. Considering what happened last time, I think India is still the team to beat.

The way the players, including him, are introduced to the audience before every match at the GCL

It is nice to remind myself of some of the things that I have won.

Playing golf at the Bangalore Golf Club before his GCL games

I go there and I try to hit the ball. Sometimes I hit it, sometimes not. Sometimes it goes in the hole,

sometimes it goes in the woods, sometimes it goes in the water, sometimes in the fairway.

Footballers Erling Haaland and Gerard Pique investing in chess

I think it is great. A lot of celebrities, not only from football, have an interest in chess. And it speaks of how chess has become part of popular culture a lot more during the last five, six years.

His future in chess

It is not going to be forever. At the moment, I am taking a few years at a time. It is hard to imagine me completely stepping away from competitive chess as long as I am pretty good at it. And also because I like playing.



GCL has a really good format. I have said from the start that we need formats that are genuinely exciting

Female offspring of spotted hyena inherit rank, resources, a taste for power

A ‘terrific’ new study has found that the youngest female cub born to an alpha female inherits her mother’s social status and also benefits from better access to food, allies, and breeding opportunities; over generations, these benefits accumulate, allowing a few privileged female lineages to produce more descendants

Kavi Bharathi R.
BENGALURU

Among people, it is common knowledge that privilege is often inherited. But according to new findings, hyenas also inherit resources and status, and not just their forebears’ genes, from their parents.

The findings were published recently in *Science Advances* – and they challenge the traditional evolutionary theories that assume males always face greater reproductive competition.

In the animal kingdom, the males are generally considered to be the dominant sex. They are stronger and more competitive. But spotted hyenas buck this trend.

Scientists at the Leibniz Institute for Zoo and Wildlife Research (Leibniz-IZW) in Berlin and the Institute of Evolutionary Science of Montpellier have found that in spotted hyenas, females dominate males not because they are bigger or stronger but because they have larger networks of social alliances.

The study also showed that female hyenas face more competition shaped by the inheritance of social rank across generations.

Alpha females

Marta Mosna, the lead author of the study and a researcher at Leibniz-IZW and the Ngorongoro Hyena Project, observed during her field visit in Africa that “male hyenas do not compete so much with each other”. Instead, they were found spending their time following the alpha female, the highest-ranking female hyenas, around.

“The males follow them wherever the female goes,” Ms. Mosna said. “They are staying close to her, spending a lot of time watching her, trying to connect with her, and trying to be friends with her.”

On the other hand, the competition is more fierce among the females. “This is not really what you would expect for the classical sex role that Darwin-Bateman predicts,” she said.

The Darwin-Bateman hypothesis proposes that reproductive inequality is greater among males. That is, between males and females, the males can father more offspring than females and this is why they compete more among themselves for access to mates. In mammals, the females also invest more in each reproductive event than males do – since they bear the physiological costs of pregnancy and lactation – they are more selective about mating. These predictions, formalised as the Darwin-Bateman paradigm, have been confirmed across many mammalian species.



Clan matriarch?: A spotted hyena in Etosha National Park, Namibia. SHARP PHOTOGRAPHY (CC BY-SA)

However, among spotted hyenas, the researchers found the females killing off the cubs of other females, despite all living in a matrilineal society in which the individuals were related to each other.

These and other observations supported the researchers’ conclusion that the daughters of ‘elite’ families could build powerful family lineages over time – thus also challenging one of evolutionary biology’s classic paradigms.

Clues in Lemala

For their study, the researchers studied hyenas belonging to eight resident clans in the Ngorongoro Crater in Tanzania. Their work spanned 29 years of data, eight generations, and 2,743 wild spotted hyenas.

The team used faecal samples to track paternity. These samples contained epithelial-rich mucus. “We need DNA information, which we normally take from the mucus around the faeces,” Dr. Mosna said. “We need to look at the males and wait for him to defecate. And then, when he leaves, be sure that this was his poop to do paternity analysis.”

“It is not always easy,” she continued. “Sometimes they even defecate in the water, and then it is gone, or sometimes after they eat it is a bit too liquid – it is not very pleasant to put your hand on. It can also be a bit challenging, but fortunately, our field assistants are very well trained and very good with it.”

For one clan that the team called ‘Lemala’, the researchers pieced together a 30-year genealogical tree and found that almost all the living members had descended from a single founding female lineage.

This led them to investigate how such extreme reproductive inequality could arise, which in turn led to the idea of the social inheritance of rank: since a mother’s social position is passed to her female cub, it could give that lineage an advantage increasing across generations.

When nepotism pays

The youngest female cub born to an alpha female inherits her mother’s social status and also benefits from better access to food, allies, and breeding opportunities. Over generations, these benefits accumulate, allowing a few privileged female lineages to produce more descendants.

“Inheriting the privilege ... means that you have better access to food and nutrition. They grow faster and survive longer. They also have a better position in the social network, which is also very important for hyenas,” Ms. Mosna said.

“This research teaches us that nothing is fixed. Sex roles are not fixed, like how a male or a female should behave; how our society should behave is not fixed by genetics. Only social processes can actually change society in a meaningful way.”

“This is a terrific paper that breaks a lot of new ground and serves as a powerful testament to the value of long-term field studies,” Kay E. Holekamp, a Michigan State University distinguished professor who was not involved in it, said.

Beyond hyenas

The researchers are now exploring whether similar patterns of socially inherited reproductive inequality occur in other animal species.

They have said they also want to investigate whether female hyenas invest differently in male and female cubs depending on their social rank. High-ranking females may invest more in female cubs to pass on their privileged position while lower-ranking females may favour male cubs, Ms. Mosna said.

“This study has broad implications for how we understand animal societies: social structures can transmit advantages across generations and thereby shape competition, inequality, and evolutionary outcomes,” Amiyaal Ilany of Tel Aviv University said.

“It also shows why inheritance should not be viewed as purely genetic. Socially inherited rank, relationships, and access to resources can have lasting effects on fitness and on the composition of future generations.”

(Kavi Bharathi R. is a science writer based at the Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru. bharathi.colors@gmail.com)

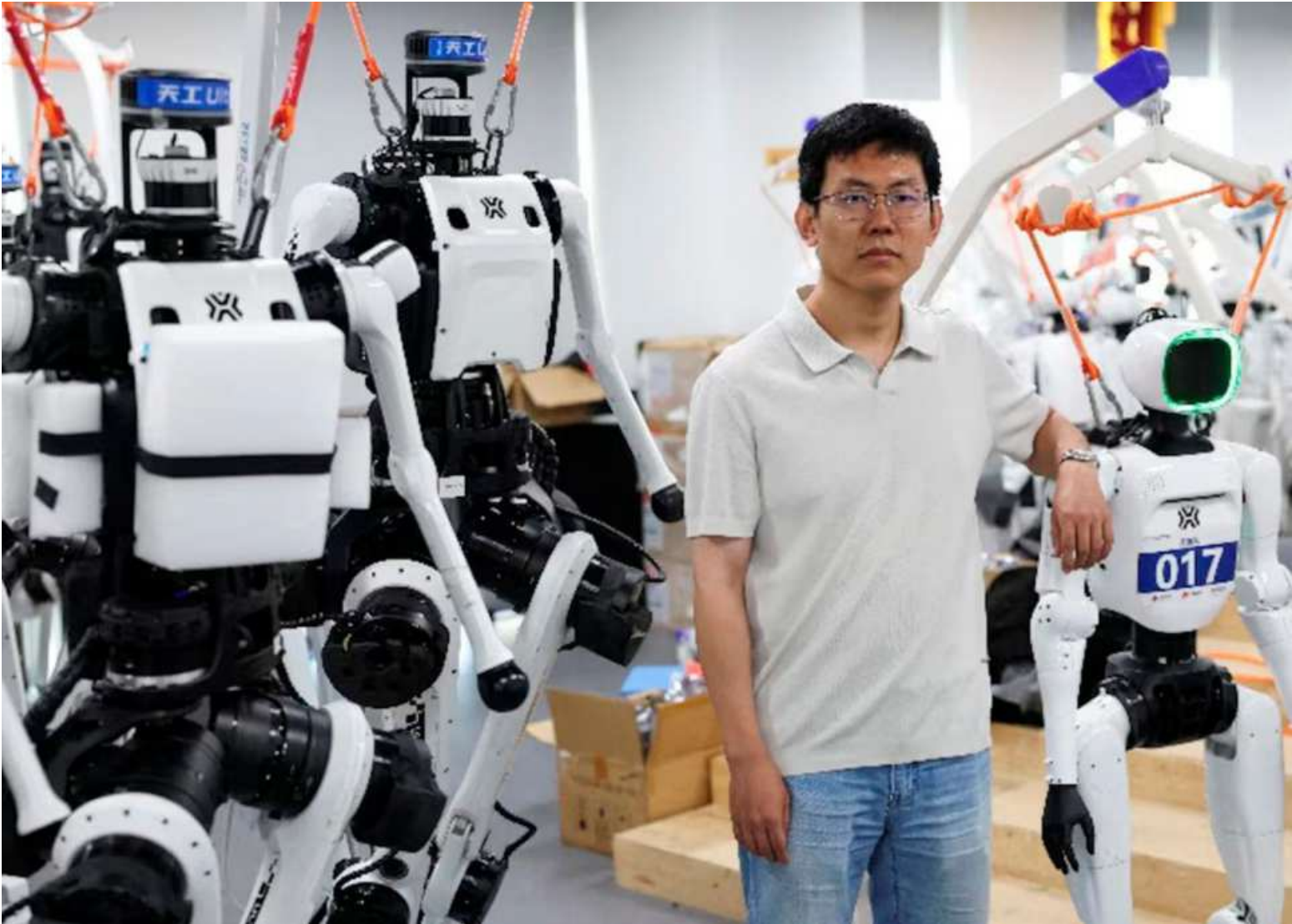
THE GIST

A team of researchers tracked 2,743 wild spotted hyenas across eight clans in Tanzania over 30 years, using DNA from mucus in faecal samples to determine paternity

By building a 30-year genealogical tree for one clan, they found that nearly all living members descended from a single founding female lineage

The researchers are now finding whether socially inherited reproductive inequality exists in other species and whether female hyenas invest differently in offspring based on rank

BIG SHOT



Jack Guo, an engineer who led the development of TianGong Ultra, stands among Tiangong Ultra and Tiangong Omni humanoid robots as he poses for a photo at the Beijing Humanoid Robot Innovation Centre on September 4, 2026. At the World Humanoid Robot Games, TianGong ran 100 metres in 8.64 seconds, almost a second faster than Usain Bolt’s world record. REUTERS

WHAT IS IT?

Mathathon: a Caltech conflict

Vasudevan Mukunth

A new event at the California Institute of Technology, called ‘Mathathon’, pulled together by a group of undergraduate students to “promote the responsible use of AI in mathematics” quickly ran into controversy last week.

Scheduled for October 30 to November 1 this year, its first round will have 100 teams of mathematicians work on open problems in mathematics for 40 hours, with each team receiving around \$20,000 worth of tokens to use on frontier AI models. The teams that have made the most progress will enter a second round that will be six months long. According to the organisers, the event aims in part to increase the exposure of mathematicians outside AI companies to powerful models.

However, on September 10, a coalition of current and former Caltech mathematicians published an open letter, signed by over 700 of their peers, including four Fields Medal winners, asking for the Mathathon to be called off. The letter said the Mathathon’s accelerated format would encourage “slop” mathematics that other mathematicians must then spend time and effort to correct and verify. Because OpenAI and Anthropic had sponsored the event, the letter also accused AI companies of turning open mathematics problems into publicity contests while draining mathematics of its human and social resources.



A view of the Millikan Library at Caltech. CANON.VS.NIKON (CC BY-SA)

While the organisers subsequently changed some of the Mathathon’s rules, including requiring participants in the second round to publish their work as preprint papers on the arXiv repository, they refused to cancel the event. However, OpenAI withdrew as a sponsor; the website currently says Anthropic will provide \$600,000 in credits.

For feedback and suggestions for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’